



Copilot Chat Basic Workshop

One-day participant guide

Check, compare, chase, draft, organise and reuse: run a real purchase from quotation to justification memo with Copilot Chat, Copilot in Outlook, Pages, Notebooks and your own agent, without the paid license.

Copilot Chat Basic Workshop

One-day participant guide · Participant edition, version 1.0

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Online resources: github.com/Asraf-JS/Copilot-Chat-Basic-Workshop

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Screenshots show the product at the time of writing. Microsoft updates its apps often, so labels and layouts in your tenant may differ slightly.

About the author

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He holds a Bachelor of Information Technology (Multimedia) from the University of Malaya, along with Microsoft certifications in Power BI (PL-300) and AI for business (AB-730). Outside the classroom he writes his own automation tools in Python and Node.js, mostly to save himself from doing the same task twice.

He runs his training practice solo, which means he has personally felt every inefficiency this book tries to fix.

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Before you begin

How to use this book

This book collects the notes and prompts from the one-day Copilot Chat Basic Workshop in one place, so you can follow along offline and keep it at your desk afterwards.

Each chapter matches one chapter of the course and has two parts:

- **Notes** explain each feature and walk you through the steps, mostly point and click, with screenshots, checkpoints and troubleshooting.
- **Hands-on exercises** give you every prompt you type, ready to copy.

The course is written for people who have Microsoft Copilot at work **without** the paid Microsoft 365 Copilot license. Everything on the main path works with either the **Copilot Chat (Basic)** or the **M365 Copilot (Basic)** label. Chapter 9 is the only exception, and it's marked optional.

Look out for the coloured boxes. Blue boxes are notes, including the **If you don't see this** boxes that cover features your organisation may not have yet. Teal boxes are tips, purple boxes are things to try, orange boxes are key points, and red boxes are warnings.

Prefer to copy prompts rather than retype them? Everything in this book is also online at github.com/Asraf-JS/Copilot-Chat-Basic-Workshop, where each grey box has a copy button. Copying from there is safer than copying from a PDF, which can add line breaks in the middle of a prompt.

Your Copilot Chat training journey

One laptop purchase, start to finish: real work with the Copilot you already have.

FOUNDATIONS

01

Which Copilot do I have?

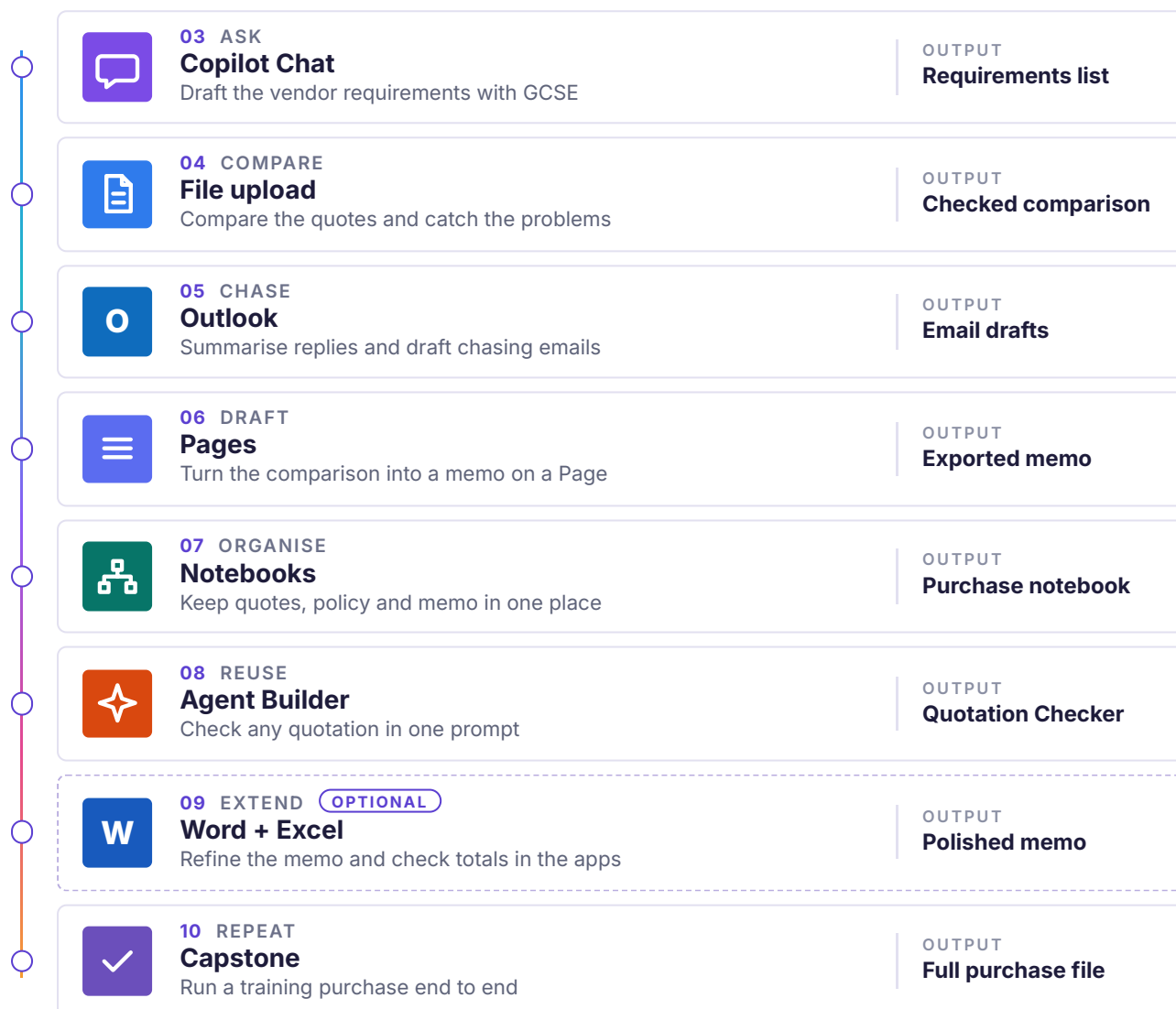
Your label, the green shield and what Basic can't do

02

Find your way around

Ways in, the message box and your chats

THE PROJECT, APP BY APP



Ask → Compare → Chase → Draft → Organise → Reuse → Extend → Repeat

Course scenario

Throughout the course you handle one real purchase from start to finish.

You're an executive in the Admin and Facilities department at Teratai Holdings Berhad. The department needs 25 new laptops for next quarter's hires. Company policy says any purchase above RM20,000 needs three written quotations, a comparison, and a justification memo before the HOD signs off.

Each chapter takes you one stage further with that purchase:

Stage	What happens
Check	Confirm your Copilot label and the EDP shield before touching any company document
Explore	Tour the Copilot app and run a first prompt about what to look for in a laptop quotation
Ask	Use GCSE to draft the requirements you'll send to vendors
Compare	Upload the three quotations and the procurement policy, build a side-by-side comparison, and catch the problems
Chase	Use Copilot in Outlook to summarise vendor replies and draft a request for a revised quote
Draft	Move the comparison into a Page and write the justification memo, then export it
Organise	Put the quotes, policy and memo in one Notebook so the whole purchase lives in one place
Reuse	Build a Quotation Checker agent so the next purchase takes minutes
Extend	Optional: open the comparison or memo in the Office apps with in-app Copilot (M365 Copilot Basic only)
Repeat	Capstone: run a second purchase end to end on your own

Ground rules

Important: Use only the fictional sample files during class, and check for the green shield before you upload anything. Only send test emails to yourself. Copilot can be wrong: check its numbers and claims before you use them, the same as you would a colleague's draft.

01

CHAPTER 1

Which Copilot Do I Have?

Before you upload a single quotation, you need to know two things: which version of Copilot your organisation has given you, and whether it's the protected work version. This chapter answers both in a few minutes, so you don't spend the rest of the day hunting for buttons you don't have.

Prompts: every prompt you need is in the steps, with a Copy button. The prompts page has them all on one page too.

Estimated time: 20 minutes

Your result: You know your Copilot label, you've seen the green shield, and you've run one safe prompt in Copilot Chat.

What You Will Learn

- Find the Copilot label on your Microsoft 365 account
- Tell Copilot Chat (for work) apart from Microsoft Copilot (for personal use)
- Check for the green enterprise data protection shield before you share anything
- Know what Copilot Chat (Basic) can't do, so you stop looking for it

Before You Begin

You need:

- your **work or school account** (the one you use for Outlook and Teams at work)
- a browser: Microsoft Edge or Google Chrome
- about five minutes of quiet to read the label table in 1.2

Note: Use the same work account all day. If your browser is signed in to a personal Microsoft account too, open an InPrivate or Incognito window for the course so the two don't mix.

1.1 Find Your Copilot Label

Microsoft shows a short label on your account that tells you which Copilot experience you have.

1. Open the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at m365.cloud.microsoft/chat and sign in with your work account.
2. Look at the bottom of the left pane. Your name is there, with a short Copilot label under it.
3. The label reads one of the three labels in the table in section 1.2.
4. Write your label down. You'll need it in Chapter 9, which is only for one of the labels.

If you don't see this: Some organisations haven't received the label yet, or show it somewhere else. Ask your trainer to confirm your label. If your organisation has more than 2,000 Microsoft 365 users and you don't have a paid Copilot license, you almost certainly have **Copilot Chat (Basic)**.

1.2 Copilot Chat, Microsoft Copilot and Microsoft 365 Copilot

There are three work labels, and one consumer product with a similar name.

Label	Who usually has it	Copilot inside Word, Excel, PowerPoint and OneNote	Copilot in Outlook	Speed at busy times
Copilot Chat (Basic)	Organisations with more than 2,000 users, no paid license (since 15 April 2026)	No	Yes	Standard access, can slow down
M365 Copilot (Basic)	Smaller organisations, no paid license	Yes, standard access	Yes	Standard access, can slow down
M365 Copilot (Premium)	Anyone with the paid Microsoft 365 Copilot license	Yes, full features	Yes	Priority access

This course is built for the two **Basic** labels. Everything on the main path works with either one. Chapter 9 is the only exception: it needs **M365 Copilot (Basic)** or Premium.

Microsoft Copilot (at copilot.microsoft.com, or the Copilot app that comes with Windows) is the consumer product. When you sign in with a personal Microsoft account, your chats are covered by consumer terms, and you won't see the green shield. Don't use it for company documents.

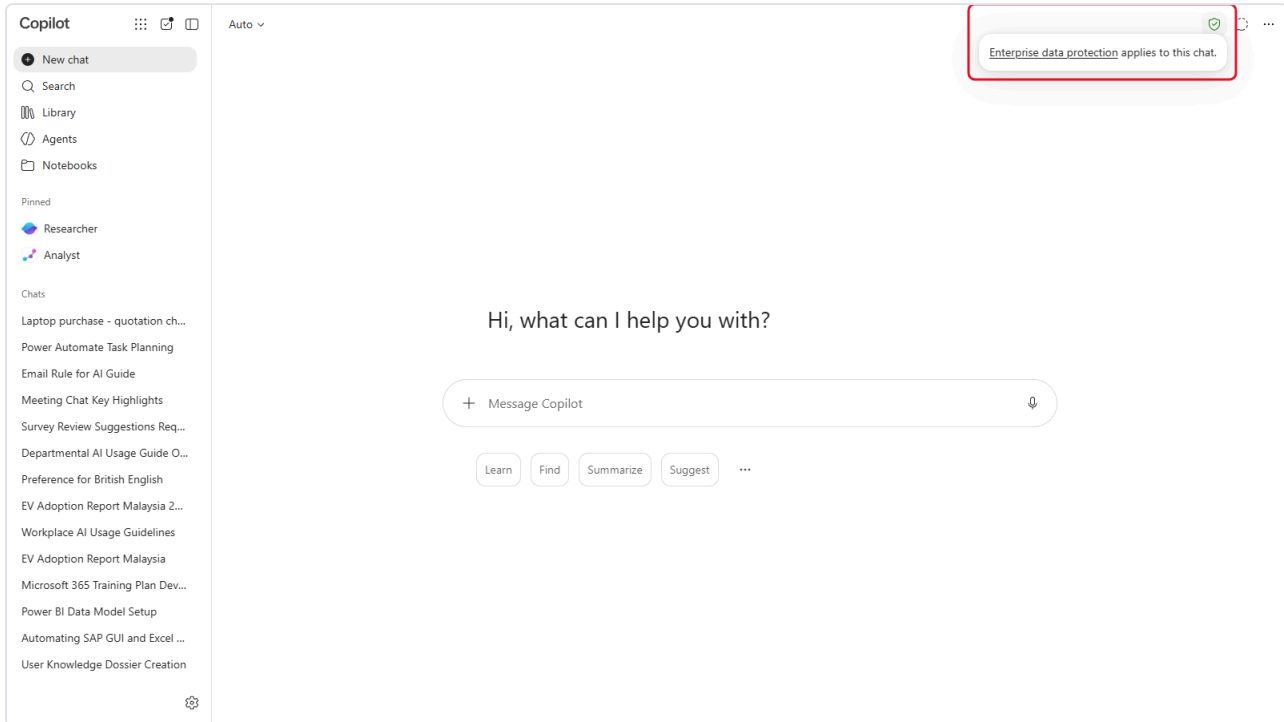
Copilot Chat is the work version. You reach it with your work account, and it shows the green shield you check in the next section.

Key point: The account matters more than the app. The same browser can open both versions. Check which account you're signed in with before you paste or upload anything.

1.3 Check for the Green Shield

The green shield means **enterprise data protection (EDP)** applies to your chat. Your prompts and uploaded files stay inside your organisation's Microsoft 365 boundary, the same as your email and OneDrive, and they aren't used to train the AI models.

1. Open the Microsoft 365 Copilot app: go to m365.cloud.microsoft/chat. You can also select **Copilot** from the left side of the Microsoft 365 home page.
2. Look at the top-right corner of the page for a small green shield.
3. Point at the shield with your mouse (don't click). A tooltip appears: **Enterprise data protection applies to this chat.**



Point at the shield to see the tooltip. No shield means no enterprise data protection.

Warning: No shield, no upload. If you can't see the green shield, you're probably signed in with a personal account. Stop, sign out, and sign back in with your work account before you continue.

Checkpoint: You can see the green shield and its tooltip.

1.4 What Basic Can't Do

These features exist, and you'll see them in Microsoft videos and articles. They need the paid license (or a preview your organisation has signed up for), so they aren't in this course:

- **Researcher** and **Analyst**, the deep research and data analysis agents
- **Cowork**
- searching your work files, Teams chats, meetings and SharePoint from Copilot Chat. With Basic, Copilot works with the web and the files you upload, plus your mailbox and calendar inside Outlook (Chapter 5)
- agents that use SharePoint sites or files as knowledge
- custom skills in Agent Builder
- voice conversations with Copilot

- priority access at busy times

You may still see **Researcher** and **Analyst** listed under **Pinned** in the left pane. They belong to the paid license and aren't part of this course, so leave them alone.

If a colleague shows you one of these, you're not missing a setting. Your license doesn't include it.

If you don't see this: Your organisation's admin can turn off parts of Copilot Chat, such as file upload, image generation or agents. If a button from this course is missing for you but not for the person next to you, tell your trainer. Standard access can also be slow or temporarily limited at peak times: if a response stalls, wait a minute and send the prompt again.

1.5 Run Your First Safe Prompt

Time to use it. This prompt asks Copilot about its own protections, using the web.

1. In the Copilot app, select **New chat** at the top left.
2. Click in the message box at the bottom, paste the prompt below, and press Enter.

Explain in plain English what "enterprise data protection" means in Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat. What happens to a file I upload? Answer in 5 short bullet points for an office worker with no IT background.

3. Read the answer. Look for the small grey labels at the end of sentences, such as **microsoft +1**. They name the websites Copilot used. **Sources** under the answer lists them all.

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Copilot Chat interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation options: New chat, Search, Library, Agents, Notebooks, Pinned (Researcher, Analyst), and Chats (Laptop purchase - quotation ch..., Power Automate Task Planning, Email Rule for AI Guide, Meeting Chat Key Highlights, Survey Review Suggestions Req..., Departmental AI Usage Guide O..., Preference for British English, EV Adoption Report Malaysia 2..., Workplace AI Usage Guidelines, EV Adoption Report Malaysia, Microsoft 365 Training Plan Dev..., Power BI Data Model Setup, Automating SAP GUI and Excel ..., User Knowledge Dossier Creation). The main area displays a prompt: "Explain in plain English what 'enterprise data protection' means in Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat. What happens to a file I upload? Answer in 5 short bullet points for an office worker with no IT background." The response explains that enterprise data protection means Microsoft treats Copilot Chat conversations as company business data and applies security controls. It lists five bullet points: 1. Prompts and files are protected as company data. 2. Microsoft does not use prompts, responses, or work content for AI training. 3. Copilot can read uploaded files to answer questions. 4. IT administrators can audit or review Copilot activity. 5. Uploaded files are stored securely for a limited period and not used for AI training. Small grey labels like "microsoft +1" are placed at the end of several sentences. At the bottom, a "Sources" button is highlighted with a red box. The interface also includes a "Message Copilot" input field and a disclaimer: "AI-generated content may be incorrect."

Each small label shows where a fact came from. You check these properly in Chapter 3.

Independent Practice

Ask Copilot what Copilot Chat (Basic) can't do, using the second prompt on the prompts page. Compare its answer with the list in 1.4. Did it get anything wrong or out of date? Copilot's knowledge of its own features isn't always current, which is a useful thing to learn on day one.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
No green shield	You're signed in with a personal account. Sign out and sign in with your work account
The page asks you to sign in again and again	Clear the browser's cookies for microsoft.com, or use an InPrivate window
You see Word, Excel and PowerPoint buttons in Copilot but no Copilot inside the apps	That's normal for Copilot Chat (Basic) . The apps open, but without Copilot inside them
The answer is slow or stops halfway	Standard access is busy. Wait a minute and try again
Your label isn't shown anywhere	Ask your trainer. Your organisation may not have the label yet

Lesson Summary

You found your label, learned that the work account and the green shield are what make Copilot safe for company documents, and saw the short list of things Basic doesn't include. Next, you find all the ways into Copilot Chat and learn the controls around the message box.

Check yourself: Can you name your label, point to the shield, and name two features Basic doesn't include?

For reference, see Microsoft's [Copilot Chat privacy and protections](#) page.

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Two short prompts to try once you've found the green shield. Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner.

Part 1: Your first safe prompt

Session: new chat | **Grounding:** web

Explain in plain English what "enterprise data protection" means in Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat. What happens to a file I upload? Answer in 5 short bullet points for an office worker with no IT background.

Part 2: What can't I do?

Session: same chat | **Grounding:** web

Compare the answer with the list in section 1.4 of the notes.

I have Copilot Chat (Basic), without a paid Microsoft 365 Copilot license. List the Copilot features I should not expect to have. Show your sources, and tell me how recent each source is.

02

CHAPTER 2

Find Your Way Around

You'll spend most of today in the Microsoft 365 Copilot app, so it pays to know where things are. This chapter tours the app, shows the other places you can open Copilot Chat, and gets you asking your first purchase question: what should a good laptop quotation include?

Prompts: every prompt you need is in the steps, with a Copy button. The prompts page has them all on one page too.

Estimated time: 30 minutes

Your result: A named chat about laptop quotations that you can find again, and a shared link to one of Copilot's answers.

What You Will Learn

- Open Copilot Chat from the Copilot app, Edge, Teams and Outlook
- Use the controls around the message box
- Start, rename, find and delete chats
- Share a response with a colleague
- Add a screenshot to a prompt (Windows)

Before You Begin

You need the green shield from section 1.3. If you can't see it, go back to Chapter 1 before you continue.

Apps You'll Use

Everything in this course runs in the browser, apart from the screenshot tool in 2.7. Start from the Microsoft 365 home page and you can reach every app from it.

App	Web address	What you use it for
Microsoft 365 Copilot app	m365.cloud.microsoft/chat	Copilot Chat, Pages, Notebooks and agents. Your main workspace today
Outlook	outlook.office.com	Copilot in Outlook (Chapter 5)

Teams

teams.microsoft.com

Another way into Copilot Chat

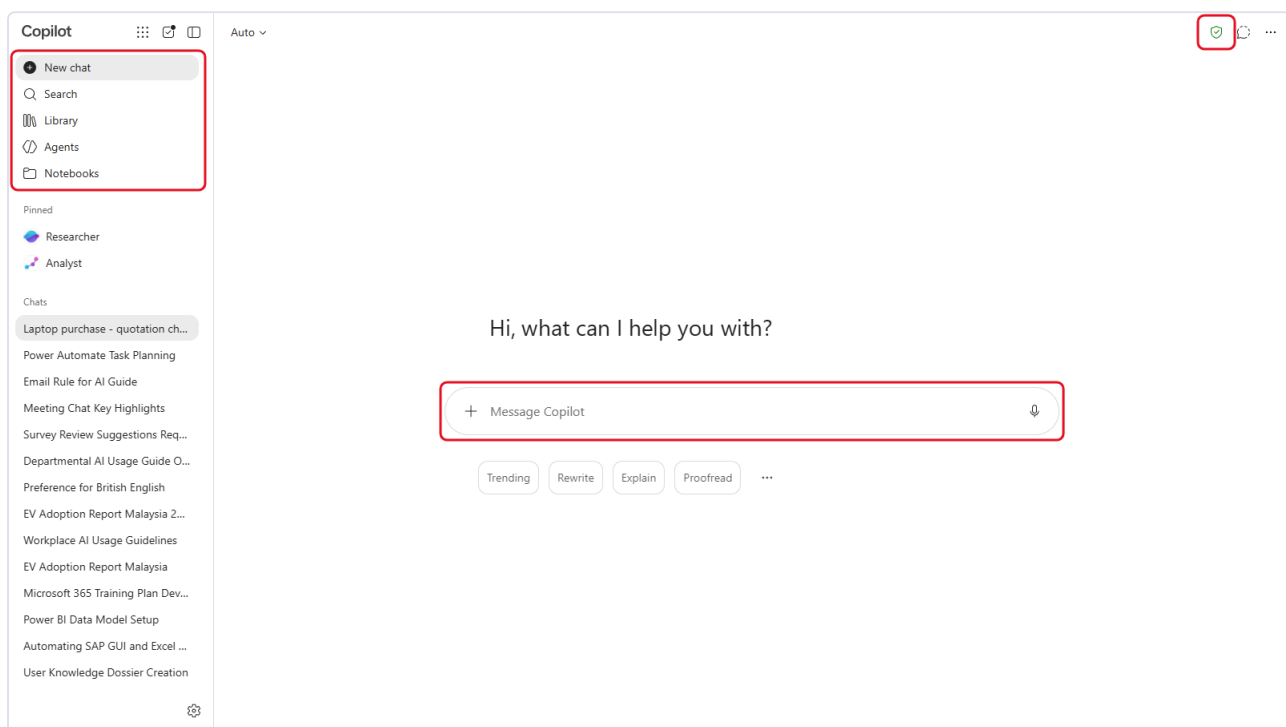
Microsoft Edge

Installed on your computer

Copilot in the sidebar

2.1 Open the Microsoft 365 Copilot App

1. Go to m365.cloud.microsoft/chat. Sign in with your work account if asked.
2. Find the parts of the screen, using the picture below:
 - the **left pane**: **New chat**, **Search**, **Library**, **Agents** and **Notebooks** at the top, then **Pinned** items, then your recent **Chats**
 - the **message box** in the middle of the page, where you type
 - the **green shield** at the top right



The three areas you use all day: the left pane, the message box and the shield. Your list of chats will be shorter, or empty, on your first day.

Note: You may see **Researcher** and **Analyst** under **Pinned**. They belong to the paid license and aren't used in this course, so leave them alone.

Tip: Your Copilot Pages are kept under **Library**. You'll use them in Chapter 6.

Tip: Pin the tab (right-click the browser tab, then **Pin**) so Copilot is always one click away during the course.

2.2 Other Ways In: Edge, Teams and Outlook

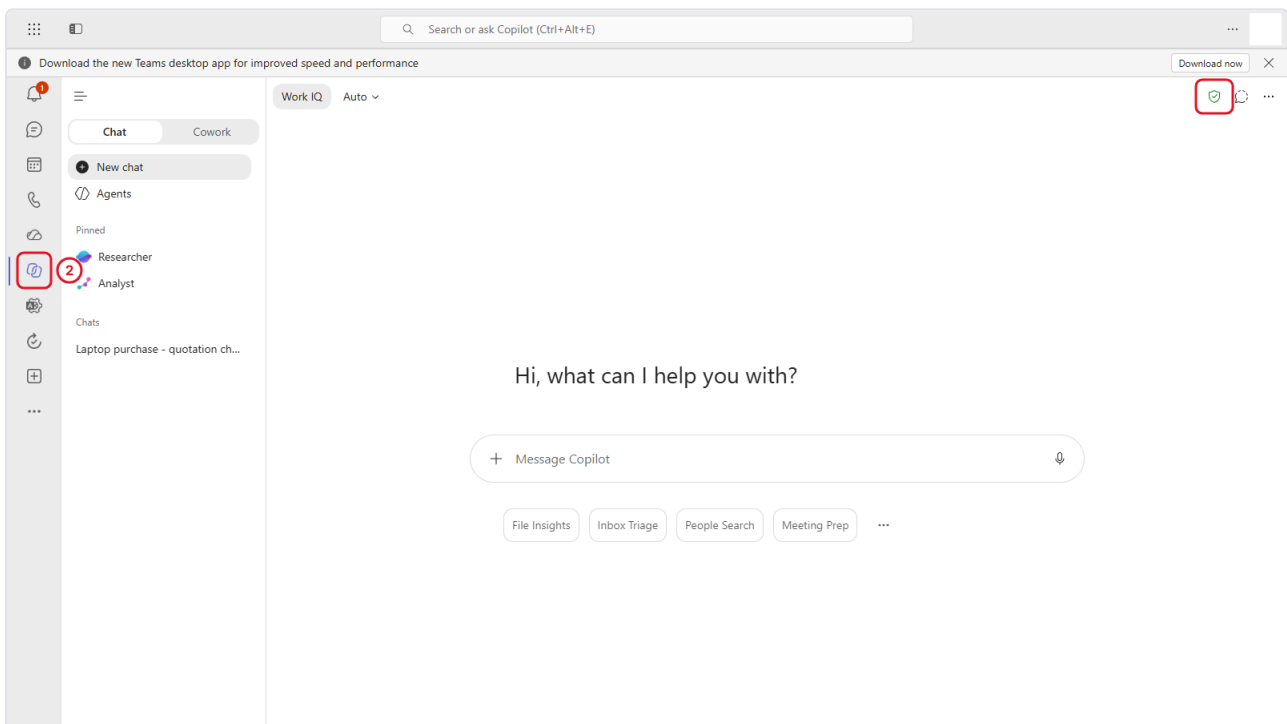
The same Copilot Chat, with the same green shield, is available in other places. Your chats in the Copilot app also show up in Teams. A chat you have in Edge or Outlook may only stay there, depending on how your organisation set things up.

Microsoft Edge

1. Open Microsoft Edge and sign in to Edge with your work account (select the profile picture at the top left of Edge).
2. Select the **Copilot** icon at the top right of the Edge window. A sidebar opens.
3. Check the sidebar shows the green shield. If it shows your personal account, switch Edge profiles first.

Teams

1. Open Teams.
2. Select **Copilot** in the bar of apps on the far left. Copilot opens inside Teams, with the green shield at the top right.



*Copilot in Teams is the same Copilot Chat, and your chats from the Copilot app show up here too. If you see a **Work IQ** button or a **Cowork** tab, as in this picture, they belong to the paid license and aren't part of this course.*

Outlook

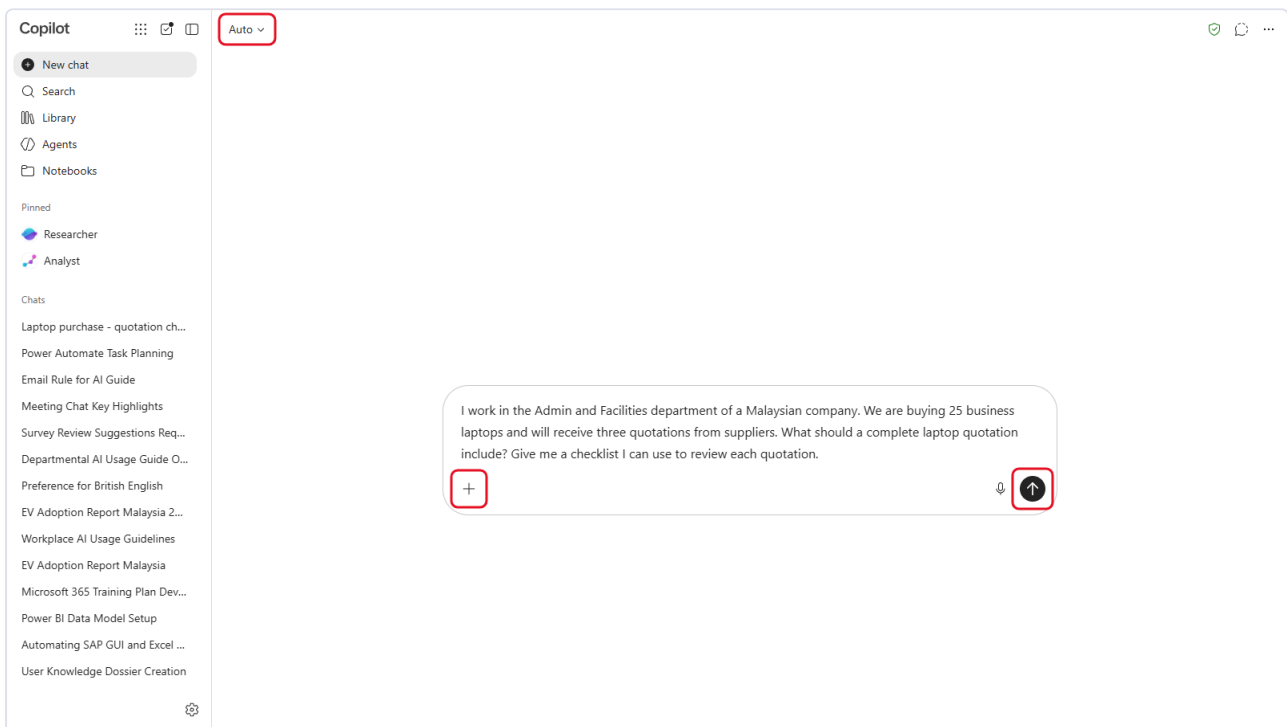
Copilot in Outlook has its own buttons for summarising and drafting email. You use it in Chapter 5, so there's nothing to do here yet.

If you don't see this: Your organisation may have hidden Copilot in Teams or Edge, or the Copilot icon in Edge may have moved to a different spot after an update. The Copilot app at m365.cloud.microsoft/chat always works if Copilot Chat is turned on for you.

2.3 The Message Box

Everything you ask goes through the message box. Point at each control to see its name.

1. Select **New chat**.
2. Point at each control to see its name:
 - **+** (**Add and manage sources**) on the left of the box, to add files and images. You use it in Chapter 4
 - the **Send** arrow on the right, which appears once you start typing
 - **Open prompt gallery**, with ready-made prompts (Chapter 3). It sits next to the suggestion buttons under the empty box, and disappears while you type
 - **Auto**, at the top left of the page, which chooses how Copilot answers. Leave it on **Auto** for this course



Type in the box and the Send arrow appears. The Auto setting is at the top left of the page.

Note: You'll see a microphone (**Start dictation**) in the message box. Dictation types what you say into the box. Voice conversations with Copilot need priority access, so they aren't part of this course.

2.4 Run Your First Prompt

The department needs 25 laptops, and three vendors will send quotations. Before they arrive, find out what a good quotation should include.

1. In the message box, paste the prompt below and press Enter.

I work in the Admin and Facilities department of a Malaysian company. We are buying 25 business laptops and will receive three quotations from suppliers. What should a complete laptop quotation include? Give me a checklist I can use to review each quotation.

2. Read the answer. Copilot uses the web to answer, so it may show sources.
3. Ask a follow-up in the same chat. Copilot remembers what you've already discussed in this chat:

Which three items on that checklist are most often missing or wrong in real quotations? Explain why each one matters.

The screenshot shows the Copilot chat interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation options: New chat, Search, Library, Agents, Notebooks, Pinned (Researcher, Analyst), and Chats. The 'Chats' section is expanded, showing a list of chat titles, with 'Laptop purchase - quotation ch...' selected. The main chat area displays the user's prompt: 'I work in the Admin and Facilities department of a Malaysian company. We are buying 25 business laptops and will receive three quotations from suppliers. What should a complete laptop quotation include? Give me a checklist I can use to review each quotation.' Below the prompt, Copilot's response includes a summary: 'For a purchase of 25 business laptops, the quotation review should go beyond just price. A complete quotation should allow your Admin, Facilities, Procurement, IT, and Finance teams to evaluate the supplier on cost, specifications, warranty, delivery, and support.' This is followed by a section titled 'Laptop Quotation Review Checklist' with a sub-header '1. Supplier Information'. A table lists items to check, each with a checkbox. At the bottom of the chat area is a message input box with a plus icon and a microphone icon. A small disclaimer at the very bottom reads 'AI-generated content may be incorrect'.

Item	Check
Supplier company name	☐
Company registration number (SSM)	☐
Contact person	☐
Phone and email	☐
Quotation reference number	☐
Quotation date	☐
Quotation validity period	☐

A first checklist. In Chapter 4 you compare the real quotations with your company's own policy, which matters more than any general checklist.

Checkpoint: You have one chat with two answers in it.

2.5 Find and Manage Your Chats

Copilot names each chat for you, usually from your first prompt. A clear name makes it easy to find later.

1. In the left pane, find your chat under your recent chats.

- Point at it and select the ... (More options) that appears.
- Select **Rename** (the menu also has **Move to notebook** and **Delete**), type the name below, and press Enter.

Laptop purchase - quotation checklist

- Select **New chat**, then select your renamed chat again. Your conversation is still there.
- To delete a chat you don't need, use the same ... menu and select **Delete**. Don't delete this one.
- To find an older chat, select **Search** at the top of the left pane and type a word from its name.

The screenshot shows the Copilot Chat interface. On the left, a sidebar lists various chats. One chat, 'Laptop purchase - quotation...', is highlighted with a red box and a red circle '2'. A context menu is open next to it, showing options: 'Rename', 'Move to notebook', and 'Delete'. The 'Rename' option is highlighted with a red box and a red circle '3'. The main chat window on the right shows a conversation. At the top, a user message says: 'I work in the Admin and Facilities department of a Malaysian company. We are buying 25 business laptops and will receive three quotations from suppliers. What should a complete laptop quotation include? Give me a checklist I can use to review each quotation.' Below this, a Copilot response says: 'For a purchase of 25 business laptops, the quotation review should go beyond just price. A complete quotation should allow your Admin, Facilities, Procurement, IT, and Finance teams to evaluate the supplier on cost, specifications, warranty, delivery, and support.' This is followed by a section titled 'Laptop Quotation Review Checklist' with a sub-section '1. Supplier Information'. Below this is a table with two columns: 'Item' and 'Check'. The table contains several rows with items like 'Supplier company name', 'Company registration number (SSM)', 'Contact person', 'Phone and email', 'Quotation reference number', 'Quotation date', and 'Quotation validity period'. Each item has a checkbox in the 'Check' column. At the bottom of the chat window, there is a text input field with a plus icon and a 'Message Copilot' button.

Rename, Move to notebook and Delete are in the More options menu beside each chat.

Tip: Start a new chat for each new task. Mixing two jobs in one chat confuses Copilot, because it tries to use everything earlier in the chat as context.

2.6 Share a Response

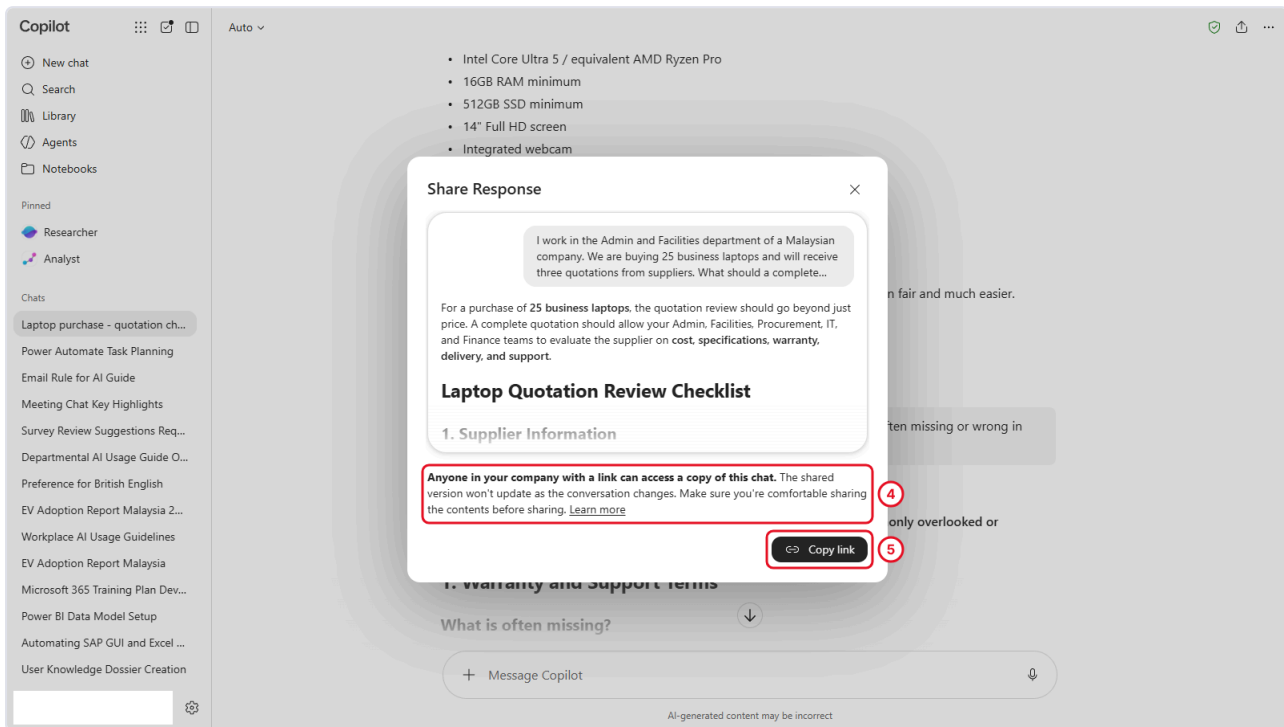
The quickest way to pass an answer on is to copy it.

- Under the checklist answer, point at the response to show its buttons.
- Select **Copy** (the two-squares icon). The text is copied with its formatting, ready to paste into an email, a Teams chat or a document.

Some organisations can also share a link to a response.

- Select **More options** (...) under the response. If you see **Share response**, select it.

4. Read the notice. Anyone in your company with the link can open a copy of the chat, and the copy doesn't change if you carry on chatting.
5. Select **Copy link** only if you want to share it. For this exercise, select the **X** to close the box instead.



Anyone in your company with the link can read a copy of this chat. Check what's in it before you share.

If you don't see this: **Share response** is an early-access (Frontier) feature, so many organisations don't have it yet. Use **Copy** instead.

Important: Only share responses that contain information your colleague is allowed to see. Once a chat includes details from an uploaded quotation, treat a shared link like the quotation itself.

2.7 Use the Screenshot Tool (Windows)

On Windows, you can capture part of your screen and add it to a prompt without saving a file first. This is handy when you want Copilot to explain an error message or read a table on a supplier's website.

1. Open the **Microsoft 365 Copilot app on Windows** (installed on your computer, not the browser).
2. In the message box, select **+** and then the screenshot option.
3. Drag a box around part of your screen. The picture appears in the message box.
4. Type a question about it, for example: `What does this message mean, and what should I do next?`

If you don't see this: The browser version of Copilot doesn't have the screenshot tool, and it's still reaching some Windows computers. Use the Windows Snipping Tool instead (Windows key + Shift + S), save the picture, and add it with **+** like any other file.

Independent Practice

Start a new chat and ask Copilot how to tell whether a laptop warranty is "onsite" or "carry-in", and why the difference matters to a company with 25 users. Rename the chat so you can find it later.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
Your old chats are missing	Check you're signed in with the same work account. Chats from another account don't appear
The Copilot icon in Edge opens a personal Copilot	Switch the Edge profile to your work account
Rename isn't in the menu	Open the chat first, then point at its name in the left pane
Share response isn't in the menu	It's an early-access feature your organisation may not have. Use Copy instead
A prompt stops halfway	Standard access is busy. Wait a moment and send it again

Lesson Summary

You can now open Copilot Chat from four places, find your way around the message box, and keep your chats tidy. You also have a first checklist for reviewing quotations. Next, you learn a simple framework that makes every prompt you write more useful.

Check yourself: Can you rename a chat, find it again, and share one response?

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Your first questions about the laptop purchase. Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner.

Part 1: What to look for in a laptop quotation

Session: new chat | **Grounding:** web

I work in the Admin and Facilities department of a Malaysian company. We are buying 25 business laptops and will receive three quotations from suppliers. What should a complete laptop quotation include? Give me a checklist I can use to review each quotation.

Part 2: Follow-up questions

Session: same chat | **Grounding:** web

Which three items on that checklist are most often missing or wrong in real quotations? Explain why each one matters.

Name for the chat (section 2.5):

Laptop purchase - quotation checklist

Part 3: Screenshot question (Windows)

Session: any chat | **Grounding:** your screenshot

Add a screenshot first (section 2.7), then send:

What does this message mean, and what should I do next?

Part 4: Independent practice

Session: new chat | **Grounding:** web

What is the difference between an "onsite" and a "carry-in" laptop warranty? Why does the difference matter to a company that will issue 25 laptops to new staff? Keep it under 150 words.

03

CHAPTER 3

Write Better Prompts

What Copilot gives you depends on what you give it. In this chapter you use a four-part framework, GCSE, to write the requirements you'll send to the three laptop vendors. Then you improve the answer, check where it came from, and save your best prompt so you can reuse it.

Prompts: every prompt you need is in the steps, with a Copy button. The prompts page has them all on one page too.

Estimated time: 45 minutes

Your result: A short set of laptop requirements, ready to send to vendors, plus a saved prompt and your own custom instructions.

What You Will Learn

- Write a prompt with the four GCSE parts: Goal, Context, Source and Expectations
- Improve a response with follow-up prompts instead of starting again
- Check Copilot's sources before you trust a fact
- Save a prompt in Prompt Gallery
- Set custom instructions and manage what Copilot remembers about you

Before You Begin

You need the Copilot app open with the green shield showing. Start each part in a **new chat** unless the step says otherwise.

3.1 The GCSE Framework

A good prompt usually has four parts. You don't need all four every time, but the more of them you include, the less Copilot has to guess.

Part	The question it answers	Example from today
G: Goal	What do you want Copilot to do?	"Draft the requirements for a laptop quotation request..."

C: Context	Who are you, and what's the situation?	"...for 25 new hires in the Admin and Facilities department of a Malaysian company..."
S: Source	What should Copilot use?	"...based on current business laptop guidance from reputable sources..."
E: Expectations	What should the result look like?	"...as a numbered list under 200 words, in plain English."

With Copilot Chat (Basic), your sources are the public web, the files you upload, and anything you paste into the prompt. Naming the source tells Copilot which to rely on.

3.2 Build the Laptop Requirements Step by Step

You'll send the same request four times, adding one GCSE part each time, and watch the answer change. Use the **same chat** for all four steps.

1. Select **New chat**. Send the Goal only:

Write laptop requirements.

2. Read the answer, then add Context. Send:

Write laptop requirements for 25 new hires in the Admin and Facilities department of a Malaysian company. They use Microsoft 365, Teams video calls and a browser all day, and travel between our Kuala Lumpur and Johor Bahru offices.

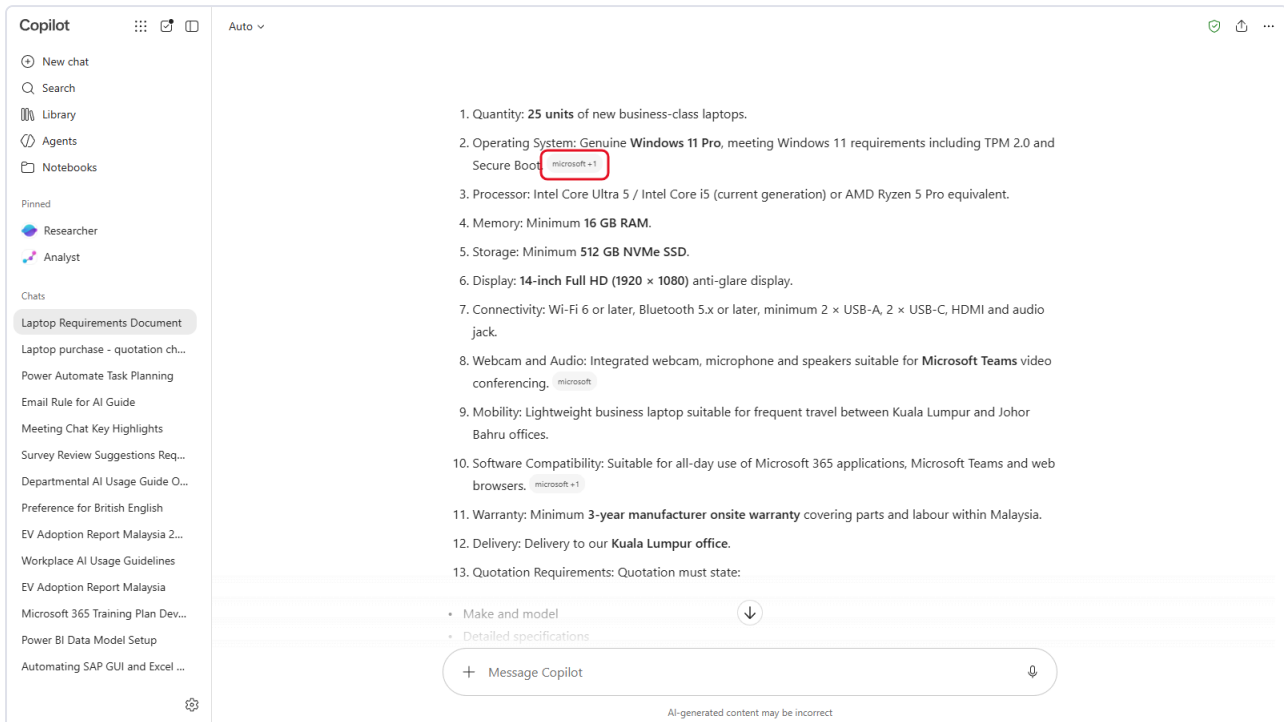
3. Add a Source. Send:

Write laptop requirements for 25 new hires in the Admin and Facilities department of a Malaysian company. They use Microsoft 365, Teams video calls and a browser all day, and travel between our Kuala Lumpur and Johor Bahru offices. Base the specifications on current guidance from reputable sources for business laptops running Windows 11, and show your sources.

4. Add Expectations. Send:

Write laptop requirements for 25 new hires in the Admin and Facilities department of a Malaysian company. They use Microsoft 365, Teams video calls and a browser all day, and travel between our Kuala Lumpur and Johor Bahru offices. Base the specifications on current guidance from reputable sources for business laptops running Windows 11, and show your sources.

Format it as a numbered list I can paste into a request for quotation, under 200 words. Include minimum specifications, a 3-year onsite warranty, delivery to our Kuala Lumpur office, and a reminder that the quotation must show its validity period, tax as a separate line, payment terms and delivery lead time.



The full GCSE prompt gives a list you could almost send as it is.

5. Scroll up and compare the four answers. Then ask Copilot to compare them for you:

Compare the four answers you just gave me. Which is most useful for a request for quotation, and what in my prompt made the difference?

Key point: The fourth prompt is long, and that's fine. A long, clear prompt gets you a usable answer the first time. A short prompt gets you a general answer and several rounds of follow-up.

3.3 Improve the Answer

You don't need to start again when an answer is nearly right. Tell Copilot what to change, in the same chat.

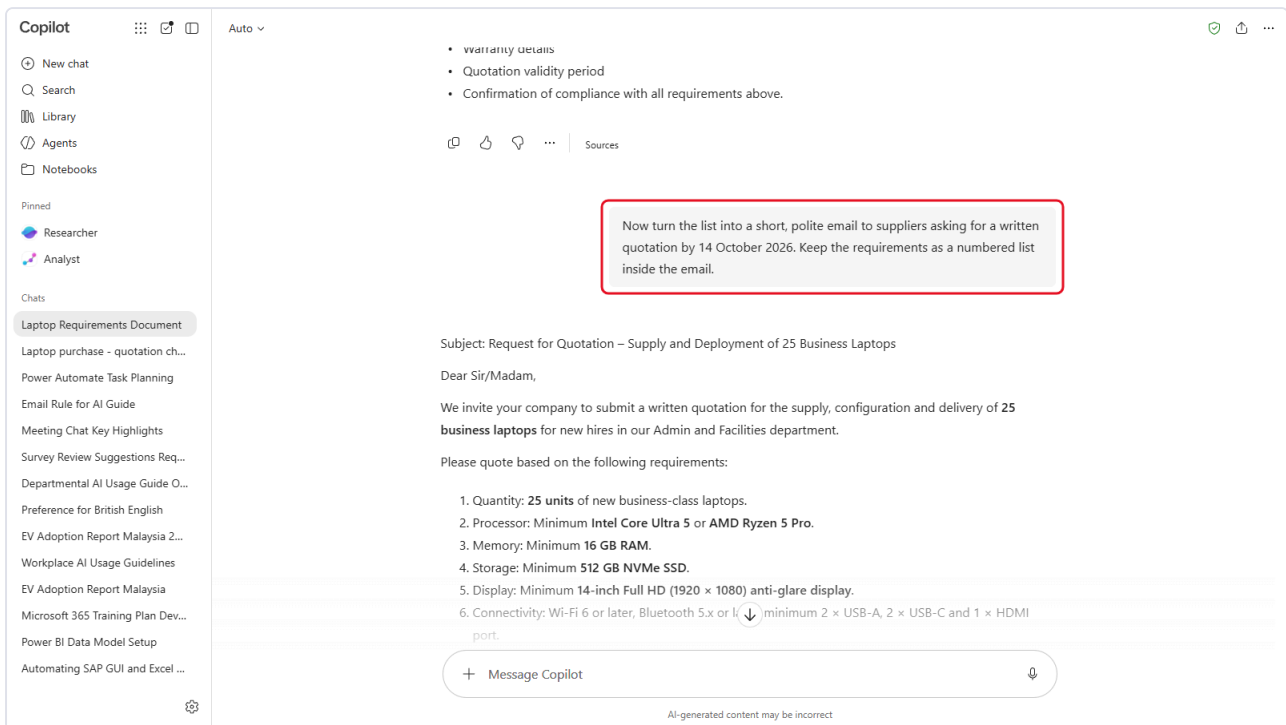
1. Send each of these, one at a time, and watch the list change:

Make the minimum specifications more specific: name the minimum processor class, memory, storage and screen size.

Add a requirement that every laptop comes with a bag, and that the supplier images the laptops with our standard Windows 11 setup before delivery.

Now turn the list into a short, polite email to suppliers asking for a written quotation by [date]. Keep the requirements as a numbered list inside the email.

2. Replace **[date]** in the last prompt with a real date before you send it, or ask Copilot to leave it as a placeholder.



Three follow-ups turned a list into an email you can send. You didn't retype the requirements once.

Tip: Say exactly what to change and what to keep. "Make it better" gives Copilot nothing to work with. "Keep the list, shorten the introduction to one sentence" does.

3.4 Check the Sources

Copilot uses the web to answer, and it shows where its facts came from. A source can be out of date, from a seller, or about another country. Checking takes a minute.

1. Go back to the answer from step 4 in section 3.2.
2. Find the small grey labels at the end of sentences, such as **microsoft +1**. They show which website each fact came from.
3. Select **Sources** under the answer. A **Sources** pane opens on the right, with the pages Copilot used listed under **References**.
4. Select a source to open it in a new tab. Check:
 - **Who wrote it?** A manufacturer selling laptops has a reason to recommend more expensive models.
 - **When?** Laptop advice from three years ago is already out of date.
 - **Does it say what Copilot said?** Find the sentence on the page that supports Copilot's claim.

The screenshot shows the Copilot chat interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation options like 'New chat', 'Search', 'Library', 'Agents', 'Notebooks', 'Pinned', 'Researcher', 'Analyst', and 'Chats'. The main chat area displays a list of requirements (12. Delivery to our Kuala Lumpur office, 13. Quotation Requirements: Quotation must state: Make and model, Detailed specifications, Unit and total price, SST/tax as a separate line item, Payment terms, Delivery lead time, Warranty details, Quotation validity period). Below this is a prompt: 'Compare the four answers you just gave me. Which is most useful for a request for quotation, and what in my prompt made the difference?'. The response states: 'The fourth answer is the most useful for an RFQ.' Below the response is a 'Comparison' table with columns for 'Version', 'Strengths', and 'Weaknesses'. A 'Sources' panel on the right lists citations: 'Windows 11 Specs and System Requirements | Microsoft', 'Windows 11 requirements | Microsoft Learn', 'System requirements for the Teams client - Microsoft', and 'System requirements for Microsoft 365 for business'. A red box highlights the 'Sources' panel, and a red circle with the number 4 is next to it. Another red circle with the number 3 is next to the 'Sources' icon in the chat area.

Sources lists every page behind the answer, with the website under each title.

5. If you find a claim with no source, or a source that doesn't support it, ask:

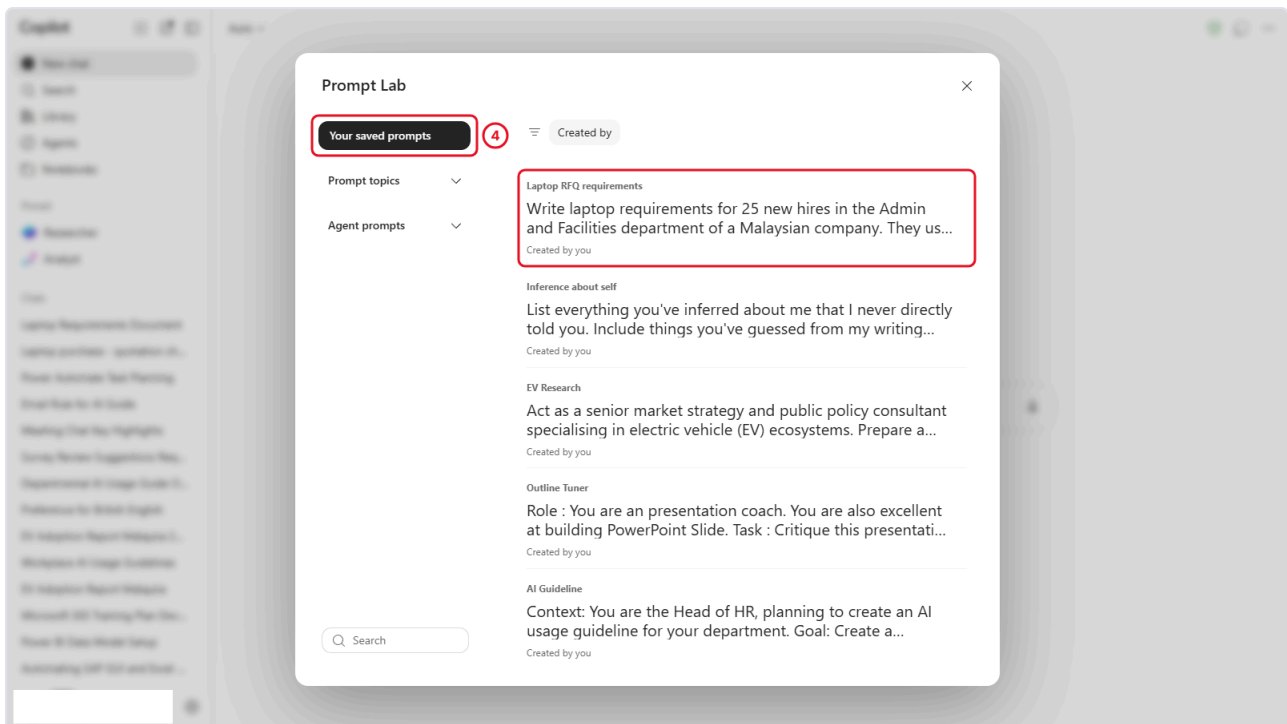
Which of the requirements in your list are not supported by one of your sources? Mark them clearly.

Key point: A source makes an answer easier to check. It doesn't make the answer correct. You're responsible for anything you send to a supplier or your HOD.

3.5 Save a Prompt in Prompt Gallery

Prompt Gallery holds ready-made prompts from Microsoft and prompts you save yourself. Save the full GCSE prompt so you can reuse it for the next purchase.

1. In your chat, point at your full GCSE prompt from step 4 in 3.2. Buttons appear beside it.
2. Select **Save prompt**, give it a title such as `Laptop RFQ requirements`, and save it.
3. Select **New chat**, then **Open prompt gallery** (beside the suggestion buttons under the empty message box). The gallery opens as **Prompt Lab**.
4. Select **Your saved prompts**. Your prompt is listed there.
5. Open **Prompt topics** to browse Microsoft's ready-made prompts. Select one to see how it's written.



Your saved prompts are listed first. Microsoft's examples are under Prompt topics.

If you don't see this: If there's no save option beside your prompt, copy the prompt into a note instead (OneNote or a Word document). Prompt Gallery may look different in your organisation, or saving may still be rolling out.

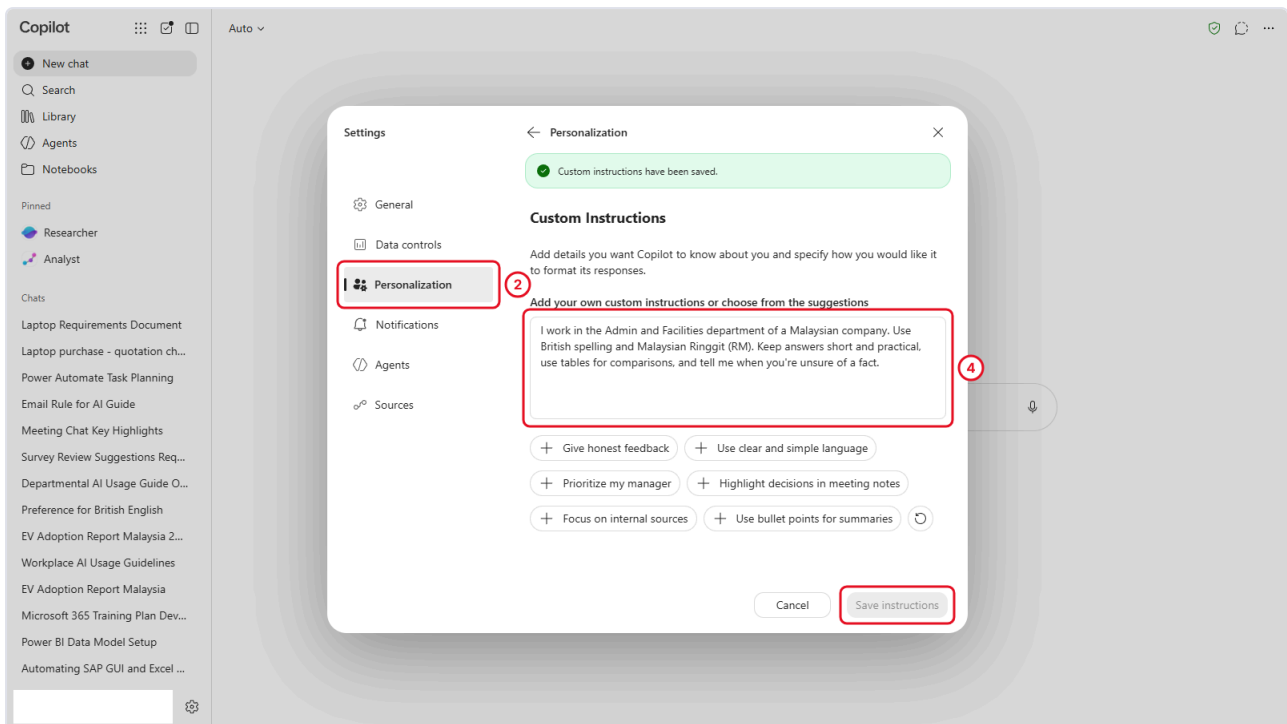
3.6 Custom Instructions and Memory

You've typed "I work in Admin and Facilities at a Malaysian company" several times now. Custom instructions tell Copilot that once, and it applies them to every new chat.

Set custom instructions

1. At the bottom of the left pane, select **Settings and more** (the gear), then **Settings**.
2. Select **Personalization**.
3. Under custom instructions, select **Edit instructions**.
4. Paste the text below into the box, change it to fit you, and select **Save instructions**.

I work in the Admin and Facilities department of a Malaysian company. Use British spelling and Malaysian Ringgit (RM). Keep answers short and practical, use tables for comparisons, and tell me when you're unsure of a fact.



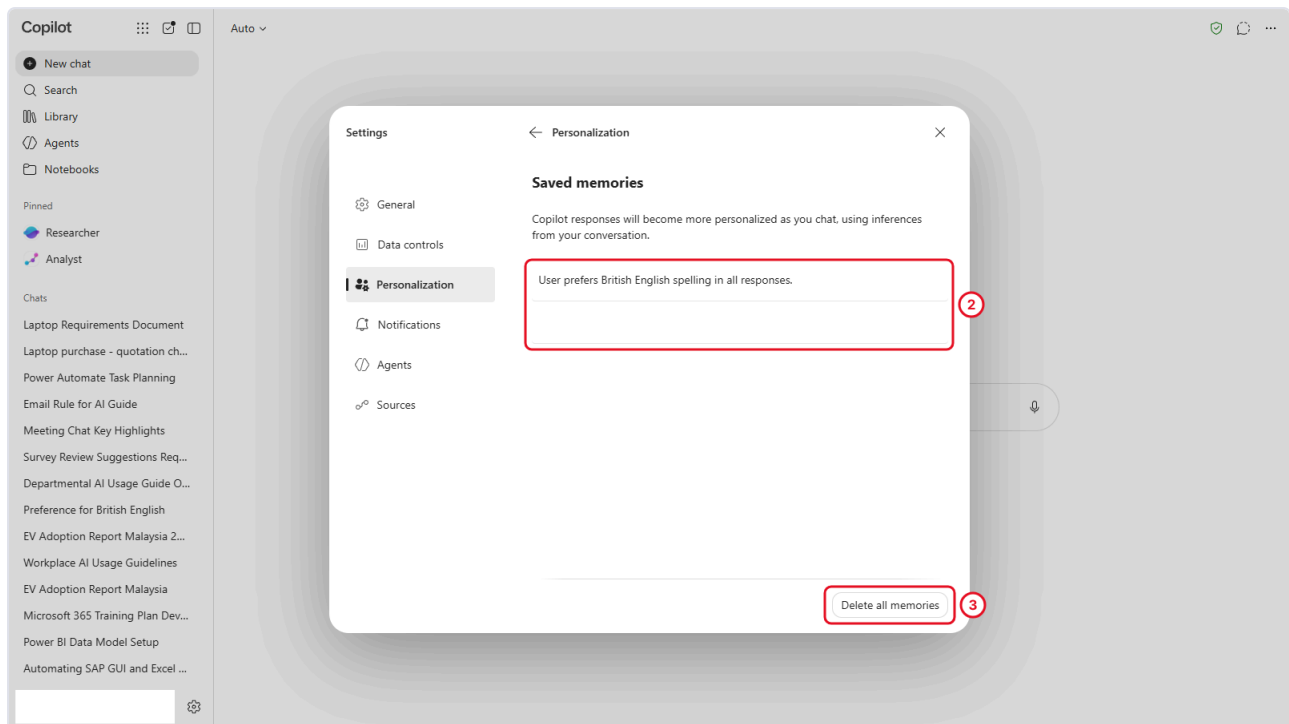
The green message confirms they're saved. Custom instructions apply to new chats, not to chats you've already started.

5. Select **New chat** and send `What spelling and currency will you use when you answer me?` to test it.

Memory

Copilot can also remember facts from your chats, such as your role or preferences, and use them later. It usually asks before it saves a memory.

1. Go back to **Settings > Personalization**. The **Saved memories** switch turns memory on or off. Leave it as your trainer asks.
2. Open **Saved memories** to see what Copilot has remembered, if anything.
3. Point at a memory to delete just that one, or select **Delete all memories** at the bottom.



You can see and delete everything Copilot has remembered about you.

Important: Don't ask Copilot to remember anything confidential, such as budget figures, staff names or passwords. Memory is for preferences and your role, not for data.

If you don't see this: Your admin may have turned memory or custom instructions off. If **Personalization** isn't in Settings, carry on: you can put the same text at the start of a prompt instead.

Independent Practice

Write a GCSE prompt of your own for the next small purchase your department makes, such as office chairs or a projector. Label each part (G, C, S, E) in your head as you write it. Ask the person next to you to spot which part is missing.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
The answer ignores part of a long prompt	Put each requirement on its own line, or ask "Did you include all the requirements I listed?"
No sources are shown	Ask "Show your sources." Some answers come from Copilot's general knowledge and have none
A source link opens an unrelated page	The source may have changed. Treat that fact as unchecked

Custom instructions aren't applied

They only affect new chats. Select **New chat**

The response stops halfway

Standard access is busy. Wait a minute and send it again

Lesson Summary

GCSE gave you a way to write a prompt that works the first time. You improved the answer with specific follow-ups, checked its sources, and saved your prompt and your preferences so you don't repeat yourself. Next, the quotations arrive, and you use Copilot to compare them against your company's policy.

Check yourself: Can you name the four GCSE parts, and explain why a source doesn't make an answer correct?

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Practise the **GCSE framework** (Goal, Context, Source, Expectations) on the laptop requirements. Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner.

Part 1: Building a GCSE prompt

Session: new chat, then the same chat for all four steps | **Grounding:** web

Send each step in order and compare the answers.

Step 1: Goal only

Write laptop requirements.

Step 2: add Context

Write laptop requirements for 25 new hires in the Admin and Facilities department of a Malaysian company. They use Microsoft 365, Teams video calls and a browser all day, and travel between our Kuala Lumpur and Johor Bahru offices.

Step 3: add Source

Write laptop requirements for 25 new hires in the Admin and Facilities department of a Malaysian company. They use Microsoft 365, Teams video calls and a browser all day, and travel between our Kuala Lumpur and Johor Bahru offices. Base the specifications on current guidance from reputable sources for business laptops running Windows 11, and show your sources.

Step 4: add Expectations

Write laptop requirements for 25 new hires in the Admin and Facilities department of a Malaysian company. They use Microsoft 365, Teams video calls and a browser all day, and travel between our Kuala Lumpur and Johor Bahru offices. Base the specifications on current guidance from reputable sources for business laptops running Windows 11, and show your sources.

Format it as a numbered list I can paste into a request for quotation, under 200 words. Include minimum specifications, a 3-year onsite warranty, delivery to our Kuala Lumpur office, and a reminder that the quotation must show its validity period, tax as a separate line, payment terms and delivery lead time.

Then compare:

Compare the four answers you just gave me. Which is most useful for a request for quotation, and what in my prompt made the difference?

Part 2: Iterating on the requirements

Session: same chat | **Grounding:** web

Make the minimum specifications more specific: name the minimum processor class, memory, storage and screen size.

Add a requirement that every laptop comes with a bag, and that the supplier images the laptops with our standard Windows 11 setup before delivery.

Replace [date] before you send this one:

Now turn the list into a short, polite email to suppliers asking for a written quotation by [date]. Keep the requirements as a numbered list inside the email.

Part 3: Checking sources

Session: same chat | **Grounding:** web

Which of the requirements in your list are not supported by one of your sources? Mark them clearly.

For each source you used, tell me who published it and when. Flag any source that sells laptops.

Part 4: Custom instructions

Session: Settings > Personalization | **Grounding:** none

Change this to fit you before you save it:

I work in the Admin and Facilities department of a Malaysian company. Use British spelling and Malaysian Ringgit (RM). Keep answers short and practical, use tables for comparisons, and tell me when you're unsure of a fact.

Test it in a new chat:

What spelling and currency will you use when you answer me?

Part 5: Weak prompts to rewrite

Session: new chat | **Grounding:** web

Each of these is missing GCSE parts. Rewrite it for your own work before you send it, then send both versions and compare.

Write an email to a supplier.

Compare these.

Summarise the policy.

Make a memo.

04

CHAPTER 4

Compare the Quotations

The three quotations have arrived. Before the HOD can sign off, policy says you need a written comparison and a justification memo. In this chapter you upload the quotations and the procurement policy, ask Copilot to build the comparison, and then do the part that matters most: check its work. Each quotation has a problem. Your job is to find all three.

Prompts: every prompt you need is in the steps, with a Copy button. The prompts page has them all on one page too.

Estimated time: 60 minutes

Your result: A checked comparison table of the three quotations, a list of problems to chase, and a recommendation you can defend.

What You Will Learn

- Upload several files to one chat and ask questions across them
- Turn three quotations into one comparison table
- Check Copilot's arithmetic instead of trusting it
- Check documents against a policy, including dates
- Spot when a comparison isn't like-for-like, and adjust it
- Ask for a recommendation with reasons

Before You Begin

You need:

- the green shield showing in the Copilot app (section 1.3)
- the four sample files, which you download in 4.1
- a calculator (the one on your computer or phone is fine)

File	What it is
quotation-pinnacle-komputer.pdf	Vendor A, Pinnacle Komputer Sdn Bhd, Petaling Jaya
quotation-seri-mutiara.pdf	Vendor B, Seri Mutiara Technology Sdn Bhd, Shah Alam

quotation-cyberjaya-digital.pdf

Vendor C, Cyberjaya Digital Supplies Sdn Bhd, Cyberjaya

procurement-policy.pdf

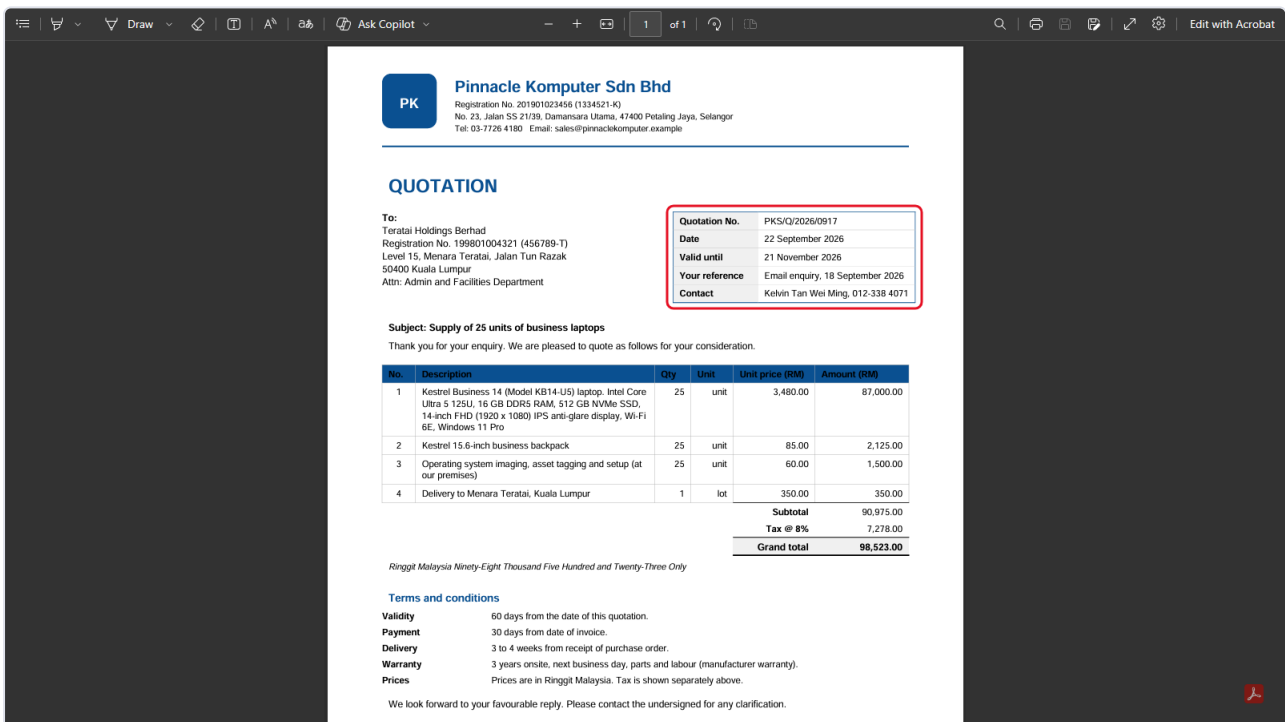
A two-page extract from Teratai Holdings' procurement policy

Note: Some screenshots in this chapter are blurred where they would give away the answers. Finding the problems yourself is the point of the lab.

Note: Every company, person and number in these files is fictional. The tax rate is for training only. Never practise with real supplier quotations: they can contain prices and terms your company has agreed to keep confidential.

4.1 Download the Sample Files

1. Download [sample-files.zip](#) (one click, all four files).
2. Open your Downloads folder, right-click the ZIP and choose **Extract All**, then **Extract**.
3. Open one quotation and have a quick look. You'll find a letterhead, a quotation number, a date, a validity period, line items, a tax line, a grand total and the terms. That's what Copilot is about to read.



A typical quotation. Copilot reads the text in the PDF, including the small print in the terms.

4.2 Start a New Chat and Upload the Files

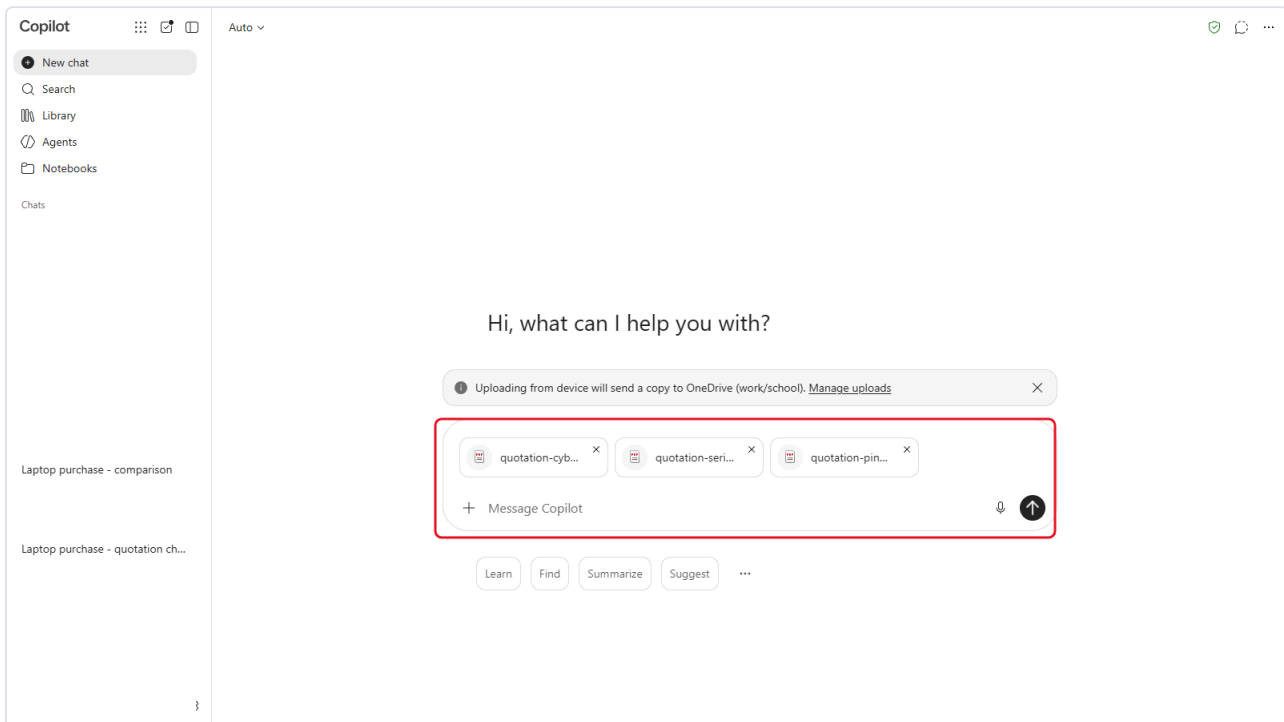
1. In the Copilot app, select **New chat**. Check the green shield.
Copilot takes at most three files in one message, so the policy goes first, on its own.
2. In the message box, select **+**, then **Upload images and files**. Go to the extracted folder, select [procurement-policy.pdf](#) and select **Open**.

3. Wait for the upload to finish, then send this message with it:

Here's our procurement policy. Confirm in one sentence that you've read it, then wait for the quotations.

4. Select + > **Upload images and files** again. Select the three quotations at once: click the first, then hold **Ctrl** and click the other two. Select **Open**.

5. Wait until each file shows in the message box without a progress circle. Don't send anything yet: the prompt for these files is in 4.3.



Three quotations attached, ready for the prompt in 4.3. The policy is already in the chat from your first message.

Note: You may see a notice that uploading from your device saves a copy to your OneDrive. That's normal: the files stay in your organisation's storage.

Important: Upload all four files in the **same chat**. Copilot can only compare files that are in the conversation it's working in. A quotation you uploaded in a different chat is invisible to this one.

If you don't see this: If Copilot refuses a file, check you've attached no more than three to one message. If upload is greyed out or missing, your admin may have turned it off, or standard access may be limiting uploads at a busy time. Wait a few minutes and try again, or tell your trainer.

4.3 Summarise Each Quotation

Start with a summary of each file. It shows you whether Copilot read every file before you ask it to compare them.

1. With the four files attached, paste the prompt below and send it.

I've uploaded three laptop quotations and an extract from our procurement policy. For each quotation, give me the vendor name, quotation number, date, validity, grand total, warranty and delivery lead time. Then tell me in one sentence what the policy extract covers. Use four short bullets: one per vendor and one for the policy.

2. Check that all three vendors and the policy appear in the answer. If one is missing, say so: You missed the Seri Mutiara quotation. Please include it.

The screenshot shows the Copilot chat interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation options like 'New chat', 'Search', 'Library', 'Agents', 'Notebooks', and a list of chats including 'Laptop Requirements Document'. The main chat area shows a user prompt (highlighted in the previous blocks) and a response from Copilot. The response consists of four bullet points summarizing three quotations and a policy extract. At the bottom of the chat area is a text input field with a plus icon and the text 'Message Copilot', and a small disclaimer: 'AI-generated content may be incorrect'.

Copilot Auto ▾

I've uploaded three laptop quotations and an extract from our procurement policy. For each quotation, give me the vendor name, quotation number, date, validity, grand total, warranty and delivery lead time. Then tell me in one sentence what the policy extract covers. Use four compact bullets, one per vendor and one policy sentence.

- Pinnacle Komputer Sdn Bhd | Quotation No: PKS/Q/2026/0917 | Date: 22 September 2026 | Validity: Valid until 21 November 2026 (60 days) | Grand Total: RM98,523.00 | Warranty: 3 years onsite, next business day, parts and labour | Delivery: 3 to 4 weeks from receipt of purchase order.
- Seri Mutiara Technology Sdn Bhd | Quotation No: SMT-QT-26-0388 | Date: 4 August 2026 | Validity: Valid until 3 September 2026 (30 days) | Grand Total: RM94,905.00 | Warranty: 3 years onsite, next business day | Delivery: 2 to 3 weeks from receipt of purchase order, subject to stock availability.
- Cyberjaya Digital Supplies Sdn Bhd | Quotation No: CDS/2026/Q-1142 | Date: 25 September 2026 | Validity: Valid until 9 November 2026 (45 days) | Grand Total: RM87,885.00 | Warranty: 1 year carry-in, parts and labour (3-year onsite upgrade available separately) | Delivery: 3 weeks from receipt of purchase order.
- Policy extract: procurement-policy covers procurement approval thresholds, quotation validity and content requirements, quotation comparison rules (including minimum 3-year IT warranties), justification memo requirements, and record-retention requirements for purchases.

+ Message Copilot

AI-generated content may be incorrect

If a file is missing from the summary, Copilot didn't read it. Fix that before you go on.

4.4 Build the Comparison Table

1. In the same chat, send:

Build a side-by-side comparison table of the three quotations. Use one column per vendor and these rows: laptop model, processor, memory, storage, screen, unit price, bag, imaging and setup, delivery charge, subtotal, tax, grand total, warranty, delivery lead time, payment terms, validity. Use RM and show the figures exactly as printed in each quotation.

2. Read the table, row by row.

Copilot

Auto

Item	Pinnacle Komputer	Seri Mutiara Technology	Cyberjaya Digital Supplies
Laptop	Kestrel Business 14 (KB14-U5)	Halcyon WorkBook 14	Meranti Pro 14
Processor	Intel Core Ultra 5 125U	Intel Core Ultra 5 125U	Intel Core Ultra 5 135U
Memory	16 GB DDR5 RAM	16 GB DDR5 RAM	16 GB LPDDR5 RAM
Storage	512 GB NVMe SSD	512 GB NVMe SSD	512 GB NVMe SSD
Screen	14" FHD (1920×1080) IPS anti-glare	14" WUXGA (1920×1200) anti-glare	14" FHD+ (1920×1200)
Unit Price	RM3,480.00	RM3,390.00	RM3,150.00
Bag	RM2,125.00 (backpack)	RM1,750.00 (backpack)	RM1,125.00 (padded sleeve)
Imaging & Setup	RM1,500.00	RM1,375.00	RM1,250.00
Delivery Charge	RM350.00	RM0.00 (complimentary)	RM250.00
Subtotal	RM90,975.00	RM87,875.00	RM81,375.00
Tax	RM7,278.00	RM7,030.00	RM6,510.00
Grand	RM98,523.00	↓ 94,905.00	RM87,885.00

+ Message Copilot

AI-generated content may be incorrect

A clean table. It looks finished, which is exactly why you check it next.

Key point: "Exactly as printed" matters. You want the table to show what each vendor wrote, mistakes included, so you can check it. If Copilot quietly fixes a figure, you lose the evidence.

4.5 Check the Arithmetic

Copilot is good with words and less reliable with sums. It often copies a total from a document without checking whether it adds up.

1. Ask Copilot to check the numbers:

For each quotation, recalculate every line amount (quantity x unit price), the subtotal, the tax and the grand total. Show your working in a table, and compare your grand total with the grand total printed in the quotation. Tell me about any difference, however small.

2. Now check it yourself. Open one quotation and use your calculator:

- add the line amounts and compare with the **Subtotal**
- add the **Subtotal** and the **Tax** and compare with the **Grand total**

3. Do the same for the other two quotations. It takes about two minutes each.

Grand Total Verification Summary

Vendor	Printed Grand Total (RM)	Calculated Grand Total (RM)	Difference (RM)
Pinnacle Komputer Sdn Bhd	RM98,523.00	RM87,000.00	RM11,523.00
Seri Mutiara Technology Sdn Bhd	RM94,905.00	RM94,905.00	RM0.00
Cyberjaya Digital Supplies Sdn Bhd	RM87,885.00	RM87,885.00	RM0.00

Pinnacle Subtotal Plus Tax Working

Item	Working	Amount (RM)
Laptops	25 × RM3,480.00	RM87,000.00
Backpacks	25 × RM85.00	RM2,125.00
Imaging, asset tagging & setup	25 × RM60.00	RM1,500.00
Delivery	1 × RM350.00	RM350.00
Subtotal		RM91,075.00
Tax @		RM5,925.00
Calculated Grand Total		RM97,000.00

AI-generated content may be incorrect

Copilot shows its working. You still check at least the grand totals yourself.

Warning: Don't skip step 2 because Copilot says the numbers are fine. Copilot can make the same mistake the vendor made, or agree with the printed figure. If your calculator and Copilot disagree, trust your calculator, then ask Copilot to explain the difference.

Checkpoint: Did you find a total that doesn't add up? Note which vendor it is, the printed figure, and the correct figure.

4.6 Check the Quotations Against the Policy

Section 5 of the policy lists what a valid quotation must show. One of the rules is about dates, and Copilot doesn't always know today's date, so you tell it.

1. Replace [today's date] with today's date (for example, 14 October 2026), then send:

Today's date is [today's date]. Check each quotation against Section 5 of the procurement policy, "What a valid quotation must show". Make a table with one row per requirement and one column per vendor. Mark each cell Yes, No or Unclear, and quote the words from the quotation that support your answer. Pay particular attention to whether each quotation is still valid today.

2. Read the **No** and **Unclear** cells. Open the quotation and find the words Copilot quoted. Are they really there?

Section 5 Requirement			
Pinnacle Komputer			
Seri Mutiara Technology			
Cyberjaya Digital Supplies			
Still valid on 14 Oct 2026			
Registered name & company registration no.	Yes - "PK Pinnacle Komputer Sdn Bhd... 201901023456"	Yes - "SM Seri Mutiara Technology Sdn Bhd... 201201017734"	Yes - "CD Cyberjaya Digital Supplies Sdn Bhd... 201601039902"
Quotation number & date	Yes - "PKS/Q/2026/0917" / "22 September 2026"	Yes - "SMT-QT-26-0388" / "4 August 2026"	Yes - "CDS/2026/Q-1142" / "25 September 2026"
Validity period or expiry date	Yes - "Valid until 21 November 2026"	Yes - "Valid until 3 September 2026"	Yes - "Valid until 9 November 2026"
Item descriptions with qty, unit price & line amount	Yes - "Qty... Unit price (RM)... Amount (RM)"	Yes - "Qty... Unit price (RM)... Amount (RM)"	Yes - "Qty... Unit price (RM)... Amount (RM)"
Subtotal shown	Yes - "Subtotal 90,975.00"	Yes - "Subtotal 87,875.00"	Yes - "Subtotal 81,375.00"
Tax shown separately	Yes - "Tax @ 8% 7,278.00"	Yes - "Tax @ 8% 7,030.00"	Yes - "Tax @ 8% 6,510.00"
Grand total shown	Yes - "Grand total 98,523.00"	Yes - "Grand total 94,905.00"	Yes - "Grand total 87,885.00"
Payment terms	Yes - "30 days from date"	Yes - "30 days from date"	Yes - "30 days from d...

A No or an Unclear is a question to answer, not a verdict. Open the PDF and look.

Checkpoint: Did you find a quotation that can't be used as it is today? Which section of the policy says so?

Tip: Copilot quotes words from the document when you ask it to. That's the fastest way to check a claim: search the PDF for the quoted words (Ctrl+F).

4.7 Is It Like-for-Like?

The policy says quotations must be compared like-for-like (Section 6). Look at your comparison table again. One vendor looks cheapest. Is it offering the same thing as the others?

1. Send:

Are these three quotations like-for-like, according to Section 6 of the policy? List every difference in what is being offered, apart from price. For each difference, say whether it changes the comparison.

2. If Copilot finds a difference the policy says to adjust for, ask it to adjust using a price the vendor has written in its own quotation:

Adjust the comparison so all three quotations are like-for-like, using only prices the vendors have stated in writing in their quotations. Show the adjusted totals, including tax, and explain each adjustment.

3. Check the adjusted total with your calculator.

Adjusted Totals (Like-for-Like)

Vendor	Original Grand Total (RM)	Adjustment incl. Tax (RM)	Adjusted Grand Total (RM)
Pinnacle Komputer Sdn Bhd	RM98,523.00		
Seri Mutiara Technology Sdn Bhd	RM94,905.00		
Cyberjaya Digital Supplies Sdn Bhd	RM87,885.00		

Warranty Difference and Adjustment Calculation

Item	Pinnacle	Seri Mutiara	Cyberjaya
Quoted Warranty			
Policy Requirement			

+ Message Copilot

AI-generated content may be incorrect

The cheapest quotation isn't always the cheapest once you compare the same thing.

Checkpoint: Which vendor's position changed after the adjustment, and why?

4.8 Ask for a Recommendation

You now know the problems. Ask Copilot to put it together, then decide whether you agree.

1. Send:

Based on the checked figures, the policy check and the like-for-like adjustment, which vendor would you recommend, and why? List what must happen before the HOD can approve this purchase, for example any quotation that needs to be corrected or revalidated by the vendor. Say which approval the policy requires for this amount.

2. Read the recommendation. Do you agree? If not, tell Copilot why and ask it to reconsider.

3. Rename the chat `Laptop purchase - comparison`. **Don't delete it.** You use it again in Chapter 6.

The screenshot shows the Copilot chat interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation options: New chat, Search, Library, Agents, Notebooks, Pinned (Researcher, Analyst), and Chats. The Chats section is expanded, showing a list of recent chats including 'Laptop purchase - comparison', 'Laptop purchase - quotation ch...', 'Power Automate Task Planning', 'Email Rule for AI Guide', 'Meeting Chat Key Highlights', 'Survey Review Suggestions Req...', 'Departmental AI Usage Guide O...', 'Preference for British English', 'EV Adoption Report Malaysia 2...', 'Workplace AI Usage Guidelines', 'EV Adoption Report Malaysia', 'Microsoft 365 Training Plan Dev...', 'Power BI Data Model Setup', and 'Automating SAP GUI and Excel ...'. The main chat area displays a recommendation from Copilot, which is partially redacted. The recommendation includes a list of actions required before approval: 1. Cyberjaya: so the war, 2. Pinnacle: Section 6.4, and 3. Seri Mutia: remain in t. Below the actions, a required approval note states: 'The recommended purchase value is approximately RM95,445.00 including tax, which falls above RM20,000 and up to RM100,000. The policy therefore requires three written quotations, a comparison, a justification memo, and HOD approval.' At the bottom of the chat area, there are three suggested actions: 'Draft the HOD approval memo', 'Create a three-quotation checklist', and 'Summarize the procurement file gaps'. A message input field at the bottom says '+ Message Copilot'.

A recommendation with conditions. Chasing those conditions is the next chapter.

Key point: Copilot recommends. You decide. Your name goes on the memo, so you need to be able to explain every number in it without Copilot.

Check Your Findings

Your trainer will go through the answers with the class. Before that, check your list:

- You found **three problems, one for each vendor**: one about the numbers, one about dates, and one about what's included.
- For each problem, you can name the section of the policy that applies.
- You can say what each vendor must do to fix its problem (and that it's the vendor's job to fix it, not yours).

Independent Practice

Ask Copilot one question about the quotations that you can check in under a minute, such as "Which vendor offers the shortest delivery time?" Then check it in the PDFs. Did Copilot get it right?

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
Copilot only talks about one or two quotations	Not every file uploaded. Check the files in your first message, and upload the missing one in the same chat

Copilot refuses some of your files	It takes at most three files per message. Send the extra file in its own message in the same chat
Copilot says it can't see the files	You started a new chat. Go back to the chat where you uploaded them, or upload them again
The table has figures that aren't in any quotation	Ask "Where in the quotation did you find this figure? Quote it." Remove anything it can't quote
Copilot says every quotation is valid	Check you gave it today's date in 4.6
The upload button is missing or greyed out	Your admin may have turned off upload, or uploads may be limited at busy times. Tell your trainer
An answer stops halfway	Standard access is busy. Wait a minute and send it again

Lesson Summary

Copilot read three quotations and a policy in seconds and built a comparison that would take you an hour by hand. It also missed things, or got them wrong, until you asked the right questions and checked the numbers yourself. That's the habit to take away: let Copilot do the reading and the layout, and keep the checking for yourself. Next, you use Copilot in Outlook to chase the vendors whose quotations need fixing.

Check yourself: Can you explain why all four files must be in the same chat, and why "exactly as printed" matters in a comparison?

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Compare the three laptop quotations against the procurement policy. Upload all four files from [sample-files.zip](#) to **one chat** before you start. Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner.

Session guide: every part runs in the **same chat**, the one you uploaded the files to. Starting a new chat loses the files.

Part 1: First look at the quotations

Session: new chat | **Grounding:** uploaded files

Send this with `procurement-policy.pdf` attached:

Here's our procurement policy. Confirm in one sentence that you've read it, then wait for the quotations.

Then send this with the three quotations attached:

I've uploaded three laptop quotations and an extract from our procurement policy. For each quotation, give me the vendor name, quotation number, date, validity, grand total, warranty and delivery lead time. Then tell me in one sentence what the policy extract covers. Use four short bullets: one per vendor and one for the policy.

If a file is missing from the answer:

You missed one of the quotations. Please read all three and include it.

Part 2: The comparison table

Session: same chat | **Grounding:** uploaded files

Build a side-by-side comparison table of the three quotations. Use one column per vendor and these rows: laptop model, processor, memory, storage, screen, unit price, bag, imaging and setup, delivery charge, subtotal, tax, grand total, warranty, delivery lead time, payment terms, validity. Use RM and show the figures exactly as printed in each quotation.

Part 3: Checking the numbers

Session: same chat | **Grounding:** uploaded files

For each quotation, recalculate every line amount (quantity x unit price), the subtotal, the tax and the grand total. Show your working in a table, and compare your grand total with the grand total printed in the quotation. Tell me about any difference, however small.

When Copilot's figure and yours disagree:

My calculator gives a different figure for this total. Show me your working step by step, and tell me which figure is correct.

Part 4: Checking against the policy

Session: same chat | **Grounding:** uploaded files

Replace [today's date] first.

Today's date is [today's date]. Check each quotation against Section 5 of the procurement policy, "What a valid quotation must show". Make a table with one row per requirement and one column per vendor. Mark each cell Yes, No or Unclear, and quote the words from the quotation that support your answer. Pay particular attention to whether each quotation is still valid today.

Are these three quotations like-for-like, according to Section 6 of the policy? List every difference in what is being offered, apart from price. For each difference, say whether it changes the comparison.

Adjust the comparison so all three quotations are like-for-like, using only prices the vendors have stated in writing in their quotations. Show the adjusted totals, including tax, and explain each adjustment.

To check any claim:

Where in the quotation did you find that? Quote the exact words.

Part 5: Recommendation

Session: same chat | **Grounding:** uploaded files

Based on the checked figures, the policy check and the like-for-like adjustment, which vendor would you recommend, and why? List what must happen before the HOD can approve this purchase, for example any quotation that needs to be corrected or revalidated by the vendor. Say which approval the policy requires for this amount.

Name for the chat:

Laptop purchase - comparison

Part 6: Independent practice

Session: same chat | **Grounding:** uploaded files

Check the answer in the PDFs yourself.

Which vendor offers the shortest delivery lead time, and what condition, if any, is attached to it?

05

CHAPTER 5

Chase Vendors with Copilot in Outlook

Your comparison left you with things to chase: one quotation needs a corrected total, one needs to be revalidated, and one vendor has written about warranty options. Those conversations happen in email. Copilot in Outlook is included with both Basic labels, and it can summarise a thread, answer questions about an email, and draft your replies.

Prompts: every prompt and email you need is in the steps, with a Copy button. The prompts page has them all on one page too.

Estimated time: 45 minutes

Your result: Three vendor emails in your inbox, a summary of one thread, and two reply drafts: a request for a revalidated quotation and a request to correct a total.

What You Will Learn

- Find Copilot in Outlook on the web and in the new Outlook for Windows
- Summarise an email thread
- Ask Copilot questions about an email, and notice what it can and can't see
- Draft a reply with Copilot, then adjust its tone and length
- Check a draft before you send it

Before You Begin

You need:

- Outlook on the web (outlook.office.com) or the new Outlook for Windows, signed in with your work account
- your findings from Chapter 4: which vendor's total is wrong, the printed and correct figures, and which quotation has expired

Note: You need vendor emails in your inbox to practise with. In 5.1 you send them to yourself, so nothing goes outside your mailbox. Every subject starts with [CCB TRAINING] so they're easy to find and delete after the course.

Note: Classic Outlook for Windows (the older desktop app) shows Copilot in different places, and some options may be missing. Use Outlook on the web for this chapter so your screen matches the pictures.

5.1 Send the Vendor Emails to Yourself

You create four emails: one each from the three vendors, and a follow-up from Seri Mutiara that forms a thread. The vendor's name is in each signature.

Email 1: Seri Mutiara Technology

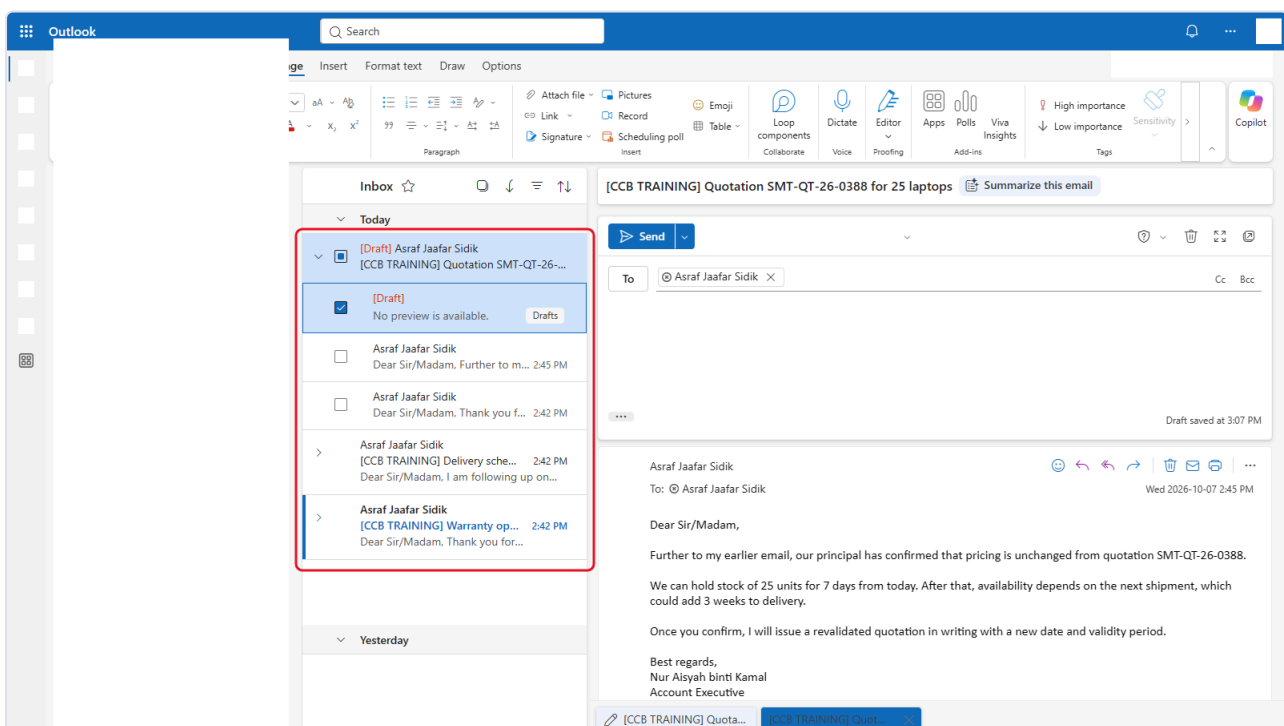
1. In Outlook, select **New mail** (it may just say **New**).
2. In **To**, type your own email address.
3. Copy the subject and body for **Email 1** from the prompts page and paste them in.
4. Select **Send**.

Emails 2 and 3: Cyberjaya Digital and Pinnacle Komputer

5. Repeat steps 1 to 4 for **Email 2** and **Email 3**.

Email 4: the Seri Mutiara follow-up (a reply, to make a thread)

6. Wait for **Email 1** to arrive in your Inbox, then open it.
7. Select **Reply**. Leave the subject as it is.
8. Paste the body for **Email 4** at the top of the reply, above the original message. Select **Send**.



The two Seri Mutiara messages appear as one conversation. That's the thread you summarise in 5.3.

Checkpoint: You have three conversations in your Inbox, and the Seri Mutiara one has two messages.

Tip: The emails come from you, so Outlook shows your name as the sender. Copilot reads the signature to work out who the vendor is. If it gets confused, add "The vendor is the person who signs each email" to your prompt.

5.2 Find Copilot in Outlook

Copilot shows up in two places in Outlook.

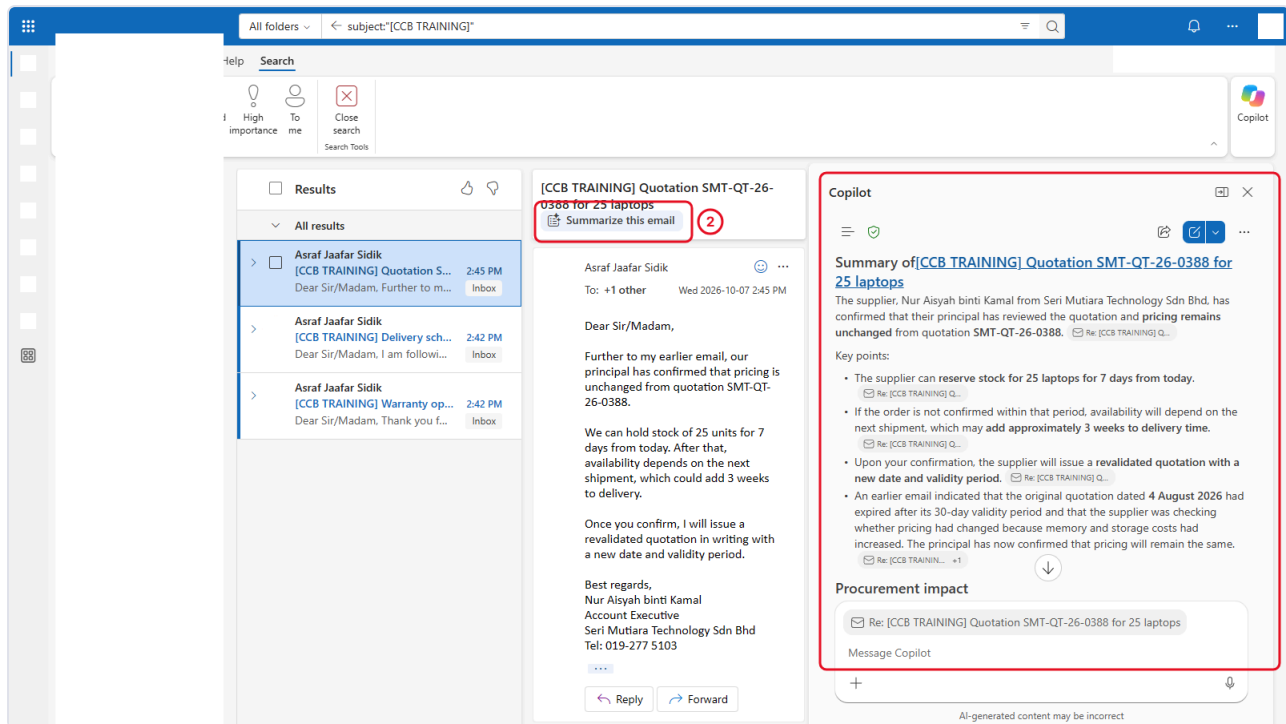
1. **On an open email: Summarize this email**, just above the message. You use it in 5.3.
2. **The Copilot pane:** the **Copilot** button at the right end of the ribbon opens a chat pane beside your mail. It works with the email you have open. You use it in 5.4 to 5.6.

Note: With the paid license, Outlook also offers **Draft with Copilot** when you write an email. With Basic you draft in the Copilot pane instead, then copy the text into your reply.

If you don't see this: Copilot in Outlook can take time to appear for a new account, and your admin can turn it off. If you can't find any of the three, check you're in Outlook on the web with your work account, then tell your trainer. If Copilot shows but doesn't respond, standard access may be busy: wait a minute and try again.

5.3 Summarise a Vendor Thread

1. Open the Seri Mutiara conversation (subject **[CCB TRAINING] Quotation SMT-QT-26-0388 for 25 laptops**).
2. Select **Summarize this email** above the message. The Copilot pane opens on the right with a summary of the whole conversation.
3. Read the summary. Check one thing in particular: does it give the vendor's **latest** position? The first email said prices may have changed. The follow-up says something different.



A summary of the whole conversation. Check that it reflects the latest message.

Key point: Summaries can give equal weight to an early message and a later one that replaced it. When a thread changes its mind, check the summary against the most recent email.

5.4 Ask Questions About Your Email

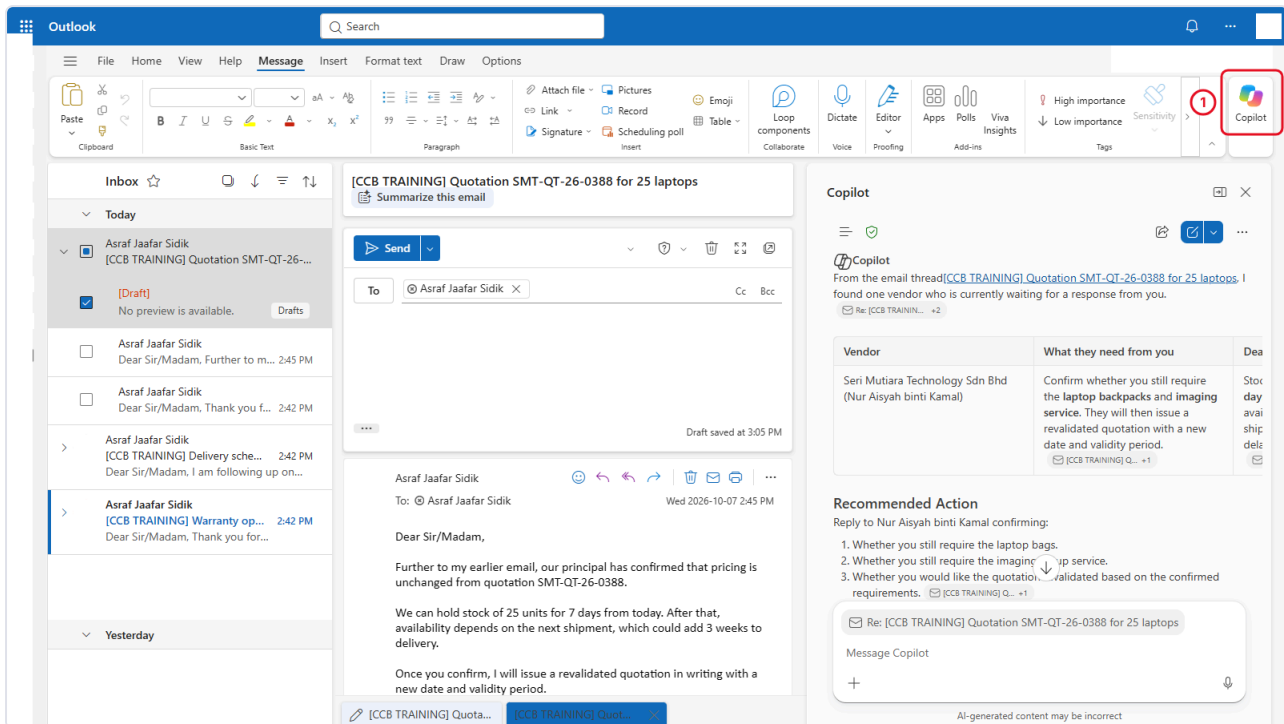
Ask Copilot what a vendor needs from you. With Basic, the Copilot pane works with the email you have open, so open the right conversation first.

1. Open the Seri Mutiara conversation and select the **Copilot** button to open the pane.
2. Paste this prompt and send it:

Look at my emails with [CCB TRAINING] in the subject. Which vendors are waiting for a reply from me, and what does each one need from me? Put it in a table with the vendor, what they asked, and any deadline.

3. Check the table against the emails. You'll probably see only Seri Mutiara, with its 7-day stock hold. Copilot answered from the open conversation, not the whole inbox.
4. Open the Cyberjaya Digital email and ask:

Which vendor has offered a warranty upgrade, and at what price per unit?



Copilot answered from the conversation you had open. To ask about another vendor, open that email first.

Key point: An answer that looks complete may only cover what Copilot could see. Here it found one vendor, not three. Always ask yourself what Copilot was looking at.

If you don't see this: Microsoft is extending Copilot in Outlook to search across the whole mailbox for Basic users, so yours may find all three vendors. If it does, check the table against each email anyway.

5.5 Draft a Request for a Revalidated Quotation

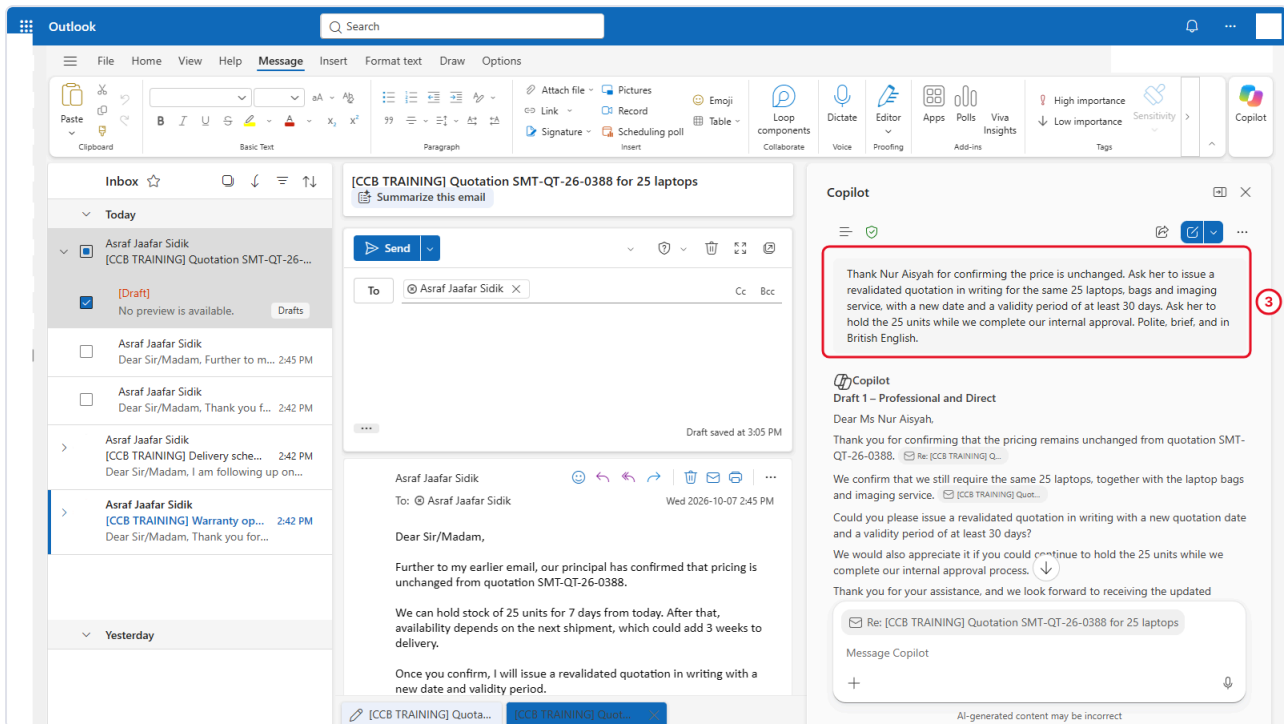
Policy Section 5.2 says an expired quotation must be revalidated **in writing**. Seri Mutiara's follow-up says the price hasn't changed, but an email isn't a revalidated quotation. Ask for one.

1. Open the Seri Mutiara conversation and select **Reply**.
2. Select the **Copilot** button to open the pane, if it isn't open already.
3. Paste the prompt below into the pane and send it.

Thank Nur Aisyah for confirming the price is unchanged. Ask her to issue a revalidated quotation in writing for the same 25 laptops, bags and imaging service, with a new date and a validity period of at least 30 days. Ask her to hold the 25 units while we complete our internal approval. Polite, brief, and in British English.

4. Read the draft in the pane. To change it, ask in the pane, for example **Make it shorter**, and mention that **we need it by Friday**.

5. When you're happy, copy the draft and paste it into your reply.



Copilot drafts in the pane. You copy, adjust and decide whether to send.

6. Read the email once more in the reply window. Check the quotation number, the quantity and the name. This reply goes to you, so you can send it, or close it and keep it in **Drafts**.

Important: Always read a Copilot draft before you send it. Check names, numbers and any promise it makes on your behalf, such as a date or a commitment to buy. In real life this email goes to a supplier.

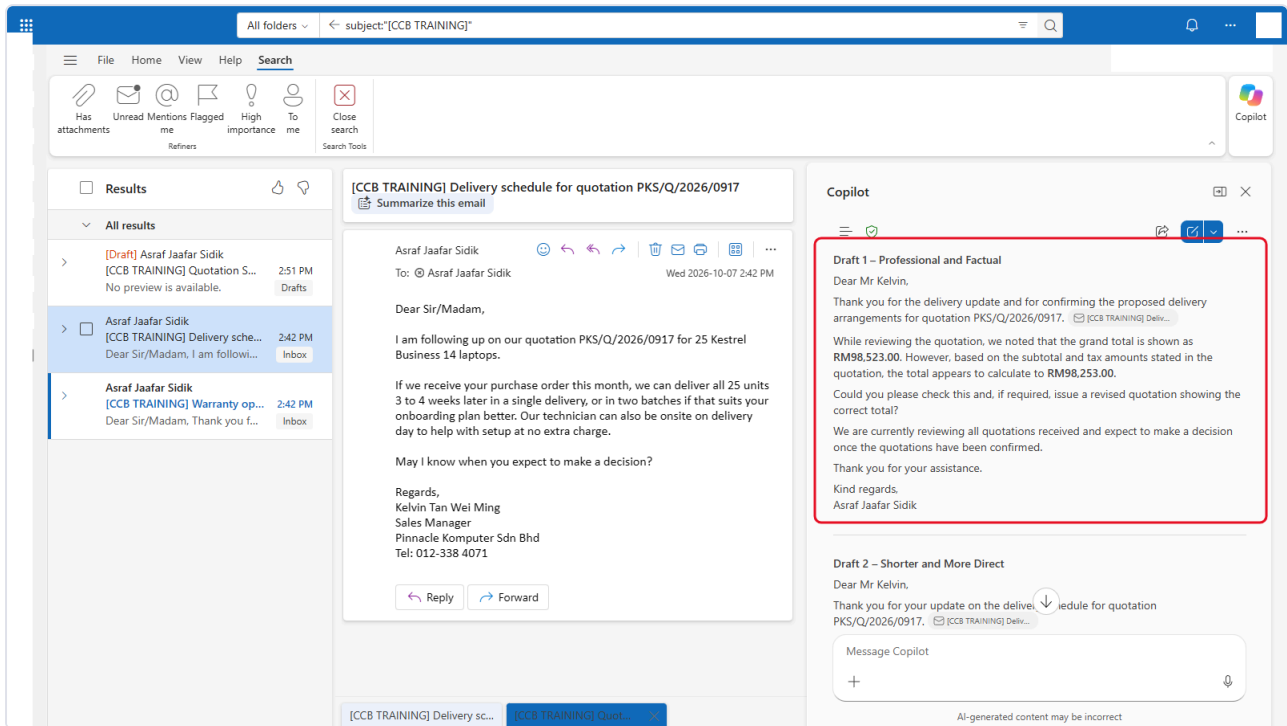
5.6 Draft a Correction Request

Policy Section 6.4 says an arithmetic error must be corrected by the vendor in a revised quotation. Pinnacle Komputer has emailed to ask when you'll decide. Use your reply to raise the error.

1. Open the Pinnacle Komputer email and select **Reply**.
2. Open the **Copilot** pane.
3. Replace the two figures in square brackets with the printed grand total and the correct grand total you found in 4.5, then send it in the pane.

Thank Kelvin for the delivery update. Explain that while checking quotation PKS/Q/2026/0917 we found the grand total is printed as RM[printed grand total], but the subtotal plus tax comes to RM[correct grand total]. Ask him to check and issue a revised quotation with the correct total. Say we expect to decide once all quotations are confirmed. Polite and factual, no blame.

4. Check the draft. The two figures must match what you wrote, exactly. Copilot sometimes rounds or retypes numbers.
5. Copy the draft into your reply. Keep it in **Drafts** or send it to yourself.



The figures came from your own check in Chapter 4. Copilot only wrote the words around them.

Tip: You give Copilot the numbers. Don't ask Copilot in Outlook to work out the correct total for you: it can't see the quotation PDF, and you've already checked it.

Independent Practice

Reply to the Cyberjaya Digital email, drafting your reply in the Copilot pane. Ask for a revised quotation that includes the 3-year onsite warranty upgrade, so all three quotations are like-for-like in writing. Then check the draft mentions the right quotation number and warranty.

After the Course

Search for [CCB TRAINING] in Outlook, select all the results, and delete them.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
No Copilot options in Outlook	Use Outlook on the web with your work account. Classic Outlook may not show them all

The summary only covers the first email	Open the newest message in the conversation and summarise again
Copilot says you are the vendor	Add "The vendor is the person who signs each email" to your prompt
Copilot can't find the [CCB TRAINING] emails	Wait a few minutes after sending. New emails can take a moment to be searchable
The draft changes your figures	Edit them by hand in the reply, or regenerate with "Use these figures exactly"
Copilot stops responding	Standard access is busy. Wait a minute and try again

Lesson Summary

Copilot in Outlook summarised a thread, found what each vendor was waiting for, and drafted two careful replies in less time than it takes to write one. You supplied the facts, from your own checks, and Copilot supplied the wording. Next, you take everything from the comparison chat into a Page, write the justification memo, and export it.

Check yourself: Why did you check the summary against the most recent email? Why do you type the figures into the correction prompt yourself?

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

The vendor emails to send yourself, and the prompts for Copilot in Outlook. Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner. Anything marked **text** is pasted straight into an email.

Session guide: these prompts run in Outlook on the web, not in the Copilot app. Part 2 uses **Summarize this email** on an open email, and Parts 3 and 4 use the **Copilot pane**, which works with the email you have open.

Part 1: Vendor emails to send yourself

Send each email to your own address. Send Emails 1, 2 and 3 as new messages. Send Email 4 as a **reply** to Email 1, so the two form one conversation.

Email 1: Seri Mutiara Technology (new email)

Subject (text):

[CCB TRAINING] Quotation SMT-QT-26-0388 for 25 laptops

Body (text):

Dear Sir/Madam,

Thank you for your call this morning about our quotation SMT-QT-26-0388 dated 4 August 2026 for 25 Halcyon WorkBook 14 laptops.

You are right that the quotation was valid for 30 days only. Memory and storage prices have moved since August, so some of our prices may have changed. I have asked our principal to confirm current pricing and will come back to you as soon as I hear from them.

In the meantime, please confirm that you still need the laptop backpacks and the imaging service.

Best regards,
Nur Aisyah binti Kamal
Account Executive
Seri Mutiara Technology Sdn Bhd
Tel: 019-277 5103

Email 2: Cyberjaya Digital Supplies (new email)

Subject (text):

[CCB TRAINING] Warranty options for quotation CDS/2026/Q-1142

Body (text):

Dear Sir/Madam,

Thank you for considering Cyberjaya Digital Supplies.

Our quotation CDS/2026/Q-1142 includes the standard 1-year carry-in warranty. For corporate customers we recommend the 3-year onsite warranty upgrade at RM280.00 per unit, as stated in our quotation. We can also offer a 2-year carry-in extension at RM150.00 per unit.

We would be happy to issue a revised quotation that includes either option. Please let us know which you prefer.

Regards,
Arvind Selvaraj
Business Development Manager
Cyberjaya Digital Supplies Sdn Bhd
Tel: 017-640 2289

Email 3: Pinnacle Komputer (new email)

Subject (text):

[CCB TRAINING] Delivery schedule for quotation PKS/Q/2026/0917

Body (text):

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am following up on our quotation PKS/Q/2026/0917 for 25 Kestrel Business 14 laptops.

If we receive your purchase order this month, we can deliver all 25 units 3 to 4 weeks later in a single delivery, or in two batches if that suits your onboarding plan better. Our technician can also be onsite on delivery day to help with setup at no extra charge.

May I know when you expect to make a decision?

Regards,
Kelvin Tan Wei Ming
Sales Manager
Pinnacle Komputer Sdn Bhd
Tel: 012-338 4071

Email 4: Seri Mutiara follow-up (reply to Email 1)

Open Email 1 in your Inbox, select **Reply**, and paste this above the original message. Keep the subject as it is.

Body (text):

Dear Sir/Madam,

Further to my earlier email, our principal has confirmed that pricing is unchanged from quotation SMT-QT-26-0388.

We can hold stock of 25 units for 7 days from today. After that, availability depends on the next shipment, which could add 3 weeks to delivery.

Once you confirm, I will issue a revalidated quotation in writing with a new date and validity period.

Best regards,
Nur Aisyah binti Kamal
Account Executive
Seri Mutiara Technology Sdn Bhd
Tel: 019-277 5103

Part 2: Summarising

Session: open email, Summarize this email | **Grounding:** the email thread

No prompt needed: open the Seri Mutiara conversation and select **Summarize this email**. Then check the summary reflects the latest message.

Part 3: Asking about your inbox

Session: Copilot pane in Outlook | **Grounding:** your mailbox

Look at my emails with [CCB TRAINING] in the subject. Which vendors are waiting for a reply from me, and what does each one need from me? Put it in a table with the vendor, what they asked, and any deadline.

Which vendor has offered a warranty upgrade, and at what price per unit?

If Copilot thinks you are the vendor:

The vendor is the person who signs each email, not the sender. Please answer again.

Part 4: Drafting replies

Session: Reply, then the Copilot pane | **Grounding:** the email you have open

Seri Mutiara: request a revalidated quotation

Thank Nur Aisyah for confirming the price is unchanged. Ask her to issue a revalidated quotation in writing for the same 25 laptops, bags and imaging service, with a new date and a validity period of at least 30 days. Ask her to hold the 25 units while we complete our internal approval. Polite, brief, and in British English.

Pinnacle Komputer: request a corrected quotation

Replace both figures in square brackets with your own findings from section 4.5.

Thank Kelvin for the delivery update. Explain that while checking quotation PKS/Q/2026/0917 we found the grand total is printed as RM[printed grand total], but the subtotal plus tax comes to RM[correct grand total]. Ask him to check and issue a revised quotation with the correct total. Say we expect to decide once all quotations are confirmed. Polite and factual, no blame.

Cyberjaya Digital: request a like-for-like quotation (independent practice)

Thank Arvind for the warranty options. Ask him to issue a revised quotation for the same items that includes the 3-year onsite warranty upgrade, so we can compare it like-for-like with the other quotations. Brief and polite.

To fix a draft that changed your numbers:

Use the figures I gave you exactly, without rounding.

06

CHAPTER 6

From Chat to Pages

Your comparison lives in a long chat, and long chats have a weakness: the more you go back and forth, the more likely something you agreed earlier quietly drops out. In this chapter you see that happen, then move the comparison into a Copilot Page, where the content stays put and you can edit it like a document. You write the justification memo on the same Page, share it, and export it for the HOD.

Prompts: every prompt you need is in the steps, with a Copy button. The prompts page has them all on one page too.

Estimated time: 40 minutes

Your result: A Copilot Page with the checked comparison and the justification memo, shared with a colleague and exported as a Word document and a PDF.

What You Will Learn

- Recognise when a long chat has started to drift
- Send a Copilot response to a Page
- Edit a Page by hand and with Copilot
- Write a justification memo that follows the policy
- Share a Page and export it to Word and PDF

Before You Begin

You need the **Laptop purchase - comparison** chat from Chapter 4, with the four files still in it. If you lost it, start a new chat, upload the four files again, and run Parts 2 to 5 of the Chapter 4 prompts before you start.

6.1 Why Long Chats Drift

Copilot reads the whole chat each time you send a message, but it doesn't treat every earlier message equally. After several rounds of changes, a point you settled ten messages ago can quietly disappear from the latest version. Nobody tells you. It's just no longer there.

Try it.

1. Open the **Laptop purchase - comparison** chat.

2. Send these three changes, one at a time:

Shorten the comparison table to the 8 rows that matter most to a manager.

Make the language more formal, and add a final row with your overall comment on each vendor.

Now give me the final comparison table, ready for the HOD.

3. Look at the final table and compare it with what you found in Chapter 4. Check for each of these:

- the corrected grand total for the vendor with the arithmetic error
- the expired validity of the other vendor's quotation
- the warranty adjustment that made the comparison like-for-like

Copilot

Auto

Item	Pinnacle Komputer	Seri Mutiara Technology	Cyberjaya Digital Supplies
Proposed Laptop	Kestrel Business 14 (KB14-US)	Halcyon WorkBook 14	Meranti Pro 14
Key Specification	Intel Core Ultra 5 125U, 16GB RAM, 512GB SSD	Intel Core Ultra 5 125U, 16GB RAM, 512GB SSD	Intel Core Ultra 5 135L 16GB RAM, 512GB SSI
Display	14" FHD (1920×1080) IPS anti-glare	14" WUXGA (1920×1200) anti-glare	14" FHD+ (1920×1200)
Adjusted Total (Incl. Tax)	RM98,523.00*	RM94,905.00	RM95,445.00 (include 3-year warranty adjustment)
Warranty	3-year onsite, next business day	3-year onsite, next business day	1-year carry-in (upgrai to 3-year onsite quote separately)
Delivery Lead Time	3-4 weeks	2-3 weeks	3 weeks
Quotation	Valid	Expired - requires written revalidation	Valid
Evaluation	Arithmetic error in grand total; revised quotation required	Expired quotation; written revalidation required	Revised quotation required to include 3-year onsite warranty

+ Message Copilot

AI-generated content may be incorrect

After three rounds of changes, the corrected Pinnacle total has quietly gone back to the wrong printed figure. Nothing in the answer says so.

Checkpoint: Did one of your findings disappear or change? In most classes, at least one does. If yours all survived, you were lucky, and it can still happen next time.

Key point: When an answer matters and you've been changing it for a while, stop iterating in the chat. Ask for one complete version that lists everything it must include, then move it to a Page, where it can't drift.

6.2 Turn the Comparison into a Page

1. In the same chat, send this prompt. It names every finding, so none can be left out:

Give me one complete comparison of the three laptop quotations for my HOD. Include: the figures exactly as printed; the recalculated grand totals, with the arithmetic error clearly marked; the validity of each quotation as of today, with the expired one clearly marked; the warranty adjustment that makes the comparison like-for-like, with adjusted totals; and a short list of open actions for each vendor. Use one table plus a short list of actions.

2. Check the answer against your Chapter 4 findings. Fix anything wrong now, with one more prompt, before you move it.
3. Under the response, select **More options (...)**, then **Edit in Pages**. The Page opens next to the chat with the response copied into it, and the Page is attached to the message box so Copilot can work with it.

The screenshot shows the Copilot interface with a chat window on the left and a new page titled "Laptop purchase - comparison and memo" on the right. The page contains a table titled "Laptop Quotation Comparison for HOD Review (14 October 2026)". The table has four columns: Item, Pinnacle Komputer, Seri Mutiara, and Cyberjaya Digital. The table lists various items including Quoted Grand Total, Recalculated Grand Total, Arithmetic Difference, Warranty, Validity Status, Policy Issue, Warranty Adjustment Required, and Adjusted Total (Like-for-Like). The chat window on the left shows a prompt to add a "Status" row to the table and a response from Copilot.

Item	Pinnacle Komputer	Seri Mutiara ...	Cyberjaya Digital ...
1 Quoted Grand Total	RM98,523.00	RM94,905.00	RM87,885.00
2 Recalculated Grand Total	RM98,253.00 ⚠️	RM94,905.00 ✓	RM87,885.00 ✓
3 Arithmetic Difference	RM270.00 ⚠️ Printed total does not equal subtotal + tax	RM0.00	RM0.00
4 Warranty (Quoted)	3 years onsite, next business day, parts & labour	3 years onsite, next business day	1 year carry-in, parts & labour
5 Validity Status (14 Oct 2026)	Valid (until 21 Nov 2026) ✓	Expired (expired 3 Sep 2026) ⚠️	Valid (until 9 Nov 2026) ✓
6 Policy Issue	Arithmetic error requires supplier correction	Written revalidation required before use	Warranty below policy minimum of 3 years
7 Warranty Adjustment Required	Nil	Nil	RM280 × 25 units = RM7,000.00 + RM560.00 tax = RM7,560.00
8 Adjusted Total (Like-for-Like)	RM98,523.00*	RM94,905.00	RM95,445.00

The Page opens beside the chat. From now on, the Page is the version that counts.

4. Select the title at the top of the Page and rename it:

Laptop purchase - comparison and memo

If you don't see this: If there's no **Edit in Pages** option, select **Copy** under the response, open **Library** in the left pane of the Copilot app, create a new Page, and paste. If you can't create a Page at all, your organisation may have turned it off, or your account may not have OneDrive storage. Tell your trainer, and use a Word document instead for the rest of this chapter.

6.3 Edit the Page with Copilot

A Page is a document you can type in, with Copilot built in.

1. Click anywhere in the Page and type, the same as in Word. Correct any figure that doesn't match your own check.
2. In the message box beside the Page (the Page is attached to it), send:

Add a "Status" row to the comparison table with one of these for each vendor: Ready, Needs correction, Needs revalidation, Needs revised quotation.

3. Copilot replies in the chat with the new row, and may offer a button to insert it. If it doesn't change the Page itself, add the row to the table by hand: select the last row, then **New**, and type the values.

does not meet the policy minimum of three years and requires a revised quotation including the stated 3-year onsite warranty upgrade. ¹

The recommendation is conditional upon the above actions being completed in writing by the respective suppliers.

Approval Required Under Section 4

The recommended value of RM95,445.00 including tax falls within the policy threshold of above RM20,000 up to RM100,000. Accordingly, the purchase requires:

- Three written quotations
- A comparison
- A justification memo
- Head of Department (HOD) approval

Add a signature and approval block

Tighten this to one page

Verify the Section 7 headings

Laptop purch...

+ Message Copilot

AI-generated content may be incorrect

Laptop purchase - comparison and memo

Item	Pinnacle Komputer	Seri Mutiara ...	Cyberjaya Digital ...
5 Validity Status (14 Oct 2026)	Valid (until 21 Nov 2026) ✓	Expired (expired 3 Sep 2026) ⚠	Valid (until 9 Nov 2026) ✓
6 Policy Issue	Arithmetic error requires supplier correction	Written revalidation required before use	Warranty below policy minimum of 3 years
7 Warranty Adjustment Required	Nil	Nil	RM280 × 25 units = RM7,000.00 + RM560.00 tax = RM7,560.00
8 Adjusted Total (Like-for-Like)	RM98,523.00*	RM94,905.00	RM95,445.00
9 Status	Needs correction	Needs revalidation	Needs revised quotation

+ New

* Printed total used because Section 6.4 requires the supplier to correct arithmetic errors; purchasers must not amend supplier figures themselves.

Open Actions Before Approval

- **Pinnacle Komputer Sdn Bhd:** Submit a revised quotation correcting the RM270.00 arithmetic discrepancy between the printed grand total and the subtotal-plus-tax calculation.
- **Seri Mutiara Technology Sdn Bhd:** Provide written revalidation of the quotation, which expired on 3 September 2026. Section 5.2 states that verbal confirmation is insufficient.
- **Cyberjaya Digital Supplies Sdn Bhd:** Submit a revised quotation including the stated 3-year onsite warranty upgrade so that the offer complies with the policy requirement for IT equipment.

Copilot suggests the change in the chat. The Page only changes when you insert it or type it yourself.

Tip: Type small fixes yourself. It's faster than asking Copilot, and you know exactly what changed.

6.4 Write the Justification Memo

Section 7 of the policy lists what the memo must include. Ask Copilot to follow it, on the same Page, above the comparison.

1. In the chat beside the Page, send this prompt. The policy is still uploaded in this chat, so Copilot can use Section 7:

Write a justification memo to the HOD for the laptop purchase, following Section 7 of the procurement policy exactly. Use a heading for each item Section 7 lists. Recommend the vendor from our comparison, but make the recommendation conditional on the open actions being completed in writing. Use [budget code] and [HOD name] as placeholders. Keep it to one page, in plain British English.

2. Read the memo. Check that every item in Section 7 has a heading, and that the total is the right one for the recommended vendor.
3. Under the memo, select **More options (...)**. With your Page still open, the option reads **Add to page**. Select it, and the memo is added to the end of your Page.
4. Move the memo above the comparison: select the memo text, cut it (Ctrl+X), click at the top of the Page and paste (Ctrl+V). Check the headings: they can lose their formatting on the way, so tidy them up.
5. Replace [budget code] and [HOD name] with ADM-IT-2026-07 and Encik Faizal Rahman (both fictional).

does not meet the policy minimum of three years and requires a revised quotation including the stated 3-year onsite warranty upgrade. ¹

The recommendation is conditional upon the above actions being completed in writing by the respective suppliers.

Approval Required Under Section 4

The recommended value of RM95,445.00 including tax falls within the policy threshold of **above RM20,000 up to RM100,000**. Accordingly, the purchase requires:

- Three written quotations
- A comparison
- A justification memo
- **Head of Department (HOD) approval** ¹

[Add a signature and approval block](#)
[Tighten this to one page](#)
[Verify the Section 7 headings](#)

Laptop purch... x

+ Message Copilot

AI-generated content may be incorrect

Justification Memo

To: Encik Faizal Rahman From: Admin and Facilities Department Subject: Recommendation for Purchase of 25 Business Laptops for New Hires

Purpose of the Purchase and the Business Need

The department requires 25 business laptops for new hires. The laptops will be used for Microsoft 365 applications, Microsoft Teams, web-based systems and day-to-day administrative work to support operational requirements.

Budget Code and Confirmation that Budget is Available

Budget Code: ADM-IT-2026-07

Budget availability is to be confirmed before approval.

Suppliers Approached and Quotations Received Supplier Quotation No. Date Pinnacle Komputer Sdn Bhd PKS/Q/2026/0917 22 September 2026

Seri Mutiara Technology Sdn Bhd SMT-QT-26-0388 4 August 2026

Cyberjaya Digital Supplies Sdn Bhd CDS/2026/Q-1142 25 September 2026 Comparison Summary, With Any Like-for-Like Adjustments Shown Supplier Adjusted Total (Including Tax) Seri Mutiara Technology Sdn Bhd RM94,905.00

Cyberjaya Digital Supplies Sdn Bhd RM95,445.00* Pinnacle Komputer Sdn Bhd RM98,523.00**

- Includes the supplier's quoted 3-year onsite warranty upgrade of RM280.00 per unit plus tax, as required for a like-for-like comparison. ** Contains an arithmetic discrepancy in the supplier's quotation and is subject to correction by the supplier. Recommended Supplier, Total Amount (Including Tax) and Reasons for the Recommendation

It is recommended that the purchase be awarded to Cyberjaya Digital Supplies Sdn Bhd at an adjusted total value of RM95,445.00 including tax, subject to the supplier issuing a revised quotation in writing that includes the quoted 3-year onsite warranty upgrade. The recommendation is based on the supplier providing the most competitive valid quotation after adjustment for the policy-required warranty comparison, together with suitable technical specifications and delivery terms. Any Exceptions, Risks or Issues Found and How They Were Resolved Pinnacle Komputer Sdn Bhd's quotation contains an arithmetic discrepancy of

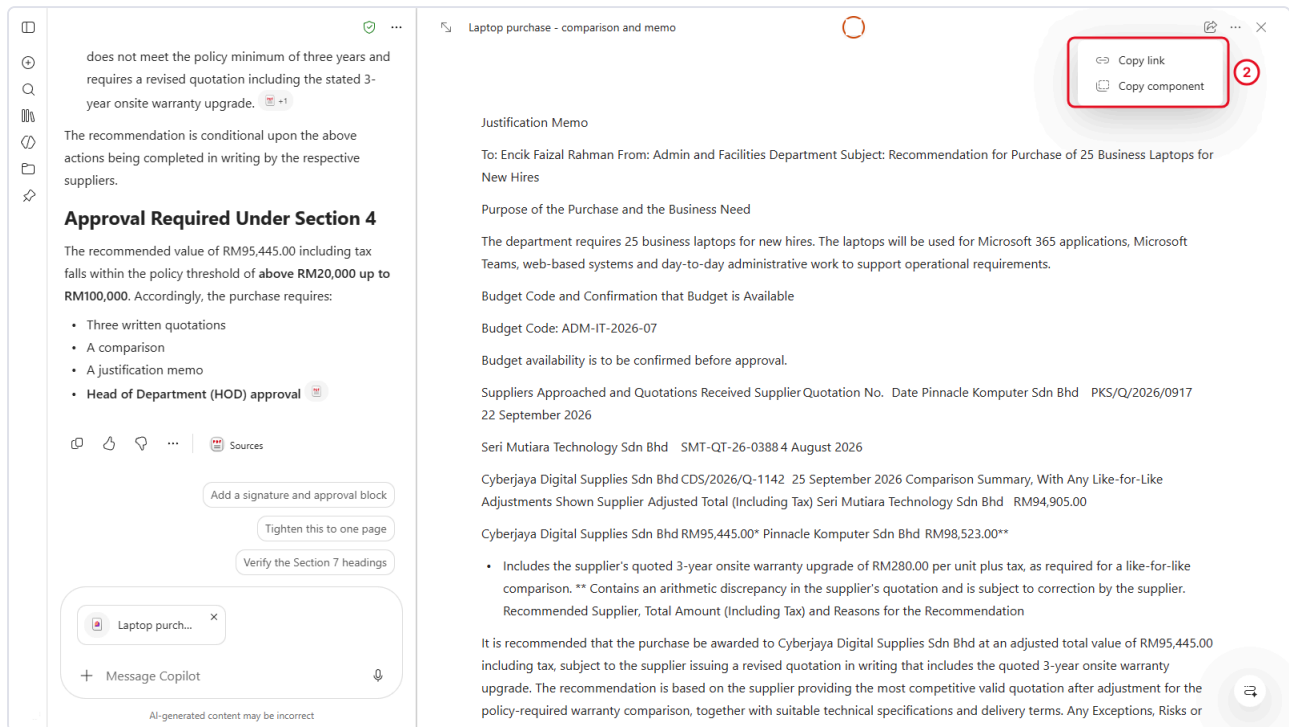
Memo first, evidence after. The HOD reads the recommendation, then checks the table.

Important: Read every sentence of the memo as if you'd written it yourself, because you're the one signing it. Delete anything you can't back up from the quotations or the policy.

6.5 Share the Page

1. Select **Share** at the top right of the Page.
2. Select **Copy link**.

3. Paste the link into a Teams chat with the person your trainer pairs you with.
4. Ask your partner to open the link. They see the Page, but not your chat with Copilot.

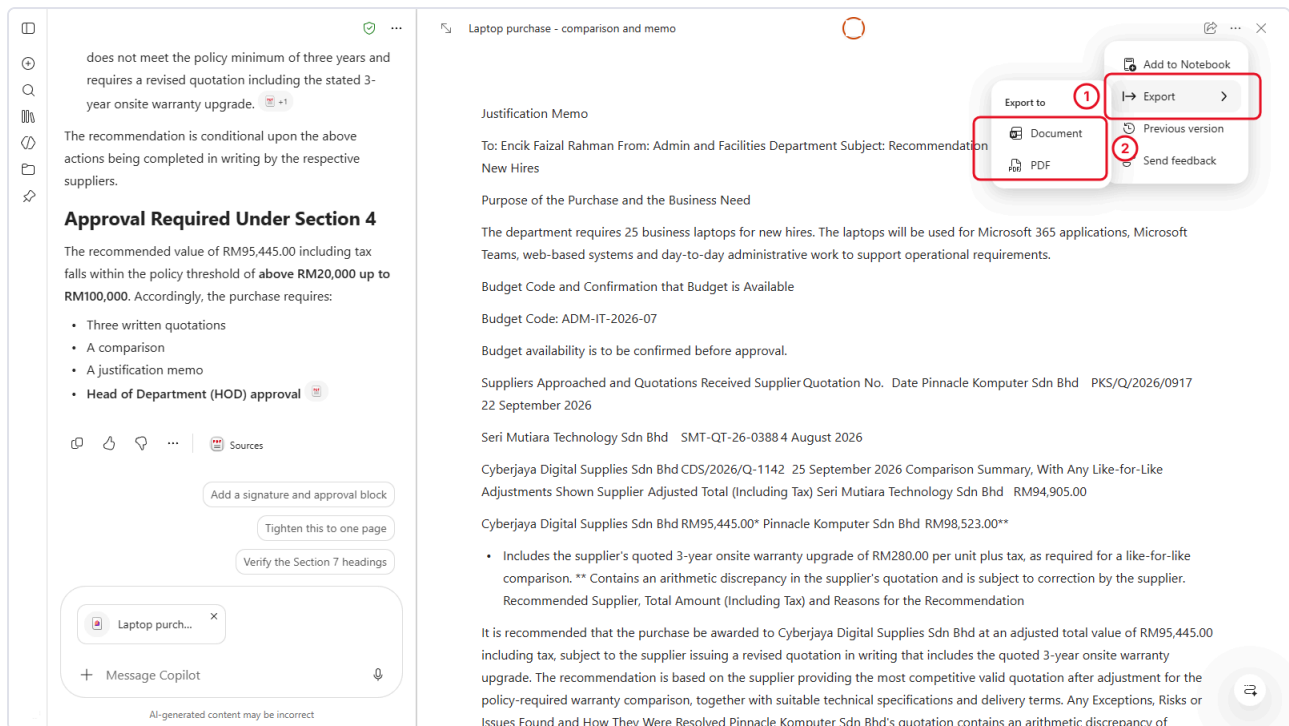


People you share with see the Page. They don't see the chat it came from or the files you uploaded there.

6.6 Export to Word or PDF

Your HOD wants the memo as a document. Export the Page to Word, then save a PDF from Word.

1. At the top of the Page, select **More actions (...)**, then **Export**.
2. Select **Document**. Word for the web opens with your memo and comparison, saved in your OneDrive.
3. Check the formatting, especially the table and the memo headings. Fix anything that moved.
4. For a PDF, go back to the Page and select **More actions > Export > PDF**. (In Word for the web, **File > Export > Download as PDF** works too.)



Word for the web works without Copilot, so this step works with either Basic label.

Checkpoint: You have a Page, a Word document in OneDrive, and a PDF in your Downloads folder, all with the same memo.

If you don't see this: If the export option is missing, select everything in the Page (Ctrl+A), copy it, and paste it into a new Word document. The table may need tidying afterwards.

Independent Practice

On your Page, ask Copilot to write a three-sentence summary of the memo for a Teams message to your HOD, letting them know the memo is coming. Put it at the end of the Page under a heading **Teams message**.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
The memo is missing a policy item	Ask "Which items from Section 7 are missing from this memo?" and add them
Copilot says it can't see the policy	You're in a different chat from the one with the files. Go back to the comparison chat, or upload the policy again
Your partner can't open the shared Page	Check you shared it with their work account, not a personal address
The table breaks in Word	Select the table in Word and choose Table > AutoFit > AutoFit to window

Pages is
missing

Your organisation may have turned Pages off, or you may not have OneDrive storage. Use Word instead

Lesson Summary

Long chats drift, so you moved the finished comparison into a Page, where it stays put and you can edit it directly. You wrote the memo against the policy, shared the Page, and turned it into a Word document and a PDF. Next, you put the whole purchase (quotations, policy and memo) into one Notebook.

Check yourself: What made the comparison drift, and what did you do to make sure the version on the Page was complete?

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Move the comparison into a Page and write the justification memo. Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner.

Session guide: Parts 1 to 3 run in the **Laptop purchase - comparison** chat from Chapter 4, where the files are uploaded. Part 2's Status row prompt runs in the Copilot box on the Page.

Part 1: Watch a chat drift

Session: Laptop purchase - comparison chat | **Grounding:** uploaded files

Send these one at a time, then check the final table against your Chapter 4 findings.

Shorten the comparison table to the 8 rows that matter most to a manager.

Make the language more formal, and add a final row with your overall comment on each vendor.

Now give me the final comparison table, ready for the HOD.

Part 2: Building the Page

Session: same chat | **Grounding:** uploaded files

Give me one complete comparison of the three laptop quotations for my HOD. Include: the figures exactly as printed; the recalculated grand totals, with the arithmetic error clearly marked; the validity of each quotation as of today, with the expired one clearly marked; the warranty adjustment that makes the comparison like-for-like, with adjusted totals; and a short list of open actions for each vendor. Use one table plus a short list of actions.

Page title (text):

Laptop purchase - comparison and memo

On the Page (Copilot box):

Add a "Status" row to the comparison table with one of these for each vendor: Ready, Needs correction, Needs revalidation, Needs revised quotation.

Part 3: The justification memo

Session: same chat | **Grounding:** uploaded files (the policy)

Write a justification memo to the HOD for the laptop purchase, following Section 7 of the procurement policy exactly. Use a heading for each item Section 7 lists. Recommend the vendor from our comparison, but make the recommendation conditional on the open actions being completed in writing. Use [budget code] and [HOD name] as placeholders. Keep it to one page, in plain British English.

Fictional values for the placeholders (text):

ADM-IT-2026-07

Encik Faizal Rahman

To check the memo:

Which items from Section 7 of the policy are missing from this memo, or only partly covered?

Part 4: Independent practice

Session: Copilot box on the Page | **Grounding:** the Page

Write a three-sentence Teams message to my HOD saying the laptop purchase memo is ready for review, the recommended vendor, and what is still pending. Add it at the end of the Page under the heading "Teams message".

07

CHAPTER 7

Keep It Together in a Notebook

By now the laptop purchase is spread across a chat, a Page, a Word document, some PDFs and your inbox. When the revised quotations arrive next week, you'll want everything in one place, with Copilot able to answer questions across all of it. That's what a Copilot Notebook is for.

Prompts: every prompt you need is in the steps, with a Copy button. The prompts page has them all on one page too.

Estimated time: 30 minutes

Your result: A Notebook called **Laptop purchase 2026** holding the quotations, the policy and the memo, and a status update Copilot wrote from all of them.

What You Will Learn

- Create a Copilot Notebook in the Microsoft 365 Copilot app
- Add files and Pages to a Notebook as references
- Ask Copilot questions that draw on everything in the Notebook
- Keep a Notebook current as a purchase moves on

Before You Begin

You need:

- the four PDFs from `sample-files.zip` (Chapter 4)
- the Page **Laptop purchase - comparison and memo** (Chapter 6)
- the exported Word memo in your OneDrive (Chapter 6)

Note: Use Notebooks in the **Microsoft 365 Copilot app**. OneNote also has a feature called Copilot Notebooks, but it isn't available to **Copilot Chat (Basic)** users. Everything in this chapter happens in the Copilot app, so it works with both Basic labels.

7.1 Create a Notebook

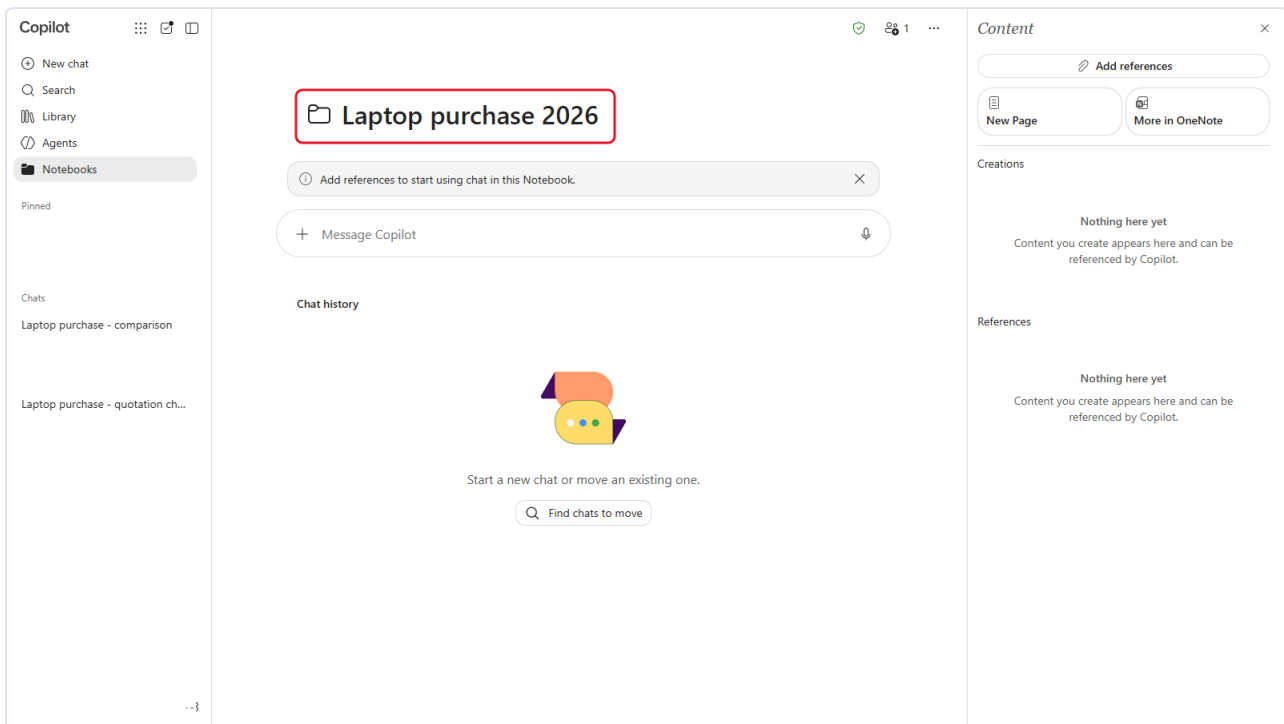
1. In the Copilot app, select **Notebooks** in the left pane.

2. Select **New notebook**.

3. In **Notebook name**, enter the name below, then select **Next**.

Laptop purchase 2026

4. The next step offers to add references. You add them in 7.2, so select **Create**. The Notebook opens with a message box and **Chat history** in the middle, and a **Content** pane on the right with **Creations** and **References**.



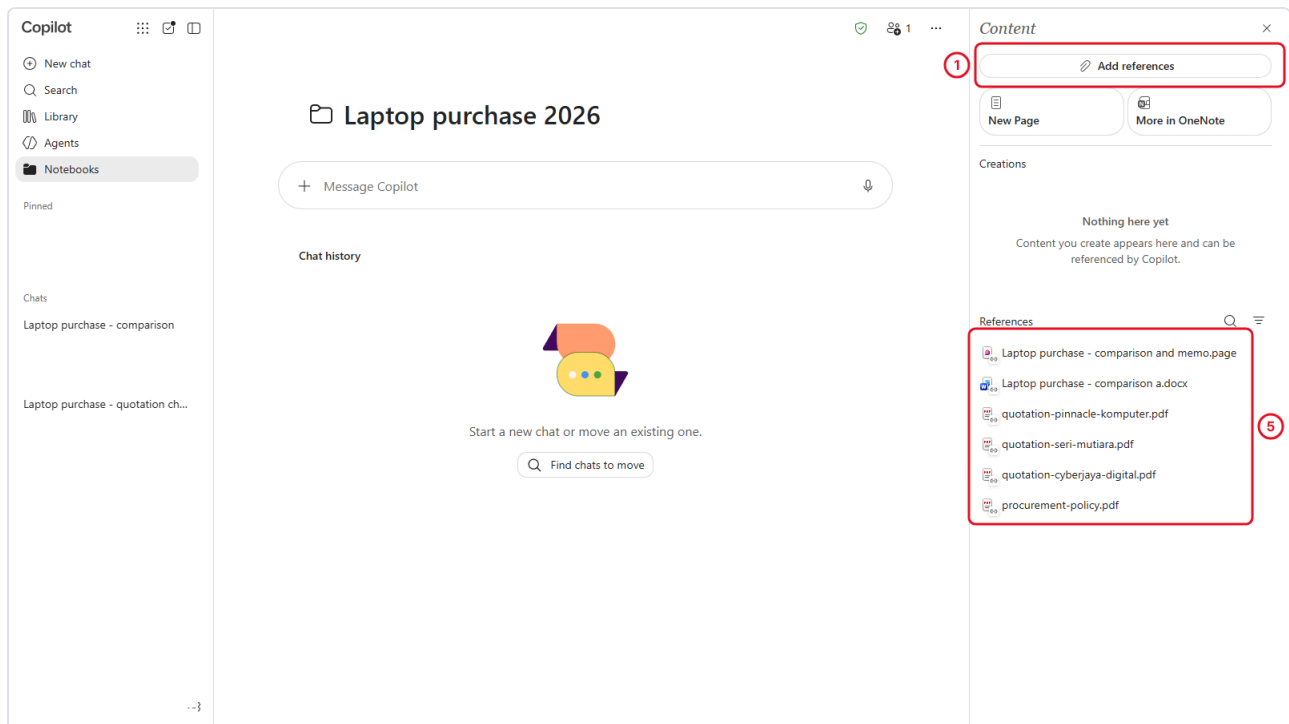
A Notebook keeps its references, its Pages and its chats together, and you can come back to it any time.

If you don't see this: Notebooks reached Basic users from mid-June 2026, so it may still be on its way, or your admin may have turned it off. Notebooks are stored in your organisation's Microsoft 365 storage, so a full storage quota can also block them. If it's missing, watch your trainer's demo, and keep using your comparison chat and Page instead.

7.2 Add the Quotes, Policy and Memo

Everything you add becomes a **reference**: Copilot reads it whenever you ask a question in this Notebook.

1. In the **Content** pane, select **Add references**.
2. Select **Upload files** and upload the four PDFs from your extracted `sample-files` folder.
3. Select **Add references** again, then **OneDrive files**, and pick the Word memo you exported in Chapter 6.
4. Select **Add references** once more and search for **Laptop purchase - comparison and memo** to add your Page.
5. Wait until every reference shows in the list under **References**.



Six references, one place. Copilot can now answer from all of them together.

Tip: Name things clearly before you add them. "Laptop purchase - comparison and memo" is easy to recognise in a list. "Page 3" isn't.

7.3 Ask Questions Across the Notebook

Questions that used to need three files open at once now take one prompt.

1. In the Notebook's chat box, send:

Using all the references in this notebook, list every open action before the HOD can approve the laptop purchase. For each action, say which vendor it involves, which section of the procurement policy requires it, and where in the references you found it.

2. Check that the answer matches your memo. Copilot should cite the references it used. Select a citation to open it.
3. Send a second prompt, the kind of thing your HOD might ask you in the corridor:

If Seri Mutiara's revalidated quotation comes back RM1,000 higher than before, does our recommendation change? Show the numbers.

4. Check the numbers with your calculator.

The screenshot shows the Copilot interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation options: New chat, Search, Library, Agents, and Notebooks (selected). Below these are sections for Pinned, Chats (listing 'Laptop purchase - comparison'), and a section for 'Laptop purchase - quotation ch...'. The main chat area displays a 'Summary' of a memo regarding a laptop purchase. The summary states that before HOD approval, references must be confirmed. It lists four items: 1. Budget availability must be confirmed. 2. Pinnacle Komputer Sdn Bhd must issue a corrected quotation to resolve the RM270 arithmetic error. 3. Seri Mutiara Technology Sdn Bhd must provide written revalidation of its expired quotation. 4. Cyberjaya Digital Supplies Sdn Bhd must issue a revised quotation that includes the 3-year onsite warranty upgrade required for IT equipment. The memo itself states that the recommendation is conditional upon these supplier actions being completed in writing. Once resolved, the procurement package would satisfy HOD approval requirements for purchases above RM20,000 up to RM100,000 under Section 4. At the bottom of the chat area are two buttons: 'Turn this into an HOD approval checklist' and 'Create a concise approval summary with the policy references'. A message input field at the bottom says '+ Message Copilot'. On the right is the 'Content' pane, which has a search bar and two buttons: 'New Page' and 'More in OneNote'. Below these are sections for 'Creations' (showing 'Nothing here yet') and 'References' (listing several documents: 'Laptop purchase - comparison and memo.page', 'Laptop purchase - comparison a.docx', 'quotation-pinnacle-komputer.pdf', 'quotation-seri-mutiara.pdf', 'quotation-cyberjaya-digital.pdf', and 'procurement-policy.pdf').

Answers come from your references, with citations, so you can check where each point came from.

5. Ask for a status update you could send today:

Write a short status update for my HOD on the laptop purchase: what's done, what's pending, and the expected next step. Five bullet points at most.

Key point: Copilot answers from the references you added. If a fact lives only in your inbox, such as Seri Mutiara's 7-day stock hold, the Notebook doesn't know it. Add it to a Page in the Notebook, or paste it into your prompt.

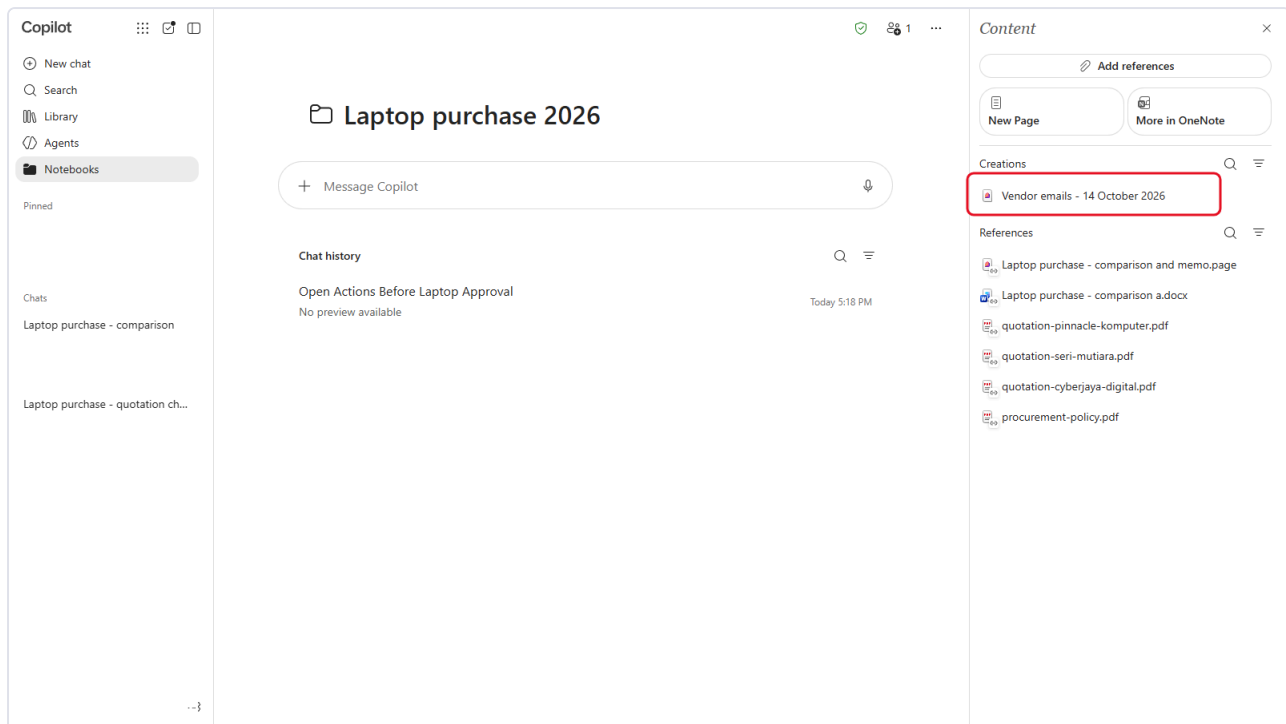
7.4 Keep the Notebook Up to Date

A Notebook is only useful while it's current.

1. Put the facts from Chapter 5 that aren't in any reference into a Page inside the Notebook. In the **Content** pane, select **New Page**, give it the title `Vendor emails`, then paste:

Vendor emails, [today's date]: Seri Mutiara confirmed pricing is unchanged and is holding 25 units for 7 days; a revalidated quotation will follow once we confirm. Cyberjaya Digital offered the 3-year onsite warranty upgrade at RM280 per unit. Pinnacle Komputer has been asked to correct its grand total.

2. Replace `[today's date]`. The Page saves as you type and appears under **Creations**, where Copilot can use it like a reference.
3. When a revised quotation arrives, upload it here and remove the version it replaces, so Copilot doesn't mix the two.



A Page in the Notebook fills the gaps between documents: phone calls, emails and decisions.

Important: Remove superseded documents. If both the expired and the revalidated quotation are in the Notebook, Copilot may quote the wrong one.

Independent Practice

Ask the Notebook: Which vendor would be ready to approve first, and what exactly are we waiting for? Check the answer against your own understanding. Then ask Copilot to turn the answer into a checklist on a new Page.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
Notebooks isn't in the left pane	It may not have reached your organisation yet, or it's turned off. Ask your trainer
A reference won't upload	Check the file isn't open in another app, and try again. At busy times uploads can be limited
The answer ignores a reference	Ask "Which references did you use?" and name the missing one in your prompt
Copilot quotes an old figure	Remove the superseded file from the references
You're looking for this Notebook in OneNote	Notebooks for Basic users live only in the Copilot app

Lesson Summary

You put the whole purchase into one Notebook, asked questions that drew on every document at once, and added a Page to fill the gaps. When the revised quotations arrive, they go in the same Notebook. Next, you build an agent that runs the Chapter 4 checks for you on any quotation.

Check yourself: Why add the Chapter 5 email facts as a Page, and why remove a quotation once a revised one arrives?

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Questions to ask across the whole laptop purchase. Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner.

Session guide: every prompt runs in the chat inside the **Laptop purchase 2026** Notebook, in the Microsoft 365 Copilot app.

Part 1: Setting up

Notebook name (text):

Laptop purchase 2026

Vendor emails Page (text). Replace [today's date] first:

Vendor emails, [today's date]: Seri Mutiara confirmed pricing is unchanged and is holding 25 units for 7 days; a revalidated quotation will follow once we confirm. Cyberjaya Digital offered the 3-year onsite warranty upgrade at RM280 per unit. Pinnacle Komputer has been asked to correct its grand total.

Part 2: Questions across the purchase

Session: Notebook chat | **Grounding:** Notebook references

Using all the references in this notebook, list every open action before the HOD can approve the laptop purchase. For each action, say which vendor it involves, which section of the procurement policy requires it, and where in the references you found it.

If Seri Mutiara's revalidated quotation comes back RM1,000 higher than before, does our recommendation change? Show the numbers.

Write a short status update for my HOD on the laptop purchase: what's done, what's pending, and the expected next step. Five bullet points at most.

Part 3: Independent practice

Session: Notebook chat | **Grounding:** Notebook references

Which vendor would be ready to approve first, and what exactly are we waiting for?

Turn your answer into a checklist I can tick off, with one line per action.

08

CHAPTER 8

Build a Quotation Checker Agent

The checks you ran in Chapter 4 took an hour and about a dozen prompts. The next purchase will need the same checks. An agent is a version of Copilot with your instructions built in, so in this chapter you write those checks once and get the same careful review every time you upload a quotation.

Prompts: every prompt and the full agent instructions are in the steps, with a Copy button. The prompts page has them all on one page too.

Estimated time: 45 minutes

Your result: A **Quotation Checker** agent that checks validity, arithmetic, tax, warranty and delivery terms on any quotation you upload, shared with a colleague.

What You Will Learn

- Use two prebuilt agents: Writing Coach and Prompt Coach
- Create an agent in Agent Builder
- Write agent instructions that turn a checklist into a repeatable review
- Add suggested prompts
- Test an agent against known problems
- Share an agent with a colleague

Before You Begin

You need the four PDFs from `sample-files.zip` (Chapter 4), and your justification memo from Chapter 6.

Note: With Copilot Chat (Basic), you can build agents from **instructions** and **public websites**. You can't give an agent SharePoint sites or files as knowledge, and custom skills need a license. That's fine for this agent: you upload the quotations into the chat each time you use it.

8.1 Try a Prebuilt Agent

Microsoft includes some ready-made agents. Try two before you build your own.

Writing Coach

1. In the Copilot app, select **Agents** in the left pane. The **Agent Store** opens.
2. Search for **Writing Coach** and open it.
3. Paste the recommendation paragraph from your justification memo (Chapter 6) with the prompt below, then send:

Give me feedback on this paragraph from a purchase memo to my head of department. Is it clear, and does it sound confident without overstating? Suggest one improved version.

[paste your paragraph here]

Prompt Coach

4. Go back to **Agents** and open **Prompt Coach**.
5. Send it a weak prompt to improve:

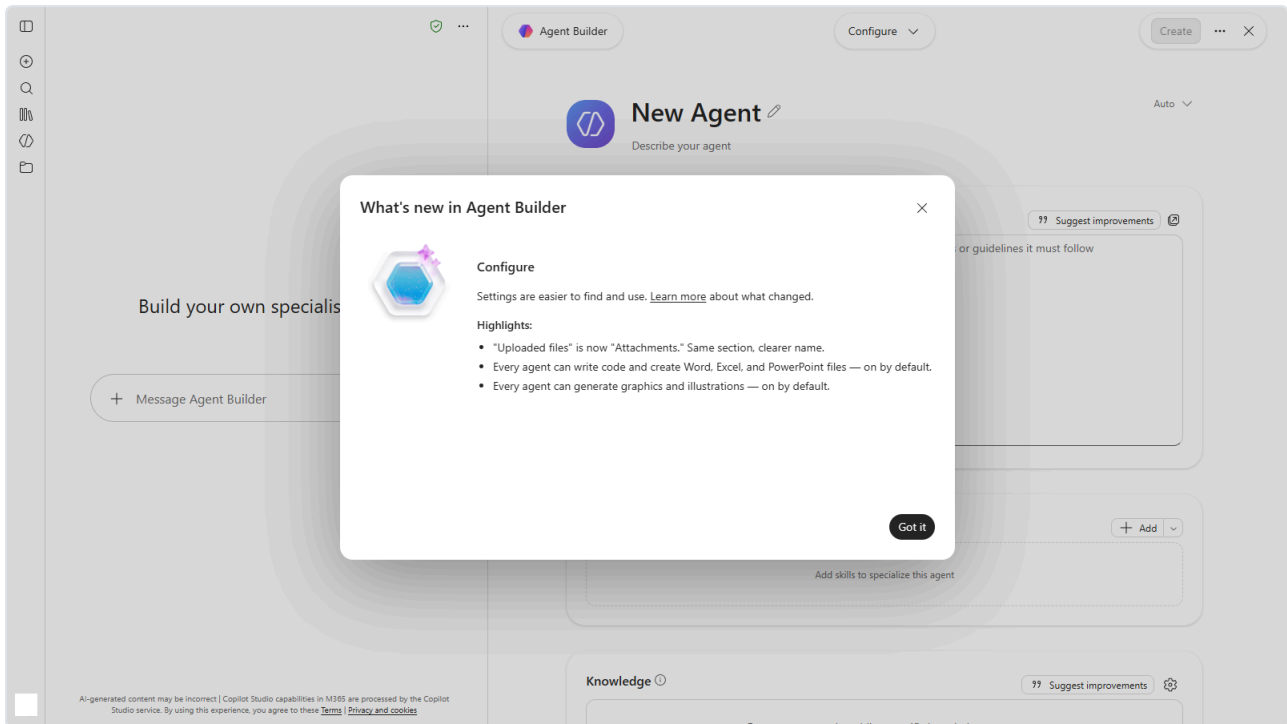
Improve this prompt using clear goal, context, source and expectations: "check this quotation"

6. Keep the improved prompt. It's a good start for your agent's instructions.

If you don't see this: Your admin decides which agents you can use. If Writing Coach says you don't have permission, send the same prompt in a normal Copilot chat instead: it does the same job. If Prompt Coach is missing, skip to 8.2. If **Agents** is missing completely, agents are turned off for your account, and the rest of this chapter is a trainer demo.

8.2 Open Agent Builder

1. Select **Agents** in the left pane, then **New agent**.
2. Agent Builder opens with **Build your own specialist agent** and a box to describe your agent in a chat. Select **Skip**: you'll fill in each field yourself, so you know exactly what the agent has been told.
3. The form opens, with name, description and instructions at the top. If a **What's new in Agent Builder** box appears, select **Got it**.



The form shows every setting on one page: name, description, instructions, knowledge and suggested prompts.

8.3 Name and Describe the Agent

1. In **Name**, enter:

Quotation Checker

2. In **Description**, enter:

Checks supplier quotations for validity, arithmetic, tax, warranty, delivery terms and missing details before you compare them. Upload one or more quotations to start.

The description is what colleagues see when you share the agent, so make it say what the agent does and how to start.

8.4 Write the Instructions

The instructions are the most important part. They're the same checks you ran in Chapter 4, written once.

1. Click in **Instructions**.

2. Paste the instructions below. Read them through: every line is something you did by hand earlier.

You are Quotation Checker, an assistant for the Admin and Facilities department of a Malaysian company. You check supplier quotations before they are compared or approved.

When the user uploads one or more quotations:

1. If the user has not told you today's date, ask for it before you check validity. Do not

guess the date.

2. For each quotation, list: supplier name and registration number, quotation number, date, validity or expiry date, and the person who signed it.

3. Validity: say whether the quotation is still valid on today's date. If it has expired, say so clearly and say that the supplier must revalidate it in writing.

4. Arithmetic: recalculate every line amount (quantity x unit price), the subtotal, the tax and the grand total. Show your working in a table. Compare each figure with the figure printed in the quotation and report every difference, however small. Never correct a supplier's figures silently: show the printed figure and your figure side by side.

5. Tax: confirm the tax is shown as a separate line, and state the rate printed on the quotation. Do not assume or name an official tax rate.

6. Warranty and delivery: state the warranty (length, onsite or carry-in, what it covers) and the delivery lead time. If there is more than one quotation, flag any differences that stop them being like-for-like.

7. Missing details: check that each quotation shows all of the following, and list anything missing: supplier name and registration number, quotation number, date, validity, item descriptions with quantities and unit prices, subtotal, tax as a separate line, grand total, payment terms, delivery lead time, warranty or service scope, and an authorised signature. For training services, also check whether the quotation says if the programme is HRD Corp claimable.

8. End with a short section called "Questions to ask the supplier", with one question for each problem you found.

Rules:

- Use only what is written in the uploaded quotations. Quote the exact words when you report a problem.
- If something is unclear or unreadable, say so. Do not fill the gap with a guess.
- Use Malaysian Ringgit (RM) and British English.
- Do not recommend a supplier unless the user asks you to.

How would you like to update your agent?

+ Message Agent Builder

You are Quotation Checker, an assistant for the Admin and Facilities department of a Malaysian company. You check supplier quotations before they are compared or approved.

When the user uploads one or more quotations:

1. If the user has not told you today's date, ask for it before you check validity. Do not guess the date.
2. For each quotation, list: supplier name and registration number, quotation number, date, validity or expiry date, and the person who signed it.
3. Validity: say whether the quotation is still valid on today's date. If it has expired, say so clearly and say that the supplier must revalidate it in writing.
4. Arithmetic: recalculate every line amount (quantity x unit price), the subtotal, the tax and the grand total. Show your working in a table. Compare each figure with the figure printed in the quotation and report every difference, however small. Never correct a supplier's figures silently: show the printed figure and your figure side by side.
5. Tax: confirm the tax is shown as a separate line, and state the rate printed on the quotation. Do not assume or

2.217/8,000

Skills ⓘ + Add

Add skills to specialize this agent

Knowledge ⓘ ⓘ Suggest improvements ⚙️

Focus your agent by adding specific knowledge sources

+ Add knowledge

🌐 Web search Search all ☒ 4

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Numbered steps make the agent work through the checks in the same order every time.

3. Scroll to **Knowledge**. Don't select **Add knowledge**: this agent doesn't need any, and Basic can't add files or SharePoint as knowledge.

4. Under **Knowledge**, turn off the **Web search** switch, so the agent sticks to the quotations you upload.

Key point: An agent is only as good as its instructions. Rule 1 (ask for the date) and the "never correct silently" line in step 4 fix the two mistakes Copilot made most often in Chapter 4.

8.5 Add Suggested Prompts

Suggested prompts are buttons people see when they open the agent. They show colleagues how to use it.

1. Scroll to **Suggested prompts** and add these three with **Add a suggested prompt**. Each one has a title and a message.

Title	Message
Check a quotation	Check the quotation I've uploaded. Today's date is [today's date].
Compare quotations	Check the quotations I've uploaded and tell me whether they're like-for-like. Today's date is [today's date].
What's missing?	List anything missing from the quotation I've uploaded, and draft one question to the supplier for each item.

The screenshot shows the Copilot Studio Agent Builder interface. On the left, a sidebar contains icons for various tools. The main area is titled 'How would you like to update your agent?' and includes a 'Message Agent Builder' button. The right panel shows the configuration for an agent named 'Agent Builder'. It includes sections for 'Skills', 'Knowledge', and 'Web search'. The 'Suggested prompts' section at the bottom is highlighted with a red box and contains a table with three prompts:

Title	Message	Actions
Check a quotation	Check the quotation I've uploaded. Today's date is 14 October 2026.	🗑️ ⋮
Compare quotations	Check the quotations I've uploaded and tell me whether they're like-for-li	🗑️ ⋮
What's missing?	List anything missing from the quotation I've uploaded, and draft one qu	🗑️ ⋮

Below the table is an 'Add a suggested prompt' button. At the bottom left, a small disclaimer states: 'AI-generated content may be incorrect | Copilot Studio capabilities in M365 are processed by the Copilot Studio service. By using this experience, you agree to these [Terms](#) | [Privacy and cookies](#)'.

Suggested prompts appear as buttons when someone opens the agent.

8.6 Create and Test the Agent

Test the agent against the quotations you already know the answers to. If it finds the three problems, it's ready.

1. Select **Create** at the top right. The confirmation says the agent is private: only you can use it until you share it in 8.7.
2. Open the agent's chat (from the confirmation, or **Agents** in the left pane) and upload `quotation-pinnacle-komputer.pdf`.
3. Send `Check this quotation. Today's date is [today's date].` with today's date filled in.
4. Did it find the arithmetic error? Did it show the printed and correct totals side by side?
5. Upload `quotation-seri-mutiara.pdf` and `quotation-cyberjaya-digital.pdf`. Send `Check these two as well, and tell me whether all three are like-for-like.`
6. Check it flagged the expired quotation and the warranty difference.

Agents miss things too. When we built this agent, it caught the expired quotation and the warranty difference, but said Pinnacle's total was correct: it claimed $90,975 + 7,278 = 98,523$, which is wrong. That's why you test against answers you already know.

7. If it missed the arithmetic error, open the agent, select **Edit**, and add this line to the end of step 4 in the instructions:

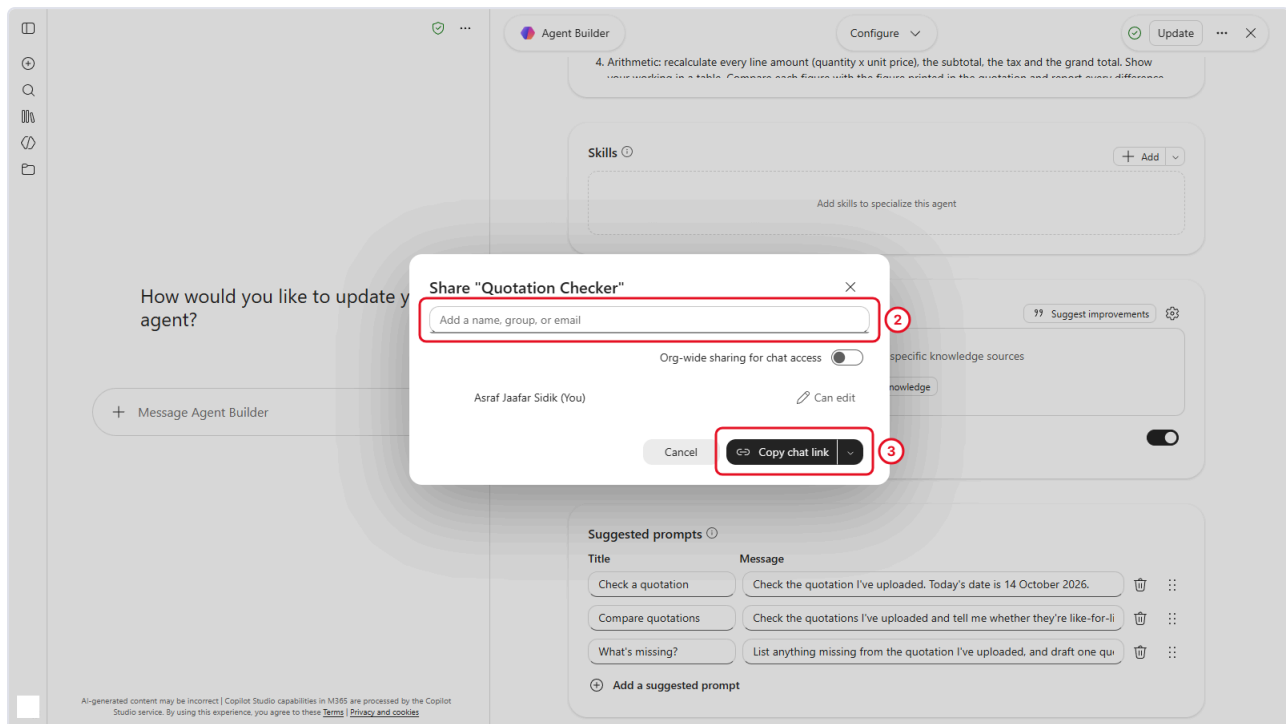
Before comparing, write out `subtotal + tax = your total` as a sum. Never assume the printed grand total is correct.

8. Select **Update**, start a new chat with the agent, and test the Pinnacle quotation again.

If you don't see this: If an upload fails at a busy time, wait a minute and try again. If the agent still misses the error after the extra line, that's worth knowing too: keep checking totals yourself, whatever the agent says.

8.7 Share the Agent

1. Open the agent in Agent Builder and select **Share**.
2. In **Add a name, group, or email**, type the person your trainer pairs you with. (The **Org-wide sharing** switch would share it with everyone in your organisation. Leave it off.)
3. Select **Copy chat link** and send the link to them in Teams.
4. Ask them to open it and use a suggested prompt with one of the quotations.



People you share with can use the agent. They can't see your chats with it, and they upload their own quotations.

Important: Sharing the agent shares its instructions, not your files or chats. Anyone who opens it can read the instructions, so don't put confidential information in them, such as budget limits or a preferred supplier.

Independent Practice

Update the agent so it also checks payment terms, and flags any quotation that asks for a deposit before delivery. Edit the agent (open it, then **Edit**), add one line to the instructions, update, and test it on one of the capstone quotations in `10-capstone/sample-files`.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
The agent checks validity without asking for the date	Put Rule 1 at the top of the instructions, and include the date in your suggested prompts
The agent quietly corrects a vendor's total	Add "Show the printed figure and your figure side by side" to step 4
The agent says it has no files	You're in a new chat with the agent. Upload the quotation again
Create or Share is greyed out	Your admin may limit who can create or share agents. Ask your trainer
Your colleague can't open the agent	Check you shared it with their work account. They may need to refresh the Agents list

Responses are slow

Standard access is busy. Wait a minute and try again

Lesson Summary

You turned an hour of careful checking into an agent that runs the same checks on any quotation in one prompt. The instructions hold the checklist, you upload the quotations each time, and colleagues can use it too. Next, if your label allows it, you look at Copilot inside Word and Excel. If not, go straight to the capstone, where your agent gets its first real job.

Check yourself: Why does this agent need no knowledge sources? Which two lines in the instructions fix mistakes Copilot made in Chapter 4?

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Everything you paste into Agent Builder, plus prompts for the prebuilt agents and for testing. Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner.

Part 1: Prebuilt agents

Session: Writing Coach | **Grounding:** your pasted text

Give me feedback on this paragraph from a purchase memo to my head of department. Is it clear, and does it sound confident without overstating? Suggest one improved version.

[paste your paragraph here]

Session: Prompt Coach | **Grounding:** your pasted text

Improve this prompt using clear goal, context, source and expectations: "check this quotation"

Part 2: Agent details and instructions

Session: Agent Builder form (after Skip) | **Grounding:** instructions only

Name (text):

Quotation Checker

Description (text):

Checks supplier quotations for validity, arithmetic, tax, warranty, delivery terms and missing details before you compare them. Upload one or more quotations to start.

Instructions:

You are Quotation Checker, an assistant for the Admin and Facilities department of a Malaysian company. You check supplier quotations before they are compared or approved.

When the user uploads one or more quotations:

1. If the user has not told you today's date, ask for it before you check validity. Do not guess the date.
2. For each quotation, list: supplier name and registration number, quotation number, date, validity or expiry date, and the person who signed it.
3. Validity: say whether the quotation is still valid on today's date. If it has expired, say so clearly and say that the supplier must revalidate it in writing.
4. Arithmetic: recalculate every line amount (quantity x unit price), the subtotal, the tax and the grand total. Show your working in a table. Compare each figure with the figure printed in the quotation and report every difference, however small. Never correct a supplier's figures silently: show the printed figure and your figure side by side.
5. Tax: confirm the tax is shown as a separate line, and state the rate printed on the quotation. Do not assume or name an official tax rate.
6. Warranty and delivery: state the warranty (length, onsite or carry-in, what it covers) and

the delivery lead time. If there is more than one quotation, flag any differences that stop them being like-for-like.

7. Missing details: check that each quotation shows all of the following, and list anything missing: supplier name and registration number, quotation number, date, validity, item descriptions with quantities and unit prices, subtotal, tax as a separate line, grand total, payment terms, delivery lead time, warranty or service scope, and an authorised signature. For training services, also check whether the quotation says if the programme is HRD Corp claimable.

8. End with a short section called "Questions to ask the supplier", with one question for each problem you found.

Rules:

- Use only what is written in the uploaded quotations. Quote the exact words when you report a problem.
- If something is unclear or unreadable, say so. Do not fill the gap with a guess.
- Use Malaysian Ringgit (RM) and British English.
- Do not recommend a supplier unless the user asks you to.

Part 3: Suggested prompts

Session: Agent Builder, Suggested prompts | **Grounding:** none

Title: **Check a quotation**

Check the quotation I've uploaded. Today's date is [today's date].

Title: **Compare quotations**

Check the quotations I've uploaded and tell me whether they're like-for-like. Today's date is [today's date].

Title: **What's missing?**

List anything missing from the quotation I've uploaded, and draft one question to the supplier for each item.

Part 4: Testing the agent

Session: the agent's chat, after you create it | **Grounding:** uploaded quotations

Upload `quotation-pinnacle-komputer.pdf` first. Replace [today's date].

Check this quotation. Today's date is [today's date].

Then upload `quotation-seri-mutiara.pdf` and `quotation-cyberjaya-digital.pdf`:

Check these two as well, and tell me whether all three are like-for-like.

If the agent misses the Pinnacle arithmetic error, add this line to the end of step 4 in the instructions, select **Update**, and test again:

Before comparing, write out $\text{subtotal} + \text{tax} = \text{your total}$ as a sum. Never assume the printed grand total is correct.

Part 5: Independent practice

Session: Agent Builder, edit the agent | **Grounding:** instructions only

Add this line to the instructions, under step 6:

Payment terms: state the payment terms, and flag any quotation that asks for a deposit or full payment before delivery or before the service is completed.

09

CHAPTER 9

Optional: Copilot in Word and Excel

Optional chapter, for M365 Copilot (Basic) only. If your label in section 1.1 is **Copilot Chat (Basic)**, you don't have Copilot inside Word and Excel. Watch your trainer's demo, or go straight to Chapter 10.

If your organisation is under 2,000 users, you probably have **M365 Copilot (Basic)**, which includes Copilot inside the Office apps with standard access. In this chapter you open the memo you exported in Chapter 6 in Word, and the comparison in Excel, and use Copilot where the documents live.

Prompts: every prompt you need is in the steps, with a Copy button. The prompts page has them all on one page too.

Estimated time: 30 minutes

Your result: A tightened memo in Word and an Excel comparison with a checked total column.

What You Will Learn

- Confirm you have Copilot inside Word and Excel
- Ask Copilot about the document you have open in Word, and improve part of it
- Put the comparison into an Excel table and ask Copilot questions about it
- Use a formula Copilot suggests to check totals

Before You Begin

You need:

- the label **M365 Copilot (Basic)** (or Premium) from section 1.1
- the Word memo you exported in Chapter 6, saved in OneDrive
- the Page **Laptop purchase - comparison and memo**

Note: Standard access applies inside the apps too. At busy times the Copilot pane can be slow or say it's temporarily limited. Wait a minute and try again.

9.1 Check You Have Copilot in the Apps

1. Open the exported memo from OneDrive in **Word for the web**.
2. On the **Home** tab, look for the **Copilot** button at the right end of the ribbon.
3. Select it. The Copilot pane opens on the right.

If you don't see this: No Copilot button means your label is Copilot Chat (Basic), or your admin has turned Copilot off in the apps. Close Word and watch the demo. If the button is there but greyed out, check the document is saved in OneDrive (not on your computer), and that **AutoSave** is on.

9.2 Refine the Memo in Word

1. In the Copilot pane, send:

Summarise this memo in three bullet points, and tell me which part a busy head of department is most likely to question.

2. Read the answer. Copilot is working with the document you have open.
3. Ask for a tighter version of the weakest part:

Rewrite the recommendation section so it is no more than 80 words, keeps every figure exactly as it is, and states the conditions clearly. Show me the new version in the chat.

4. Compare the new version with your original. Check every figure. If you prefer the new one, copy it from the pane and paste it over the old paragraph.

Important: Your memo was checked line by line in Chapter 6. Any rewrite can change a figure or soften a condition. Read the new version against the old one before you keep it.

9.3 Analyse the Comparison in Excel

1. Open your Page **Laptop purchase - comparison and memo**, select the comparison table, and copy it (Ctrl+C).
2. In OneDrive, select **Create or upload > Excel workbook**. Name it `Laptop comparison`.
3. Select cell **A1** and paste (Ctrl+V).
4. Select any cell in the data, then **Insert > Table**. Tick **My table has headers** and select **OK**. Copilot works best with data in a table.
5. Select **Copilot** on the **Home** tab to open the pane.
6. Ask:

Which vendor has the lowest like-for-like total in this table, and by how much?

7. Ask for a formula to check the totals:

Give me a formula I can put in a new row to check that subtotal plus tax equals the grand total for each vendor, showing TRUE or FALSE. Tell me which cell to put it in.

8. Add the formula where Copilot suggests, then fill it across for all three vendors. A FALSE shows a vendor whose total doesn't add up.

Tip: The comparison table may paste with numbers stored as text (left-aligned, with RM in the cell). If a formula returns an error, ask Copilot: Some numbers in this table are stored as text. How do I convert them to numbers?

Independent Practice

In Word, ask Copilot to list every number in the memo with the sentence it appears in. Check each one against your Excel table.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
No Copilot button	Your label is Copilot Chat (Basic), or Copilot is turned off in the apps
The Copilot button is greyed out	Save the file to OneDrive and turn on AutoSave
Copilot in Excel says it needs a table	Select the data and choose Insert > Table
The formula returns #VALUE!	Some numbers are stored as text. Convert them, or retype the figures
Copilot says it's temporarily limited	Standard access is busy. Wait and try again

Lesson Summary

With M365 Copilot (Basic), Copilot works inside the documents themselves: you tightened the memo in Word and checked the comparison with a formula in Excel. Next is the capstone, where you run a whole purchase on your own.

Check yourself: Why put the comparison into an Excel table before asking Copilot about it?

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

For **M365 Copilot (Basic)** users only. Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner.

Part 1: Copilot in Word

Session: Copilot pane in Word, with the memo open | **Grounding:** the open document

Summarise this memo in three bullet points, and tell me which part a busy head of department is most likely to question.

Rewrite the recommendation section so it is no more than 80 words, keeps every figure exactly as it is, and states the conditions clearly. Show me the new version in the chat.

Independent practice:

List every number in this memo, with the sentence it appears in.

Part 2: Copilot in Excel

Session: Copilot pane in Excel, with the comparison table open | **Grounding:** the open workbook

Workbook name (text):

Laptop comparison

Which vendor has the lowest like-for-like total in this table, and by how much?

Give me a formula I can put in a new row to check that subtotal plus tax equals the grand total for each vendor, showing TRUE or FALSE. Tell me which cell to put it in.

If the formula returns an error:

Some numbers in this table are stored as text. How do I convert them to numbers?

10

CHAPTER 10

Capstone: The Training Vendor Purchase

A second purchase has landed on your desk, and this time you run it yourself. You use the same stages as the laptop purchase (ask, compare, chase, draft, organise) and the agent you built in Chapter 8. Each stage tells you the goal, gives a hint, and says how to know you're done. The click-by-click steps are in the earlier chapters if you need them.

Prompts: the prompts page has suggested prompts for each stage. Try writing your own first, with GCSE, and use the starters only if you get stuck.

Estimated time: 45 minutes

Your result: A checked comparison of three training quotations, chasing emails drafted for each provider, a justification memo on a Page, and everything filed in a Notebook.

What You Will Learn

This chapter brings together everything from Chapters 2 to 8. There's nothing new to learn: the aim is to do it without step-by-step help.

Before You Begin

You need:

- the green shield showing in the Copilot app
- your **Quotation Checker** agent from Chapter 8
- the procurement policy (there's a copy in this chapter's sample files)

10.1 The Brief

From your HOD: The department needs a two-day in-house **Effective Business Writing** course for 30 executives, at Menara Teratai, in November 2026. HR says it must be HRD Corp claimable so we can use our levy. I've asked three providers to quote. Please check the quotations, compare them, and send me a recommendation with a memo, the same as you did for the laptops.

Before you start, look at the brief again and note the four things every quotation must match: **two days**, **30 participants**, **in-house**, and **HRD Corp claimable**.

10.2 Get the Files

1. Download [sample-files.zip](#) and extract it.
2. You have four files:

File	What it is
quotation-ilmu-cemerlang.pdf	Ilmu Cemerlang Training Sdn Bhd, Johor Bahru
quotation-pena-mahir.pdf	Pena Mahir Learning Sdn Bhd, George Town
quotation-bestari-skills.pdf	Bestari Skills Academy Sdn Bhd, Kuala Lumpur
procurement-policy.pdf	The same policy extract as Chapter 4

Note: All three providers and every detail in their quotations are fictional. The screenshots in this chapter are blurred where they would give away the answers.

10.3 Draft the Requirements

Goal: A short list of requirements you'd send to training providers, written with GCSE.

Hint: Your Goal is the requirements list. The Context is the brief. Your Source is the brief plus anything Copilot can find about running an in-house writing course. Your Expectations are a numbered list for a request for quotation.

Done when: Your list includes duration, number of participants, venue, HRD Corp status, what the fee must include (materials, certificates) and what the quotation must show (validity, tax as a separate line, payment terms).

10.4 Compare the Quotations

Goal: A checked, like-for-like comparison of the three quotations.

Hint: Start with your **Quotation Checker** agent. Open it from **Agents**, upload all three quotations, use the **Compare quotations** suggested prompt, and give it today's date. Then start a new Copilot Chat, send the policy in its own message first, then the three quotations (Copilot takes at most three files per message), and build the comparison table. Check every total with your calculator.

Copilot Auto ▾

New chat
Search
Library
Agents
Notebooks

Chats

Laptop purchase - comparison

Laptop purchase - quotation ch...

Executive Summary: Are they like-for-like?

No, the quotations are not fully like-for-like. The most significant differences are:

Supplier	Programme Duration	Participants	HRD Corp Claimable	Trainer So

Therefore:

1. Ilmu Cemerlang Training Sdn Bhd

Supplier Details

+ Message Quotation Checker

AI-generated content may be incorrect

Your agent's first real job. Check its findings against the quotations, the same as you would Copilot's.

Done when: You've found one problem in each quotation and can name the policy section that applies to each. Look closely at how each provider prices the course, whether it covers what the brief asks for, and what each quotation says, or doesn't say, about HRD Corp.

Tip: The cheapest quotation on paper may not be the cheapest once it matches the brief. Ask yourself whether each one is quoting for the same thing.

If you don't see this: If your agent isn't under **Agents**, open the sharing link you copied in 8.7, or skip the agent and do the checks in Copilot Chat with the Chapter 4 prompts. If an upload fails or Copilot stops responding, standard access may be busy: wait a minute and try again. If your admin has turned off Notebooks or Pages, use a Word document for 10.6 and a OneDrive folder for 10.7.

10.5 Chase the Providers

Goal: One email to each provider asking for exactly what you need to fix its quotation.

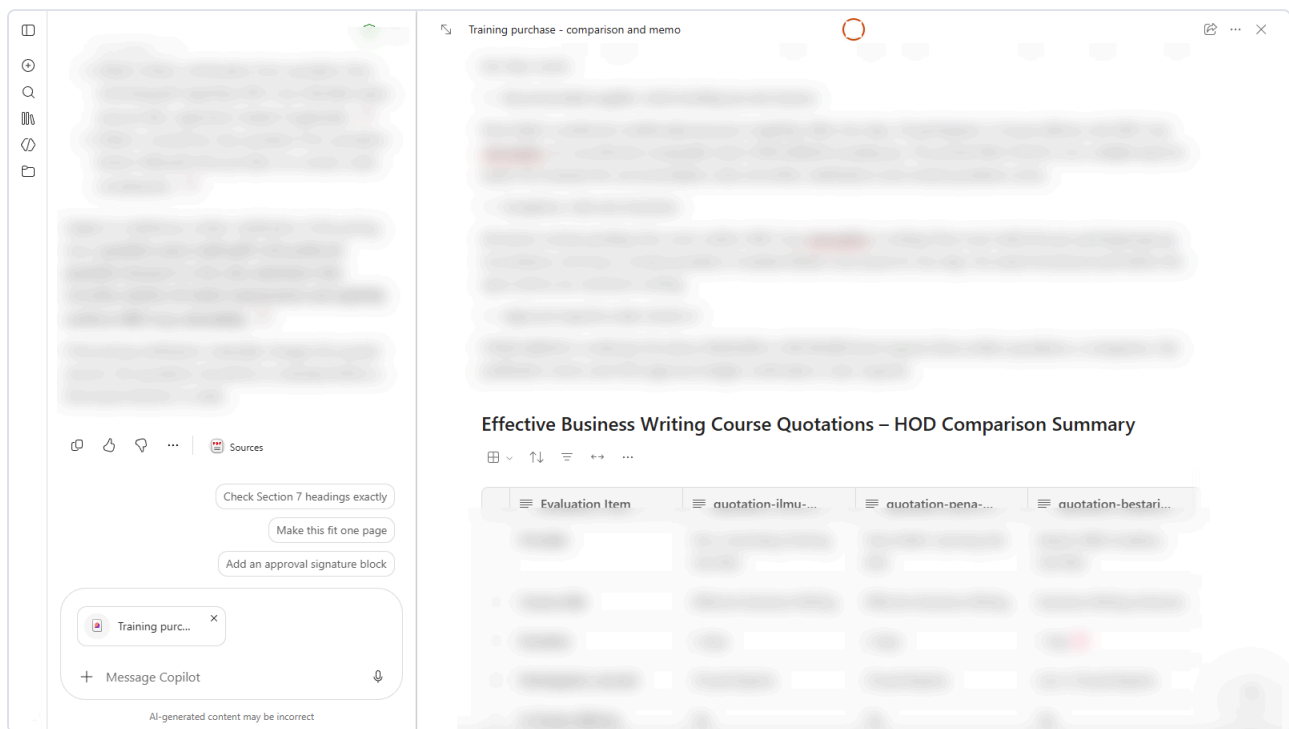
Hint: In Outlook, create a **New mail** to yourself with a subject starting [CCB TRAINING], then draft the text in the **Copilot** pane and copy it into the email. Give Copilot the facts in your prompt: the quotation number, the problem and what you need. Don't ask Copilot to work out figures it can't see.

Done when: You have three drafts. Each one names the quotation number, explains the problem politely, and asks for a revised quotation or written confirmation.

10.6 Write the Memo

Goal: A justification memo on a Page that follows Section 7 of the policy.

Hint: Ask for one complete comparison in the chat (list everything it must include, so nothing drifts), then use **Edit in Pages**. Write the memo in the same chat, where the policy is uploaded, and add it to the Page. Make the recommendation conditional on the open actions.



Same structure as the laptop memo: recommendation first, evidence after.

Done when: The memo covers every item in Section 7, says which approval the amount needs, explains why the cheapest-looking quotation isn't the recommendation (if it isn't), and has no figure you haven't checked.

10.7 File It in Your Notebook

Goal: Everything for the training purchase in one Notebook.

Hint: Create a new Notebook called `Training purchase 2026`. Add the three quotations, the policy and your Page, plus a note about the emails you drafted.

Done when: You can ask the Notebook `What's still outstanding before the HOD can approve this?` and get a correct answer with citations.

10.8 Run Your Quotation Checker

Goal: Use your agent as a final check on whatever you'd send to the HOD.

Hint: Imagine one provider sends a revised quotation. Upload the original quotation to the agent and ask:
If the supplier fixed only the problem I raised, would this quotation pass every check?

Done when: You're confident that the memo, the comparison and the chasing emails tell the same story.

Capstone Checklist

Tick these off before you tell your trainer you've finished.

- ☐ I wrote the requirements with all four GCSE parts.
- ☐ My comparison shows each figure as printed, and I checked every total myself.
- ☐ I found one problem in each quotation and know which policy section applies.
- ☐ I drafted one chasing email per provider, with facts I gave Copilot myself.
- ☐ My memo is on a Page, follows Section 7, and makes the recommendation conditional.
- ☐ Everything is in the **Training purchase 2026** Notebook.
- ☐ I could explain every number in the memo without Copilot.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
The agent doesn't ask for the date	Include today's date in your prompt. Then update the agent's instructions (Chapter 8)
One total looks far too small	Read the pricing lines carefully. Is the fee per person or per group?
A quotation looks cheapest by a long way	Check it quotes for the same course as the brief
Copilot can't see the files	You're in a different chat from the one you uploaded to
Anything else	Go back to the matching chapter: comparison (4), emails (5), Pages (6), Notebooks (7), agent (8)

Lesson Summary

You ran a whole purchase with Copilot: requirements, comparison, chasing, memo and filing, with your own agent doing the first round of checks. Copilot did the reading, the layout and the drafting. You did the checking and the judging, which is the part your HOD is relying on. For more practice, try the four short exercises in Chapter 11.

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Suggested prompts for each stage of the capstone. Try writing your own with GCSE first, and use these only if you get stuck. Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner.

Session guide: Part 1 runs in a new chat. Part 2 starts in your **Quotation Checker** agent, then moves to a new chat with all four files uploaded. Parts 3 and 4 run in that same chat. Part 5 runs in Outlook.

Part 1: Requirements

Session: new chat | **Grounding:** web

Draft the requirements for a request for quotation for a two-day in-house Effective Business Writing course for 30 executives at our Kuala Lumpur office in November 2026. The course must be HRD Corp claimable. Base it on what a good in-house training quotation should include, and show your sources. Format it as a numbered list under 200 words, including duration, participants, venue, HRD Corp status, what the fee must include, and what the quotation must show (validity, tax as a separate line, payment terms).

Part 2: Comparison and checks

Session: Quotation Checker agent, with the three quotations uploaded | **Grounding:** uploaded files

Check the quotations I've uploaded and tell me whether they're like-for-like. Today's date is [today's date].

Session: new chat, with all four files uploaded | **Grounding:** uploaded files

I've uploaded three quotations for a two-day in-house Effective Business Writing course for 30 participants, and our procurement policy. Build a comparison table with one column per provider and these rows: course title, duration, number of participants covered, pricing basis (per participant or per group), fee, materials, subtotal, tax, grand total, HRD Corp claimable status, validity, payment terms. Show figures exactly as printed.

Check each quotation against our brief: two days, 30 participants, in-house, HRD Corp claimable. Then check each against Section 5 of the policy. Today's date is [today's date]. Quote the words from each quotation that support your answer.

One quotation states a price per participant but calculates the fee as one group. What would the total be if the per-participant price were applied to 30 participants, including tax? Show your working. I will ask the provider to confirm, so label this as unconfirmed.

Part 3: Memo

Session: same chat | **Grounding:** uploaded files

Give me one complete comparison of the three training quotations for my HOD. Include: figures as printed; any figure that needs correcting by the provider, clearly marked as unconfirmed; whether each quotation matches the brief; HRD Corp status; and the open action for each provider. Use one table plus a short list of actions.

Write a justification memo to the HOD for the training purchase, following Section 7 of the procurement policy exactly. Use a heading for each item Section 7 lists. Make the recommendation conditional on the open actions being completed in writing, and explain why the cheapest-looking quotation is or isn't recommended. Use [budget code] and [HOD name] as placeholders. One page, plain British English.

Part 4: Notebook

Session: Training purchase 2026 Notebook | **Grounding:** Notebook references

Notebook name (text):

Training purchase 2026

What's still outstanding before the HOD can approve this? For each item, say which provider it involves and which policy section requires it.

Part 5: Chasing emails

Session: Outlook, new mail to yourself, Copilot pane | **Grounding:** your prompt

Use a subject that starts [CCB TRAINING] . Fill in the square brackets from your own findings.

Write a polite email to [contact name] at [provider] about quotation [quotation number] for our two-day Effective Business Writing course for 30 executives. Explain that [the problem you found], and ask them to [what you need: a revised quotation, or written confirmation]. Brief and factual, British English.

11

CHAPTER 11

Extra Practice

Four short exercises for when you finish early, or for practice back at your desk. They follow on from the laptop purchase but stand on their own, and each one uses only the features that come with both Basic labels.

Prompts: every prompt you need is in the steps, with a Copy button. The prompts page has them all on one page too.

Estimated time: 10 to 15 minutes each, self-paced

Your result: Up to four small pieces of finished work, each built with the skills from Chapters 2 to 8.

Which One Should I Try?

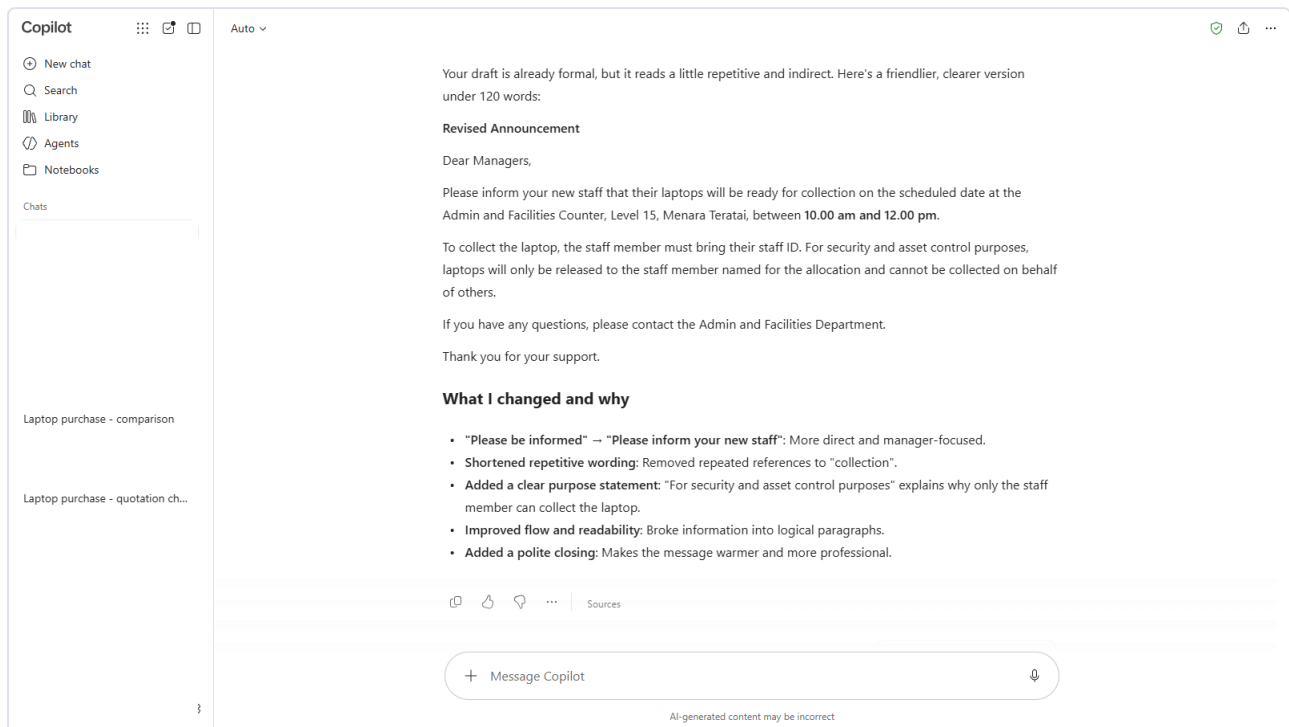
Exercise	What you make	Practises	Where
A. Polish an announcement	A staff announcement about the new laptops	Writing Coach (or Copilot Chat), iterating	Copilot app, Agents
B. Make a notice image	A notice image for laptop collection day	Image generation, describing a picture	Copilot app, Chat
C. Improve a weak prompt	A strong GCSE prompt from a weak one	Prompt Coach, GCSE	Copilot app, Agents
D. Research with sources	A short, sourced note on disposing of old laptops	Web grounding, checking sources	Copilot app, Chat

If you don't see this: Your admin decides which prebuilt agents you can use. If one is missing or says you don't have permission, do the same exercise in a normal Copilot chat with the same prompt. Image generation can also be limited or slow at busy times with standard access: if Copilot says it can't make an image right now, try again later.

A. Polish an Announcement

The problem: The laptops are coming, and the new hires' managers need to know how collection works. Your first draft is accurate but stiff.

1. In the Copilot app, select **Agents** and open **Writing Coach**. If it says you don't have permission, select **New chat** instead.
2. Paste the prompt from the prompts page, which includes the draft, and send it.
3. Read the feedback. Ask for one change at a time, for example **Make the opening friendlier, and keep it under 120 words.**
4. When you're happy, copy the final version.



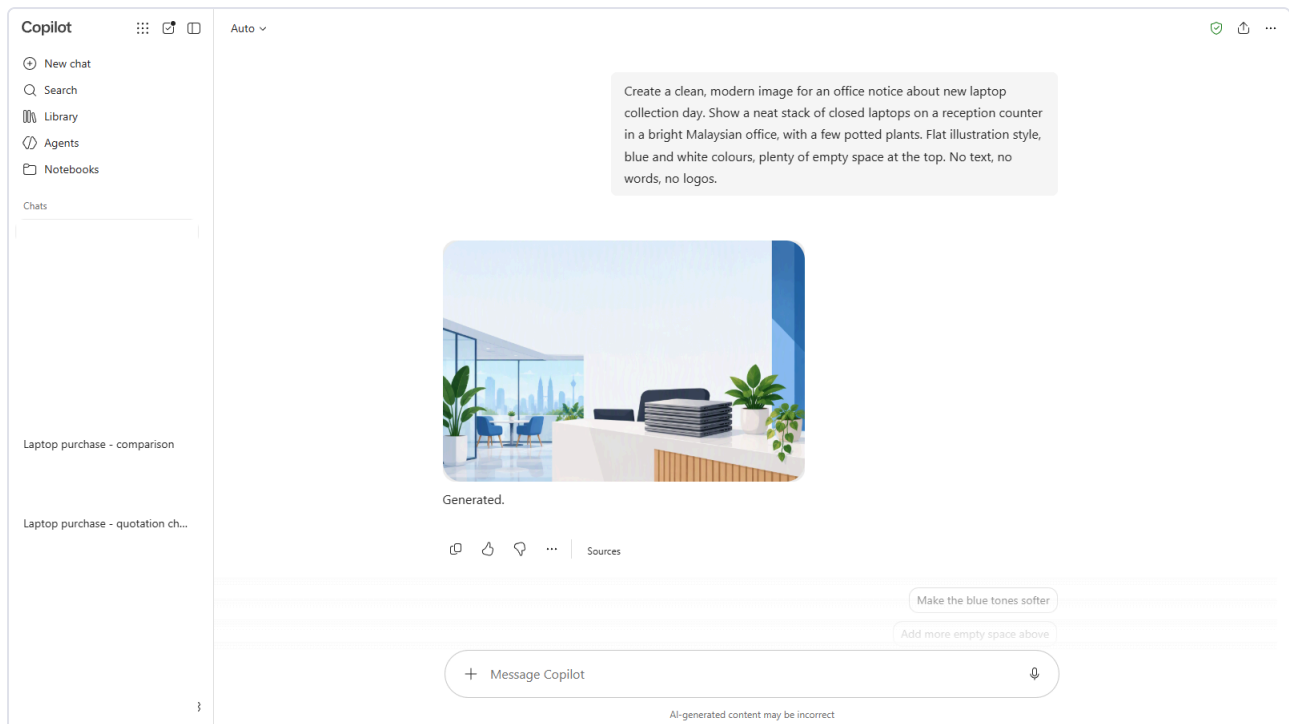
Copilot tells you what it changed and why. Use that to improve your own first drafts next time.

Done when: Your announcement is under 120 words, has the date, place and what to bring, and sounds like you.

B. Make a Notice Image

The problem: You want a simple image for the notice board and the Teams post about laptop collection day.

1. Select **New chat**. Copilot Chat creates images itself, so you don't need a separate agent.
2. Send the prompt from the prompts page.
3. Look at the image. Ask for one change at a time, for example **Use a calmer colour scheme with blue and white.**
4. Download the image you like best.



Describe the scene, the style and the colours. Leave the exact words for the notice text itself.

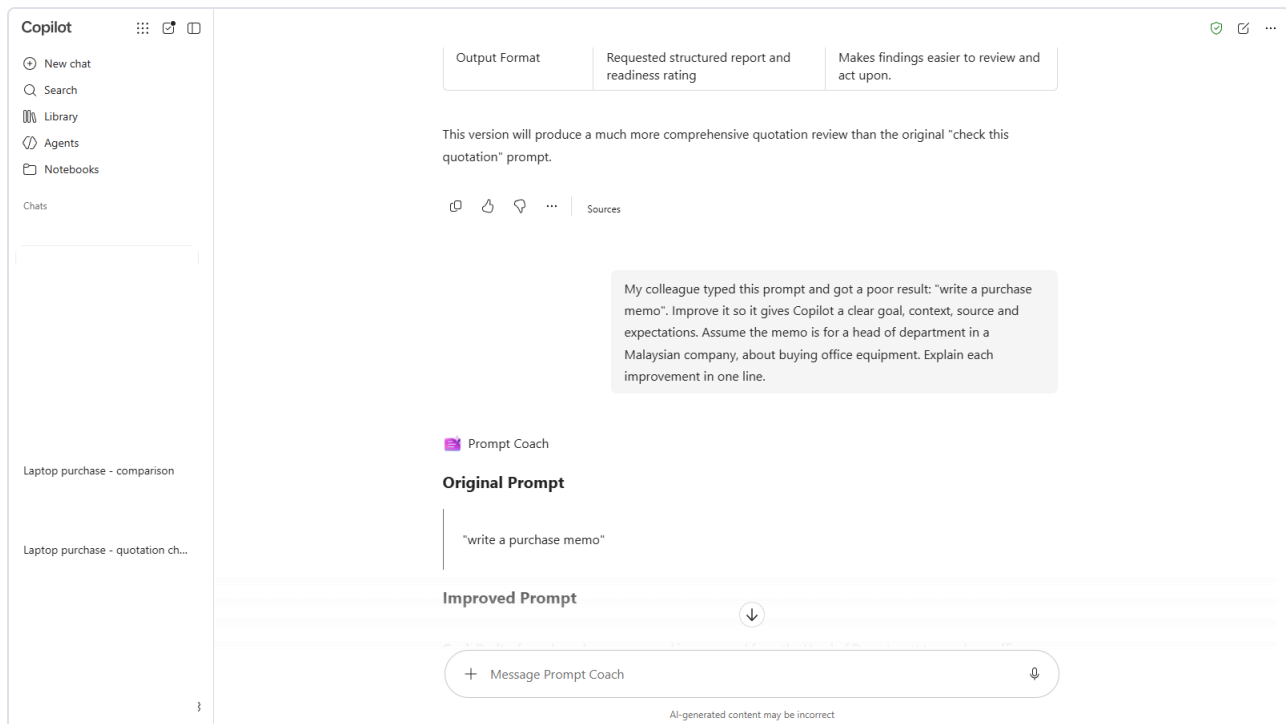
Important: AI images often get text wrong: spelling, dates and numbers. Ask for an image **without** words, and put the date and place in the notice text yourself. Don't ask for company logos or real brand names.

Done when: You have an image with no text in it that you'd be happy to put above the announcement from Exercise A.

C. Improve a Weak Prompt

The problem: A colleague tells you "Copilot is useless, I asked it to write a memo and got rubbish." Their prompt was four words long.

1. Select **Agents**, then **Prompt Coach**.
2. Send the prompt from the prompts page.
3. Read Prompt Coach's version. Which GCSE parts did it add?
4. Run the improved prompt in a new Copilot Chat. Compare the result with what the four-word prompt gives.



The improved prompt adds a goal, context, source and expectations. That's GCSE from Chapter 3.

Done when: You can explain to your colleague, in one sentence, why their prompt didn't work.

D. Research with Sources

The problem: The 25 new laptops mean some old ones will be retired. Your HOD asks how the company should dispose of old laptops properly in Malaysia.

1. Select **New chat**.
2. Send the prompt from the prompts page.
3. Open at least two of the sources. For each one, check who published it, when, and whether it says what Copilot says it does.
4. Ask the follow-up prompt to separate checked facts from Copilot's general advice.

Copilot Auto ▾

New chat
Search
Library
Agents
Notebooks

Chats

Laptop purchase - comparison

Laptop purchase - quotation ch...

Responsible Disposal of Old Office Laptops in Malaysia (5 Key Points)

- Securely wipe all data before disposal**
 - Remove company data from every laptop using a recognised media sanitisation process. The **NIST SP 800-88 Guidelines for Media Sanitization** state that media sanitisation should make access to the data "infeasible" and provide suitable methods for disposal based on information sensitivity. nist +1
 - Keep records of the wiping process and any certificates issued by a data-erasure provider.
- Treat unusable laptops as e-waste**
 - In Malaysia, e-waste is classified as **Scheduled Waste SW110** under the Environmental Quality (Scheduled Wastes) Regulations 2005. Old computers and laptops fall within this category. doe +2
 - The Department of Environment (DOE) warns that improper disposal can release hazardous substances and harm human health and the environment. doe +1
- Use DOE-registered collectors or licensed recovery facilities**
 - DOE advises generators of e-waste to send it to **registered collection centres** or **licensed recovery facilities** rather than informal scrap dealers. doe +1
 - DOE publishes lists of approved collection centres and recovery facilities for proper handling and recycling. doe +1
- Consider resale if the laptops still have value**
 - After secure data wiping, functional laptops can be resold to employees, refurbishers, or second-hand IT asset disposition (ITAD) providers.
 - Good practice is to document the asset transfer, serial numbers, and proof of data sanitisation before ownership changes. (This is a recommended business practice rather than a specific DOE requirement.) doe +1

+ Message Copilot

AI-generated content may be incorrect

Regulations change. Check that each source is current and from an official or reputable body.

Done when: You have a short note of no more than five points, each backed by a source you've opened and checked.

Lesson Summary

Writing Coach and Prompt Coach are ready-made agents, and Copilot Chat can make images on its own. Web research with sources works best when you check the sources yourself. All four exercises use what comes with your Basic license, so you can keep practising at your desk tomorrow.

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Prompts for the four extra exercises. Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner.

Exercise A: Writing Coach

Session: Writing Coach, or a new chat | **Grounding:** your pasted text

Help me improve this announcement to managers of new staff. Keep all the facts, make it friendlier and clearer, and keep it under 120 words. Tell me what you changed and why.

Draft:

Please be informed that the laptops for new hires will be available for collection. Collection will take place on the stated date at the Admin and Facilities counter, Level 15, Menara Teratai, between 10.00 am and 12.00 pm. Staff are required to bring their staff ID. Laptops will be issued only to the staff member concerned. Any enquiries may be directed to the Admin and Facilities department.

Follow-up:

Make the opening friendlier, and keep it under 120 words.

Exercise B: Make an image

Session: new chat | **Grounding:** none

Create a clean, modern image for an office notice about new laptop collection day. Show a neat stack of closed laptops on a reception counter in a bright Malaysian office, with a few potted plants. Flat illustration style, blue and white colours, plenty of empty space at the top. No text, no words, no logos.

Follow-up:

Use a calmer colour scheme with blue and white, and make the laptops the clear focus.

Exercise C: Prompt Coach

Session: Prompt Coach | **Grounding:** your pasted text

My colleague typed this prompt and got a poor result: "write a purchase memo". Improve it so it gives Copilot a clear goal, context, source and expectations. Assume the memo is for a head of department in a Malaysian company, about buying office equipment. Explain each improvement in one line.

Exercise D: Research with sources

Session: new chat | **Grounding:** web

How should a company in Malaysia dispose of old office laptops responsibly? Cover data wiping, e-waste rules and options such as resale, donation or recycling. Use official or reputable sources, show them, and keep it to five points.

Follow-up:

Which of your five points come directly from an official source, and which are general good practice? Mark each one.

Copilot Chat Basic Workshop

This book accompanies the one-day Copilot Chat Basic Workshop. It follows one purchase at a fictional Malaysian company, from checking which Copilot you have, through writing requirements with the GCSE framework, comparing three supplier quotations against a procurement policy and chasing the vendors in Outlook, to a justification memo on a Copilot Page, a Notebook for the whole purchase and a Quotation Checker agent you build yourself. Every chapter gives point-and-click steps and ready-to-paste prompts that work with Copilot Chat (Basic), without the paid Microsoft 365 Copilot license.